



Meal Management System

User Manual & Complete Feature Catalog

Employee & Mess Manager Guide

Everything the application does, screen by screen — with real screenshots of **every page, card, table, button, filter, status and empty state**, taken from a full month of live data.

APPLICATION

Meal Tracker — office meal management

VERSION

0.1.0 · Next.js 16 + Supabase

DOCUMENT DATE

29 September 2026

REFERENCE MONTH

September 2026 (5 Sep → 5 Oct)

AUDIENCE

Employees · Mess Managers · New users · Management

CURRENCY & TIME

Bangladeshi Taka (৳) · Asia/Dhaka

This manual doubles as a User Manual, a Feature Catalog, a Visual UI Guide, Training Material, a Quick Reference and a Troubleshooting/FAQ guide.



Table of Contents

1	About the Application	3
2	Getting Started — Access, Sign-up, Sign-in	5
3	The Employee Panel	13
4	Meal Status & Meal Selection	20
5	Monthly View — Dates, Months, Totals	24
6	The Mess Manager Panel	30
7	Employee Management	40
8	Meal Data & the Monthly Meal Table	45
9	Expense Status — Deposits, Rate, Dues	53
10	Guest Meals	61
11	Dashboard Analytics	67
12	Empty States	72
13	Status, Colour & Icon Guide	82
14	Role & Permission Guide	86
15	The Monthly Workflow	88
16	Common User Scenarios	91
17	Frequently Asked Questions	98
18	Quick Start Guide	101
A	Appendix — Screen Audit & Demo Dataset	103

How to read this manual

ELEMENT	WHAT IT MEANS
Figure 4.2	A screenshot taken from the running application. The number is <i>section.figure</i> .
WITH DATA / EMPTY STATE	Side-by-side comparison of the same screen with and without records.
Red circles 1 2 3	Numbered call-outs on a screenshot, explained in the table underneath.
Note Rule Tip Warning	Coloured boxes: background information, a hard rule enforced by the system, a shortcut, or something that cannot be undone.

About the screenshots in this manual

Every screenshot is a real capture of the application running against a complete month of test data (14 employees, 629 daily meal records, 32 deposits, 9 guest dates, 28 spending entries, 4 mess-month manager accounts). Nothing has been drawn, mocked or retouched. All figures — meal counts, bills, deposits, guest bills, totals — are the numbers the application itself produced.

1 About the Application

Meal Tracker is a mobile-first web application that runs an office mess: who eats which meal on which day, what the mess spends, what each person owes at the end of the month, and how many plates the cook has to prepare today.

1.1 Why it exists

Before an app, an office mess runs on a paper register. Three problems repeat every month:

- **Nobody knows today's plate count until it is too late.** The cook guesses, and food is wasted or runs short.
- **The register is edited after the fact.** Somebody "remembers" they skipped dinner three days ago and the totals stop being trustworthy.
- **Month-end billing is a night of arithmetic.** Meals × rate, minus deposits, per person, by hand.

Meal Tracker fixes all three: employees mark their own meals in advance, meals lock themselves at a published deadline, and every bill is calculated by the database from the records that already exist — so the numbers can never go stale.

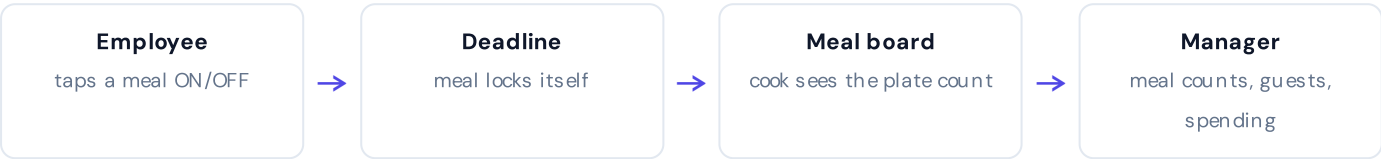
1.2 Who uses it — three audiences, three screens

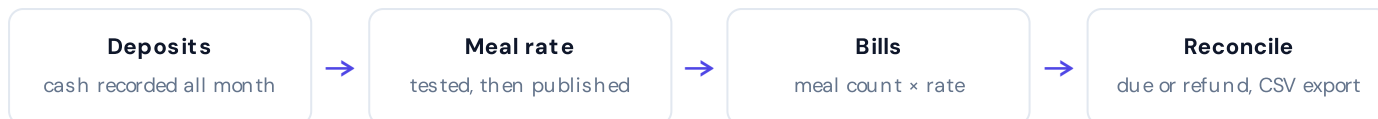
AUDIENCE	SCREEN	WHAT THEY DO THERE
The cook no login at all	 — the meal board	Reads today's plate count per meal, plus guests and the total to prepare. Read-only: there is not a single button to press. The page refreshes itself every minute.
Employees one login each	 — Employee Panel	Switch their own breakfast / lunch / dinner ON or OFF, see the meals they have already had, their deposits, and their published bill.
Mess managers one shared login per month	 — Mess Manager Panel	Seven tabs: Dashboard, Meal Status, Guest, Expense Status, Spend, Report, Employees. They run the month and close the books.

The mess month runs 5th → 5th, meal by meal

A "month" here is not a calendar month. It starts with the **5th's lunch** and ends with the **next 5th's breakfast** — for example **5 September lunch → 5 October breakfast**. Each mess month has exactly one manager account, named after the month (), shared by that month's team of roughly five people. On the 5th, two managers are in charge at once, each for their own meals of that day.

1.3 The basic workflow





1.4 How the money works

Four formulas run the whole application. Everything else on screen is one of these four applied to a different slice of data.

```

daily meal count    = breakfast ON × breakfast count + lunch ON × lunch count + dinner ON × dinner count
monthly meal count  = sum of the daily meal counts over the manager period's own meals
total bill          = monthly meal count × meal rate
balance            = total deposit − total bill    (> 0 refund · = 0 settled · < 0 due)
  
```

A **meal count** is not the same as a meal. Breakfast is smaller than lunch, so each meal carries a weight. The default weights are **Breakfast 0.75 · Lunch 1.25 · Dinner 1.00**, and the mess manager can change them for any single date (a biryani night can be worth 200). Weights are stored once per date, not per person, so changing a date's lunch count instantly re-prices everyone who had lunch that day.

Guests and mess spending are kept completely separate from employee bills:

```

guest bill (one date) = breakfast guests × ₳60 + lunch guests × ₳150 + dinner guests × ₳150
total bill to collect = the same, added up over every date of the mess month (paid by the office)
total monthly spending = the sum of every spending entry recorded in the mess month
  
```

1.5 What the system guarantees

GUARANTEE	HOW IT IS ENFORCED
Nobody edits anyone else's meals	An employee's login can write only their own meal row. Enforced by the database (Row Level Security), not just hidden in the interface.
Past meals never change	A previous day is refused outright; today's meal is refused once its deadline passes. Enforced by a database trigger, so it also blocks a hand-made API request.
Each month sees only its own data	September2026 cannot see August's meal counts, deposits, rate, guests, spending or report — and vice versa.
A manager changes only their own meals	And only while their period is running: 00:00 on its first day to 23:59 on its last, Bangladesh time.
Nothing is ever deleted by an account change	A login cannot be deleted while its month exists; a month cannot be deleted while it holds meal counts, deposits, guests or spending.
"Today" is always Bangladesh time	Every date and deadline is computed in Asia/Dhaka , whatever the phone or server is set to.

2 Getting Started

2.1 How to reach the application

Meal Tracker is a website — there is nothing to install. Open the office link in any phone or desktop browser. Three addresses matter:

ADDRESS	WHO IT IS FOR	SIGN-IN NEEDED?
/	The cook, and anyone passing by	No. Today's meal board is public and read-only.
/employee	Every employee	Yes — Token Number + password.
/admin	The month's mess manager team	Yes — month account name + password.

The two buttons in the top-right corner of every page — [Employee Panel](#) and [Mess Manager](#) — switch between the panels. The one you are currently inside is filled in solid.

Page 6 of 108

5	Guest count (amber)	Guests declared by the mess manager for today. Shown only when guests exist, and never mixed into the employee number.
6	To prepare (indigo)	Employees + guests. This is the number the cook cooks to.
7	Employee column	Every active employee, ordered by Token Number. Inactive people are not listed.
8	Green tick	This person is eating this meal.
9	Grey dash	This person is not eating this meal.

2.2 Employee sign-up (Token Number)

Every employee signs up **once**, using the Token Number printed on the office employee list. No phone number, no e-mail, no verification message.

1. The mess manager adds you to the employee list with your Token Number (Section 7).
2. You open `/employee/signup`.
3. Type your **Token Number** and choose a password of at least **6 characters**, twice.
4. Press **Create account** — you are signed straight in. There is no confirmation step.

EMPTY FORM

Meal Tracker

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Employee sign up

Use your Token Number from the employee list. Each Token Number can sign up once.

Token Number

12

The number the mess manager has on the employee list.

Password

At least 6 characters.

Confirm password

Create account

Already have an account? Sign in

Figure 2.2 — `/employee/signup` before typing.

FILLED IN

Meal Tracker

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Employee sign up

Use your Token Number from the employee list. Each Token Number can sign up once.

Token Number

101

The number the mess manager has on the employee list.

Password

At least 6 characters.

Confirm password

Create account

Already have an account? Sign in

Figure 2.3 — Token 101 with a password entered twice, ready to submit.

Rule — one account per Token Number

A Token Number can be claimed only once, and only if it is on the employee list and the employee is active. Token numbers are not secret (they are printed on the meal board), so whoever signs up first claims it. If the wrong person claims a token, the mess manager presses **Reset login** (Section 7.4) and the real employee signs up again.

Meal Tracker 0.1.0 · September 2026

Page 7 of 108

What the sign-up form tells you when something is wrong

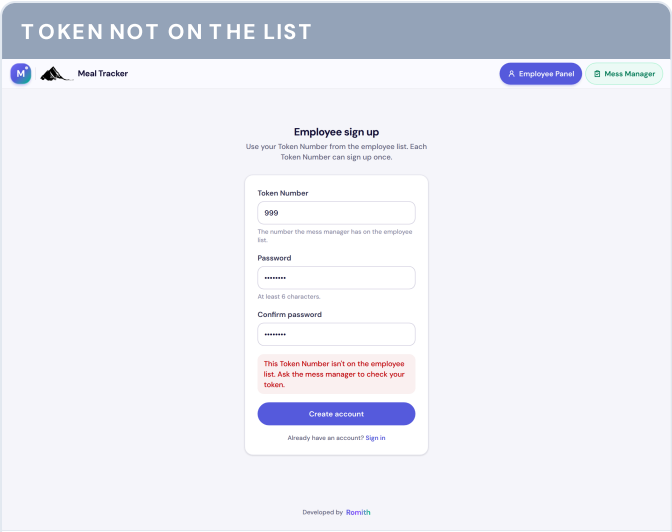


Figure 2.4 — Token 999 does not exist. Ask the manager to check your token.

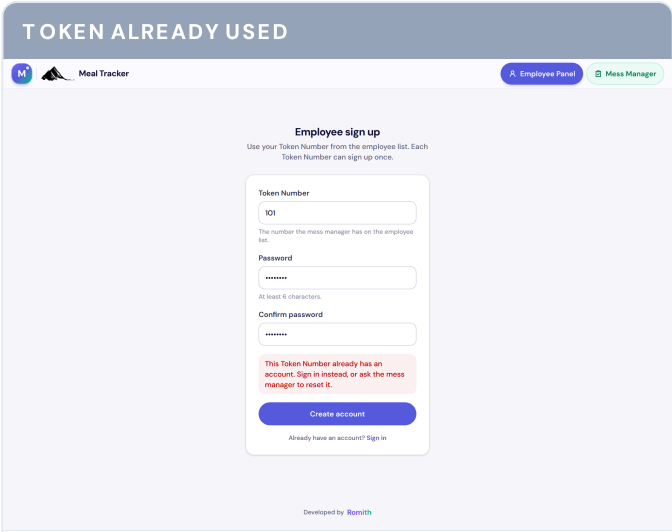


Figure 2.5 — This token already has an account. Sign in instead, or ask for a reset.

2.3 Employee sign-in

After the first time, use `/employee/login` : Token Number and password.

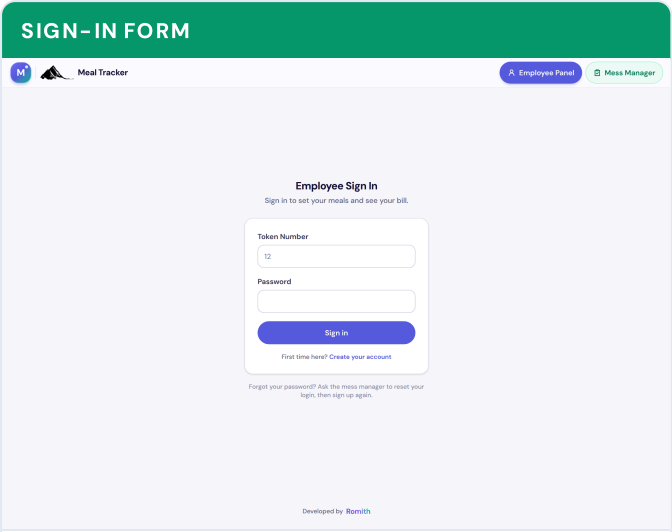


Figure 2.6 — Note the reminder under the card: there is no "forgot password" e-mail. The mess manager resets your login instead.

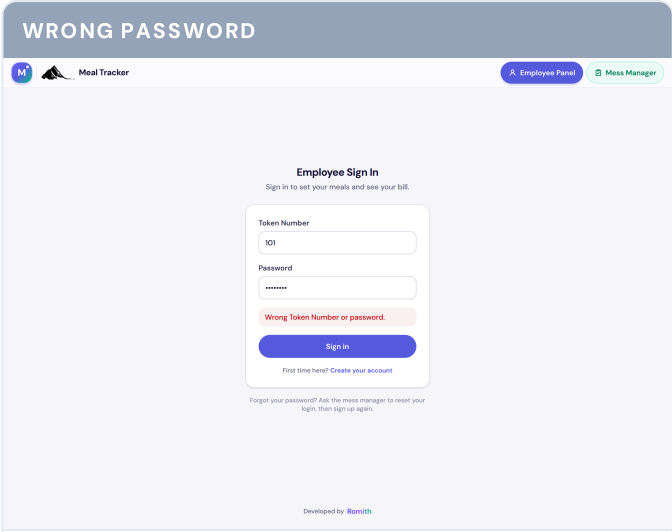


Figure 2.7 — The message never says *which* of the two was wrong.

What you see immediately after signing in

You land on your own Employee Panel — your name, your token, today's meals, and your month. You can see nobody else's meals, deposits or bill. Section 3 walks through every part of this screen.

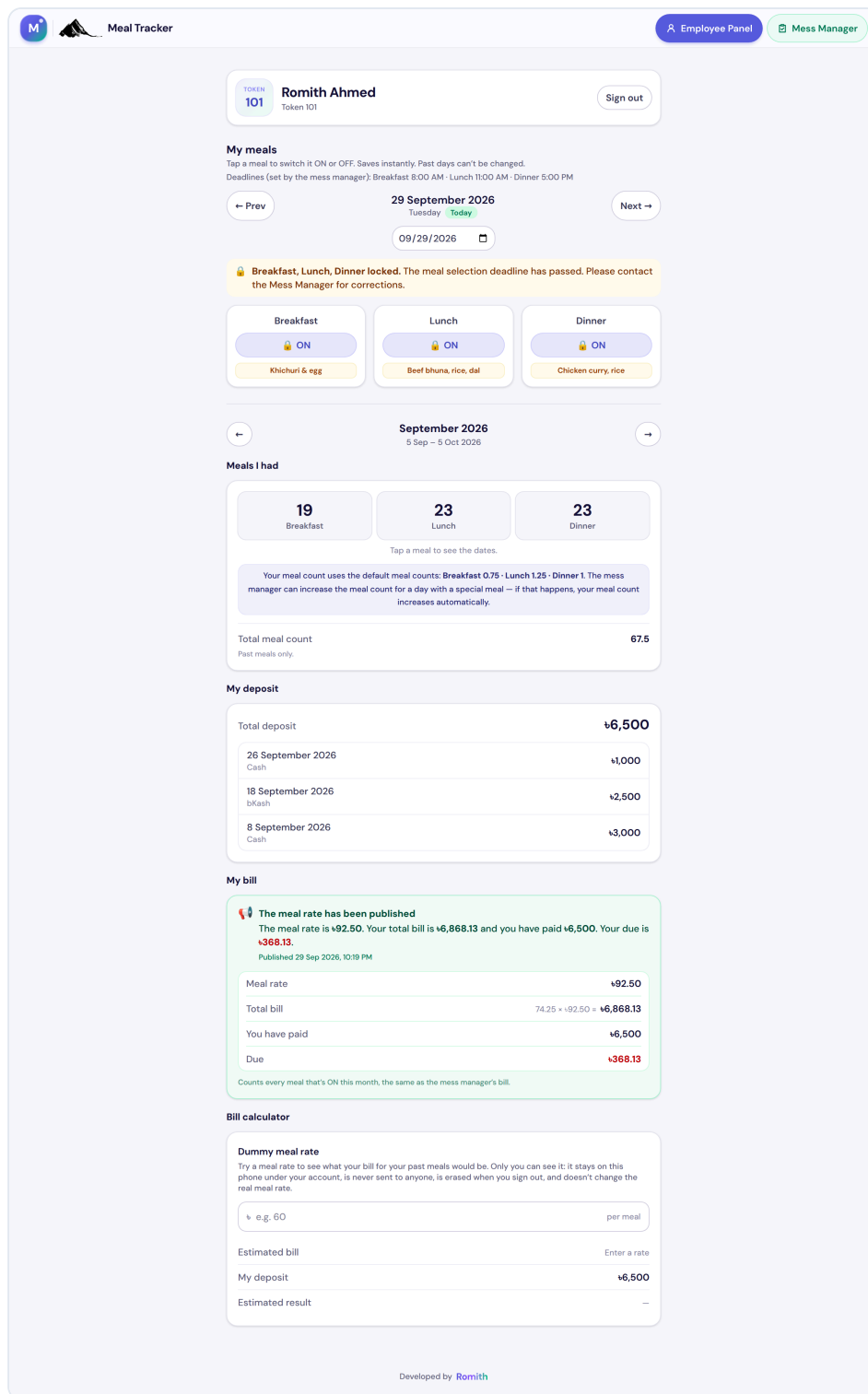


Figure 2.8 — The Employee Panel straight after signing in, on the evening of 29 September 2026. All three of today's meals are already past their deadlines, so each shows .

2.4 Mess manager sign-up (one account per month)

Each month's team signs up **once** at </admin/signup> with the month's name and a password of at least **8 characters**, then shares both with the team. Signup is open — anyone with the link can claim a month nobody has taken yet — but the account can only ever manage the month written in its own name.

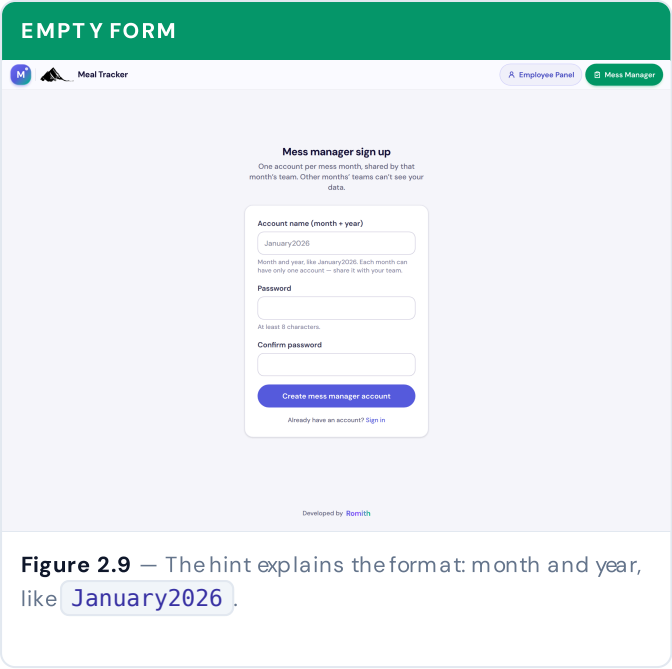


Figure 2.9 — The hint explains the format: month and year, like `January2026`.

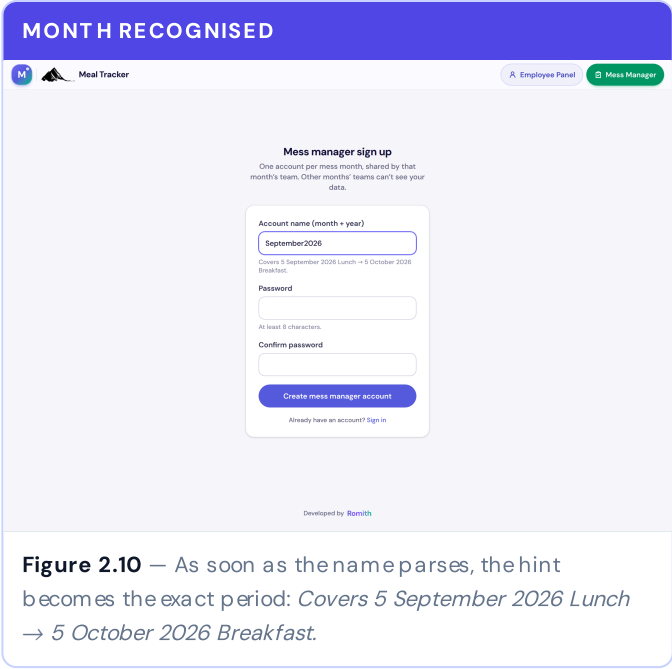


Figure 2.10 — As soon as the name parses, the hint becomes the exact period: *Covers 5 September 2026 Lunch → 5 October 2026 Breakfast.*

Rule — each month can be claimed only once

If the month already has an account, sign-up is refused and you are told to sign in instead (Figure 2.11). There is no "forgot password" for a month account either: to reset it, an administrator changes the password for that month's user in the Supabase dashboard. Nothing is deleted by a password change.

2.5 Mess manager sign-in

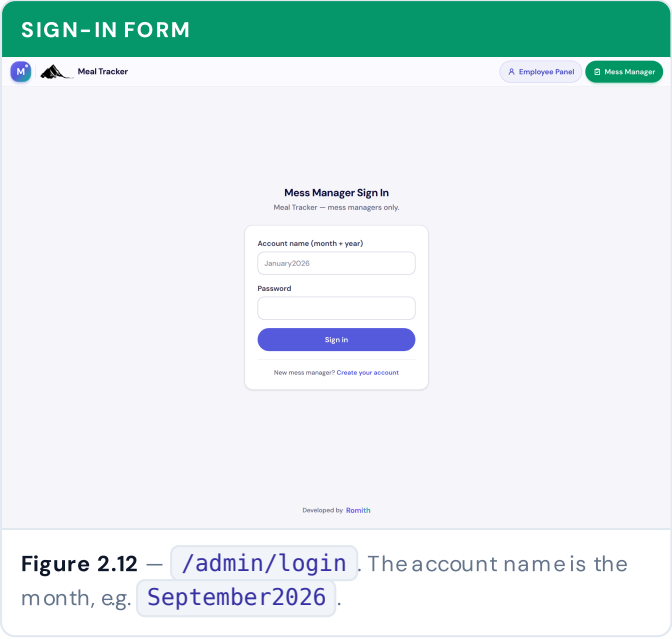


Figure 2.12 — `/admin/login`. The account name is the month, e.g. `September2026`.

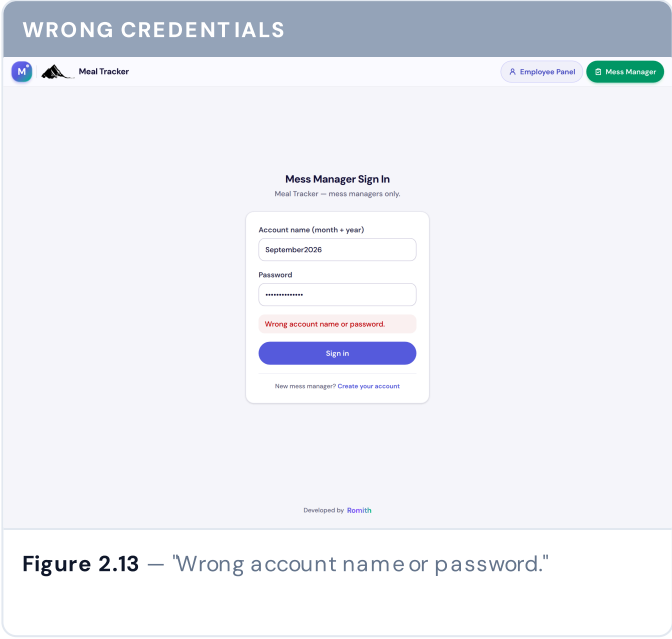


Figure 2.13 — "Wrong account name or password."

Mess manager sign up

One account per mess month, shared by that month's team. Other months' teams can't see your data.

Account name (month + year)

September2026

Covers 5 September 2026 Lunch -> 5 October 2026 Breakfast.

Password

At least 8 characters.

Confirm password

September2026 already has a mess manager. Sign in instead.

Create mess manager account

Already have an account? [Sign in](#)

Developed by [Romith](#)

Figure 2.11 — Trying to sign up for a month that already has a manager: *"September2026 already has a mess manager. Sign in instead."*

What the manager sees after signing in

The Dashboard, with the left-hand tab list, the month's figures, and the account name and period pinned to the bottom of the sidebar. Section 6 documents every tab.

2.6 Signing out

- **Employee:** the **Sign out** button in the white card at the top of the panel. Signing out also erases the private "dummy meal rate" saved in that browser (Section 3.6).
- **Mess manager: Sign out** at the bottom of the sidebar on a computer, or the last item of the scrolling tab row on a phone. It returns you to `/admin/login`.

2.7 When the wrong kind of account opens a panel

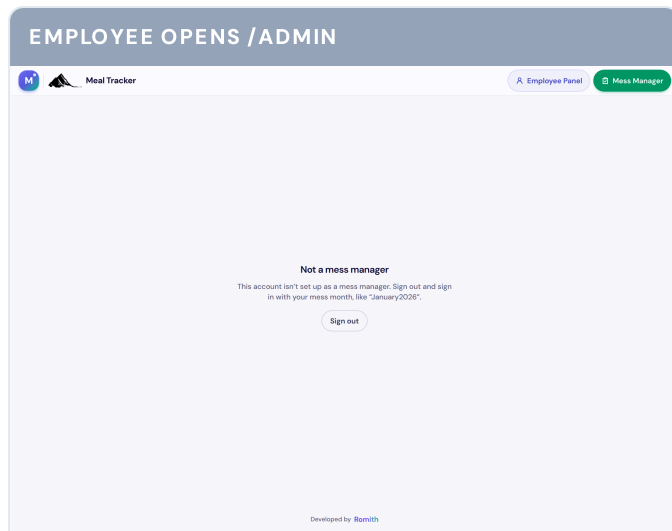


Figure 2.14 — An employee login is not a manager login. Sign out and sign in with the month account.

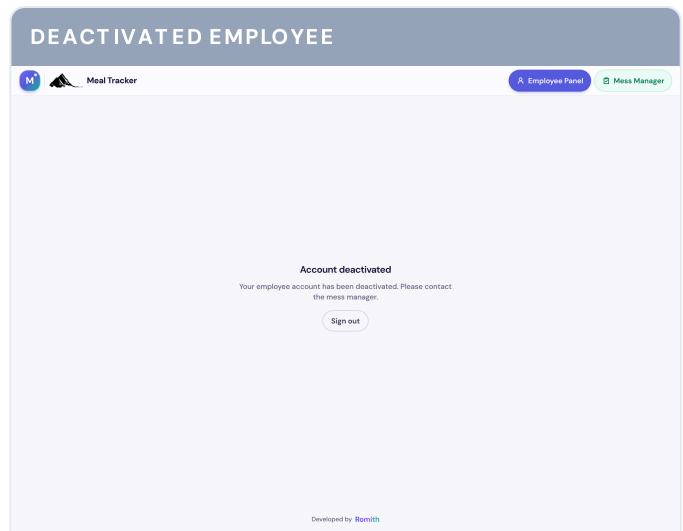


Figure 2.15 — A deactivated employee can still sign in, but the panel is closed until the manager reactivates them.

2.8 First-time setup (administrator, once per installation)

1. Each month's team signs up at `/admin/signup` with the month name.
2. The manager adds every employee with their Token Number under **Employees**.
3. Each employee signs up once at `/employee/signup`.
4. The manager checks the meal deadlines under **Meal Status** → **Employee meal deadlines** (they start at Breakfast 8:00 AM · Lunch 11:00 AM · Dinner 5:00 PM).

That is the whole setup. There is nothing else to configure inside the application.

3 The Employee Panel

The Employee Panel (`/employee`) is a single scrolling page. Everything an employee can do in the whole application is on it. There are no sub-pages and no menus to learn.

3.1 The page at a glance

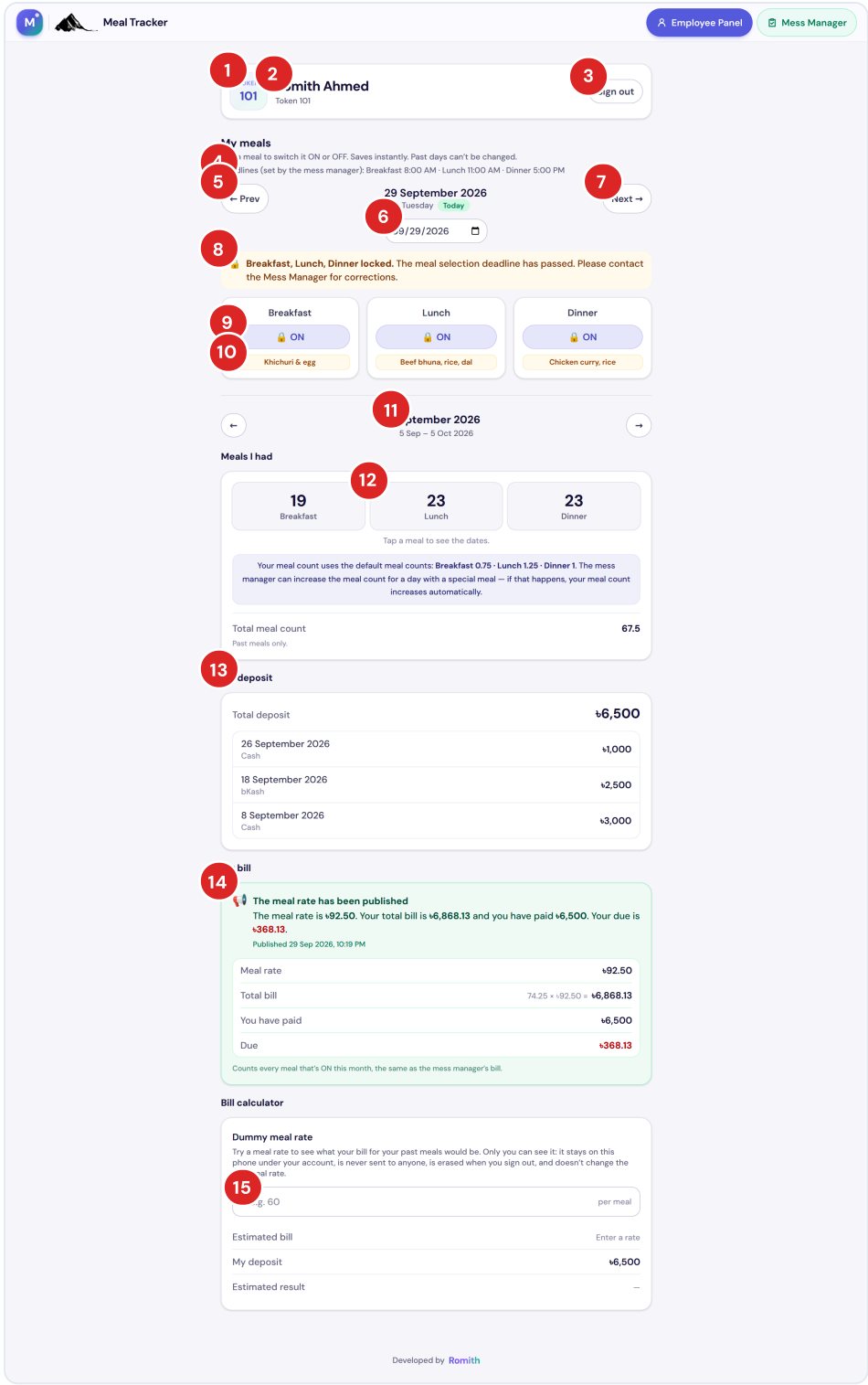


Figure 3.1 — The complete Employee Panel with a populated month (Romith Ahmed, token 101, 29 September 2026). Every numbered element is explained below.

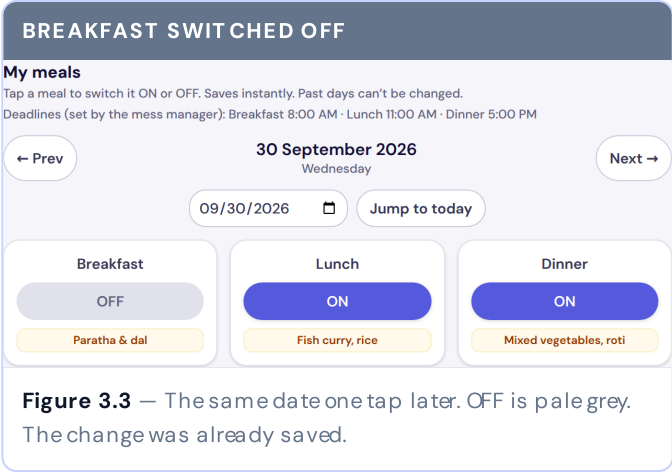
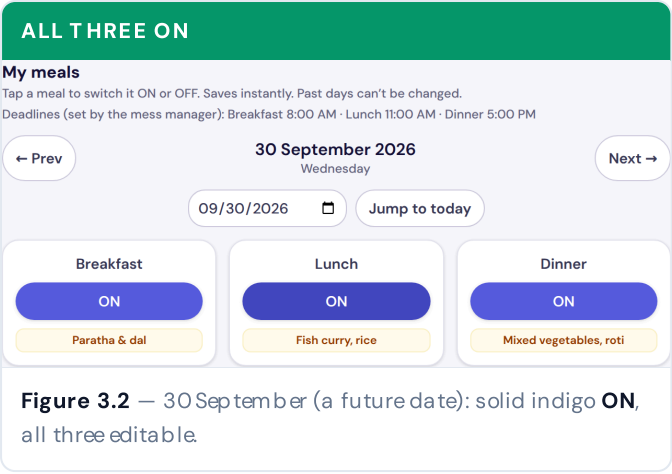
#	ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES
1	Token tile	Your Token Number, the number you sign in with. If you have no token it shows the first letter of your name instead.
2	Your name	Exactly as the mess manager typed it on the employee list. You cannot change it yourself.
3	Sign out	Ends the session on this device and erases the private dummy meal rate stored in this browser.
4	Deadline line	The three deadlines currently in force, set by the mess manager. Read-only here.
5	← Prev	Moves the meal section back one day. Past days are visible but locked.
6	Date picker	Jump straight to any date. A Jump to today button appears beside it whenever you are not on today.
7	Next →	Moves forward one day. Future days are always editable.
8	Lock notice	Explains why meals cannot be changed right now, and which deadlines have passed. Absent when everything is open.
9	Meal ON/OFF button	One per meal. Tap to switch. Saves instantly — there is no Save button anywhere on this page.
10	Dish chip	What the mess manager announced is cooking for that meal. Information only — it changes no count and no bill.
11	Month selector	The mess month whose record is shown below (5th → 5th). The ← → arrows move a whole month at a time.
12	Meals I had	How many breakfasts, lunches and dinners you have already had this month. Tap one for the list of dates.
13	My deposit	The month's total plus every individual deposit the manager recorded for you.
14	My bill	Your real bill — but only after the manager <i>publishes</i> the meal rate.
15	Bill calculator	A private "what if the rate were xX?" box. Never leaves your phone.

Everything saves by itself

Tapping a meal writes it to the database immediately. A brief ... means the save is in flight; a **red outline** means it failed and you should tap again. There is no Save button and no "unsaved changes" state to worry about.

3.2 My meals — switching a meal ON or OFF

Three cards, one per meal. The button underneath shows the current state and is the control itself.

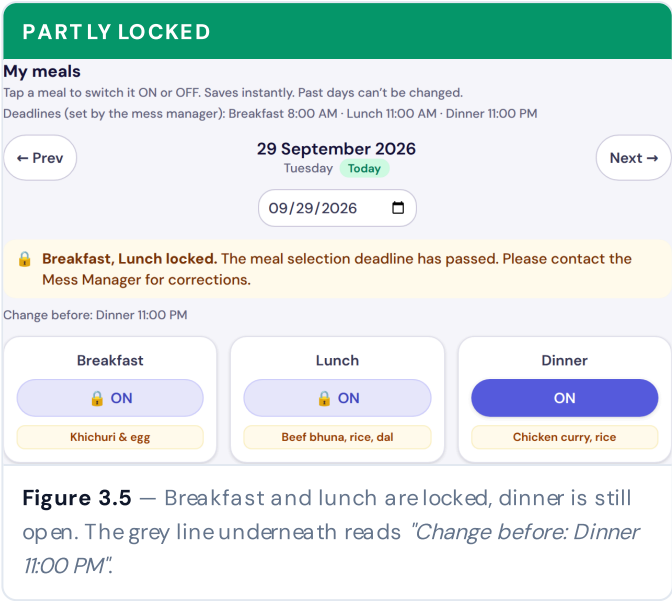
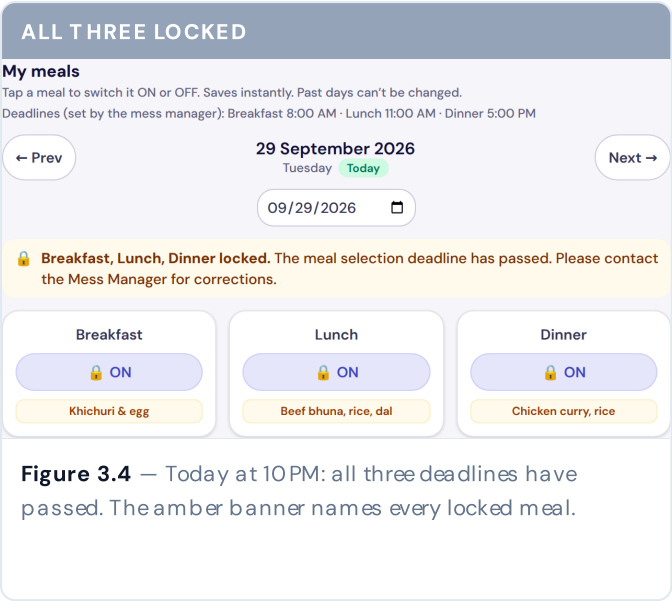


What is different?

Only the breakfast button: **solid indigo "ON"** becomes **pale grey "OFF"**. Nothing else on the page moves. The dish chip stays — the kitchen is still cooking khichuri, you have simply said you are not eating it. Your meal count for that day drops by 0.75 the moment the day passes.

3.3 Locked meals

A padlock on the button means the meal can no longer be changed from the Employee Panel. The button still shows the truth (🔒 ON or 🔒 OFF) — it just cannot be pressed.



What is different?

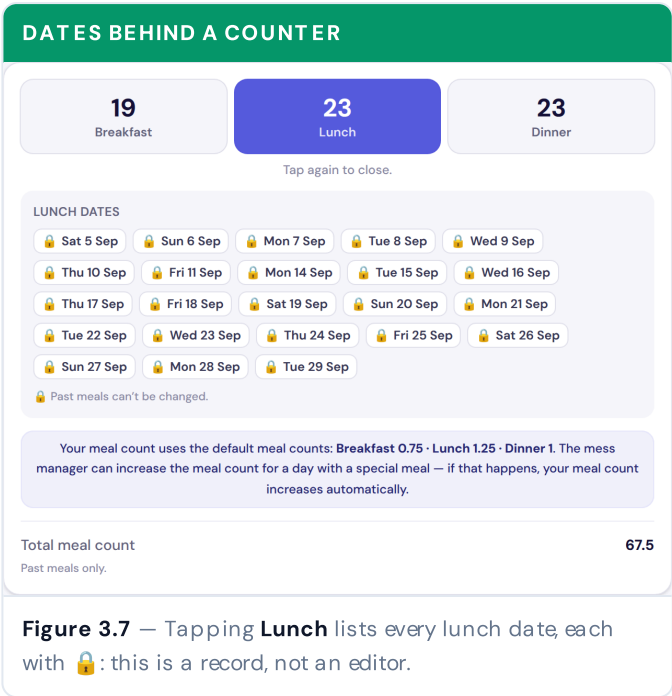
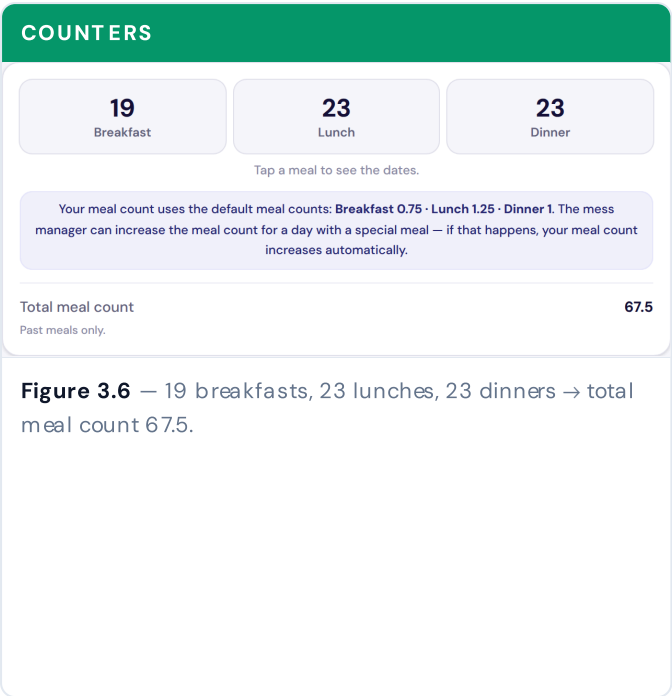
In Figure 3.5 the mess manager had moved the dinner deadline to 11:00 PM, so at 10:30 PM dinner was still open: its button is tappable and the banner lists only **Breakfast, Lunch locked**. The extra grey line "Change before: ..." appears only while at least one of today's meals is still open.

Rule — three lock states, and only three	
DATE	BREAKFAST / LUNCH / DINNER
Before today	🔒 Never editable, for any reason.
Today	✅ Editable until that meal's deadline · 🔒 from the deadline onwards.
After today	✅ Always editable (the deadline only applies once that day becomes today).

The lock clock re-checks itself every 15 seconds and whenever you return to the tab, so a meal locks on screen the moment its deadline passes — no reload needed. That clock follows the *server's* time, so a phone set to the wrong time still shows the right locks.

3.4 Meals I had

Three counters for the selected mess month, and the weighted total underneath.



"Past meals only" — why this number is smaller than your bill

Meals I had counts a meal only once it can no longer be changed (its day is over, or today's deadline has passed). Meals you have already switched ON for the days ahead do *not* count yet. Your **My bill** card and the mess manager's report count *every* meal that is ON in the month, including the upcoming ones. In Figure 3.1 that is the difference between **67.5** (past) and **74.25** (the whole month, used for the bill).

The indigo strip inside the card restates the weights in force — **Breakfast 0.75 · Lunch 1.25 · Dinner 1** — and warns that the manager may raise a day's meal count for a special meal, in which case your total rises automatically.

3.5 My deposit

Total deposit		₹6,500
26 September 2026	Cash	₹1,000
18 September 2026	bKash	₹2,500
8 September 2026	Cash	₹3,000

Figure 3.8 — Total at the top, then every deposit newest first, with the date and the manager's note (Cash, bKash, ...). Employees cannot add or edit deposits — only the mess manager records them, on the Expense Status tab.

3.6 My bill, and the private bill calculator

These two cards look similar but are completely different things.

	MY BILL	BILL CALCULATOR
Where the rate comes from	The mess manager, after pressing Publish meal rate .	Whatever you type into the box.
Which meals it counts	Every meal ON in the month.	Past meals only.
Who can see it	You and the manager — the same numbers.	Only you. The rate is stored in your own browser, under your own account, is never sent to the server, and is erased when you sign out.
Is it the real bill?	Yes.	No — it is an estimate and changes nothing.

 **The meal rate has been published**

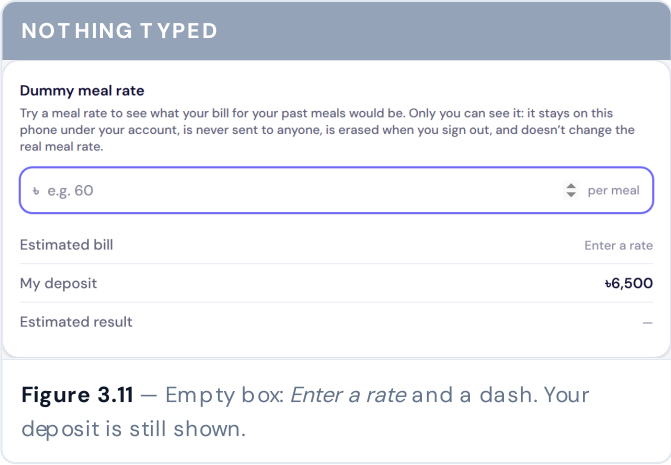
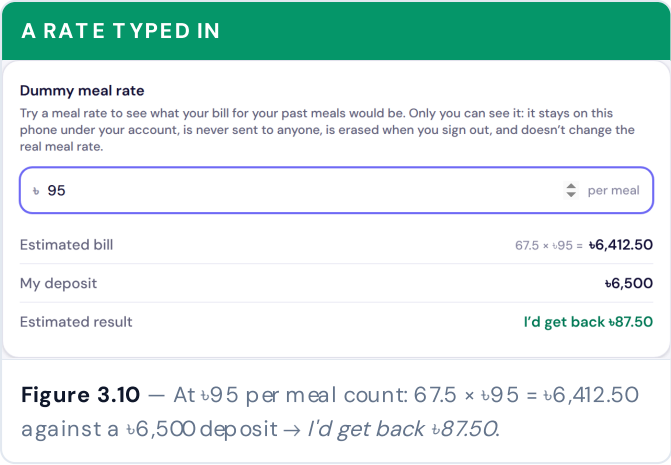
The meal rate is ₹92.50. Your total bill is ₹6,868.13 and you have paid ₹6,500. Your due is **₹368.13**.

Published 29 Sep 2026, 10:19 PM

Meal rate	₹92.50
Total bill	74.25 × ₹92.50 = ₹6,868.13
You have paid	₹6,500
Due	₹368.13

Counts every meal that's ON this month, the same as the mess manager's bill.

Figure 3.9 — **My bill** once the rate is published: the announcement line, the time it was published, then meal rate, total bill (with the multiplication shown), what you have paid, and the **Due** or **Refund** in colour.



What is different?

Only the two right-hand values. With a rate, **Estimated bill** shows the working ($67.5 \times ₹95 =$) and **Estimated result** turns green (money back) or red (money to pay). With the box empty, both fall back to placeholders. The rate you type is remembered on this phone for next time — and only for your account, so on a shared phone nobody else sees it.

3.7 The Employee Panel on a phone

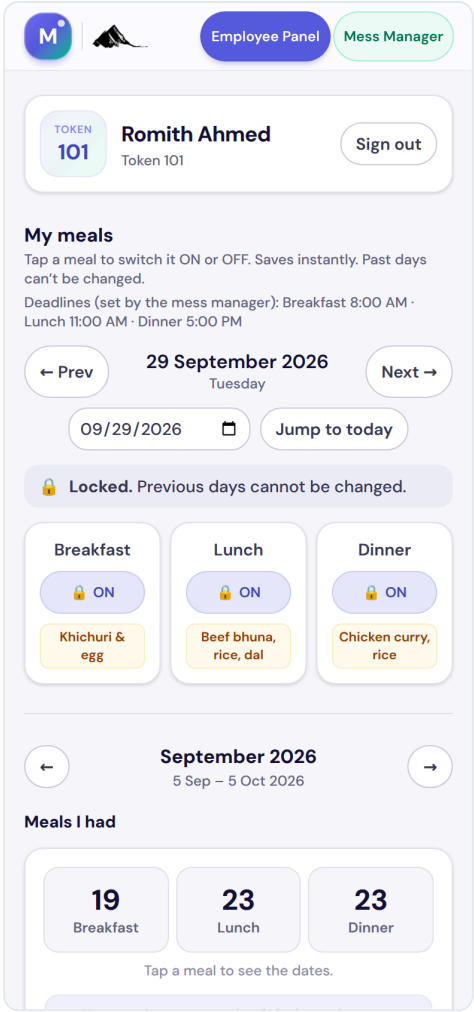


Figure 3.12 — The same page at phone width. The layout is designed for this size first: the three meal cards stay side by side and the buttons are thumb-sized.

3.8 What an employee can and cannot do

CAN	CANNOT
Switch their own meals ON/OFF for today (before the deadline) and any future date	Change anyone else's meals — the database refuses it, not just the screen
Look at any date, past or future	Change a past date, or today after the deadline
See their own meal history, deposits and published bill for any month	See another employee's deposits, bill or due
Try any rate in the private calculator	Change the real meal rate, or see a rate the manager is only testing
Read the announced dish for a date	See guest counts, guest bills or mess spending — these never appear in the Employee Panel
Change their own password by asking for a login reset	Change their own name or Token Number

4 Meal Status & Meal Selection

This section covers the single most-used feature in the application: telling the mess whether you are eating. It is deliberately tiny — three buttons — and everything interesting is in the rules around them.

4.1 The three deadlines currently in force

MEAL	DEADLINE	WHAT HAPPENS AT THAT TIME
 Breakfast	8:00 AM	Today's breakfast button locks. It keeps showing ON or OFF, but tapping does nothing.
 Lunch	11:00 AM	Today's lunch button locks.
 Dinner	5:00 PM	Today's dinner button locks.

These times are a setting, not a law of nature

8:00 / 11:00 / 17:00 are the values this office is running with, and they are what every screenshot in this manual shows. They are one office-wide setting that **any** mess manager can change at **Meal Status** →  **Employee meal deadlines** (Section 4.5). If your office has different times, the Employee Panel always prints the real ones on the line under "My meals" — trust that line, not this table.

4.2 Every state a meal button can be in

APPEARANCE	STATE	MEANING
 solid indigo	ON, editable	You are eating this meal. Tap to cancel.
 pale grey	OFF, editable	You are not eating. Tap to book it.
 pale indigo	ON, locked	You are counted for this meal and it can no longer be cancelled here.
 pale grey	OFF, locked	You are not counted and can no longer book it here.
...	Saving	The tap is being written to the database. Lasts a fraction of a second.
Red outline	Save failed	The value was rolled back. Check your connection and tap again.

4.3 The same employee, four different dates

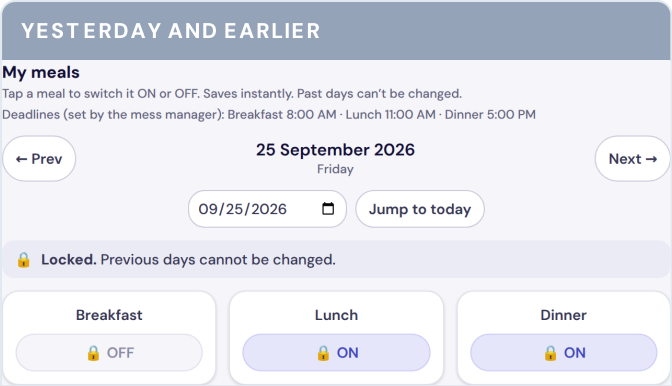


Figure 4.1 — 25 Sep tember. Grey banner: “Locked. Previous days cannot be changed.” All three buttons carry regardless of deadlines.

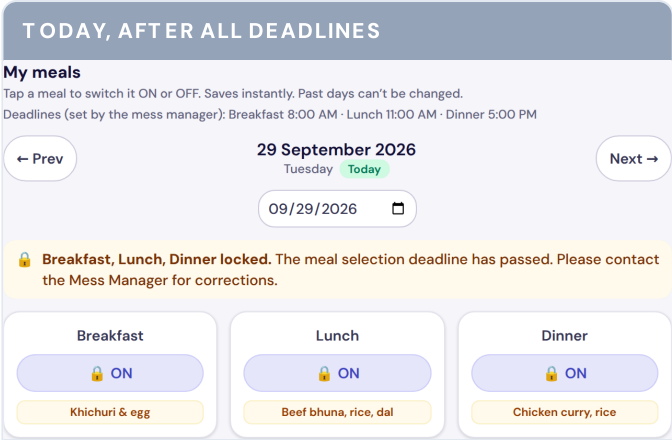


Figure 4.2 — 29 Sep tember at 10 PM. Amber banner naming all three meals, and the advice to contact the Mess Manager.

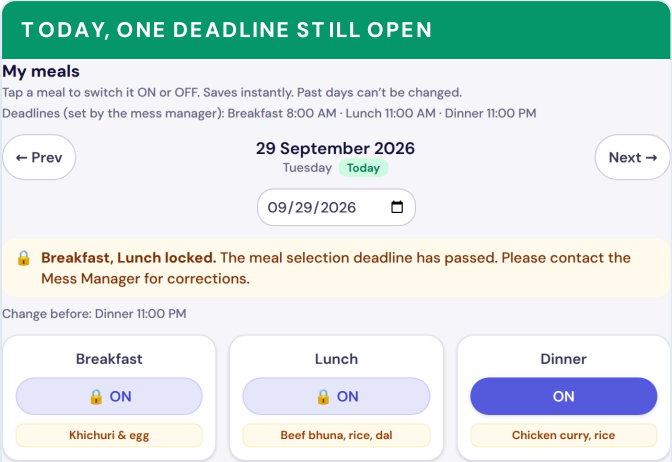


Figure 4.3 — Only the meals whose deadline has passed are named; the rest stay tappable and a “Change before: ...” line appears.

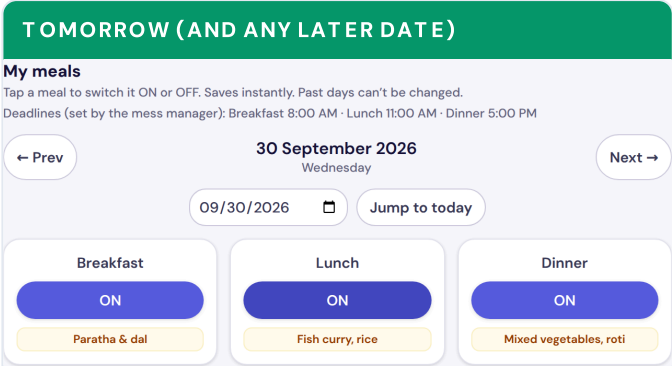


Figure 4.4 — 30 Sep tember. No banner at all: future dates are always editable, so there is nothing to explain.

What is different across the four?

The banner and the padlocks — nothing else. The buttons always show the true ON/OFF value; the date never changes what you are counted for, only whether you may still change it. A past date gets a grey “previous days” banner, today gets an amber “deadline passed” banner listing exactly which meals are affected, and a future date gets no banner.

4.4 When there is no data for a date

A date on which you have never touched anything has no record in the database at all. The panel does not show an error or an empty box — it simply shows all three meals OFF, because that is what “no record” means.



Figure 4.5 — 12 September: on leave. All three OFF and locked. Your meal count for this day is 0.



Figure 4.6 — 20 October: no record exists. All three OFF, all three editable, no dish announced so no amber chips.

What is different?

The buttons are identical in wording — the only difference is the padlocks, and the amber dish chips that appear in Figure 4.5 (the manager had announced a menu for that date) but not in Figure 4.6 (nothing announced). Read the padlocks, not the words.

4.5 Who changes the deadlines — and how

The deadlines live on the mess manager's **Meal Status** tab, in a collapsed strip at the top. Any mess manager can open it; the change applies office-wide and takes effect on every employee's next page load.

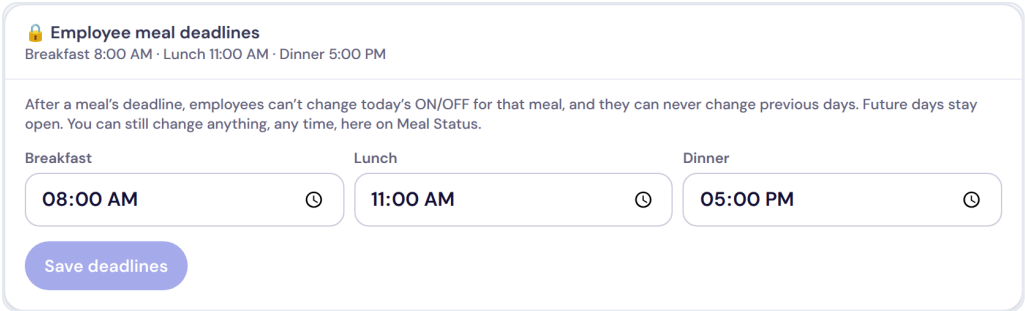


Figure 4.7 — **Meal Status** → **Employee meal deadlines**, expanded. Three time fields and one **Save deadlines** button. The paragraph above them restates the rule; note the last sentence: "You can still change anything, any time, here on Meal Status."

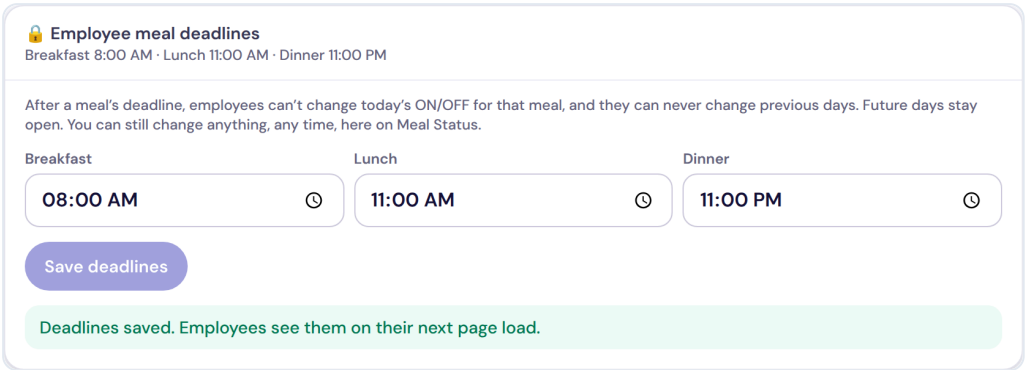


Figure 4.8 — After saving: "Deadlines saved. Employees see them on their next page load." The summary line in the collapsed header updates immediately.

4.6 What happens after a deadline — exactly

1. **On screen:** within 15 seconds the button grows a padlock and stops responding. No reload needed.

2. **In the database:** any attempt to write that meal is rejected with `MEAL_LOCKED` — including an attempt made outside the application, from a script or a modified request.
3. **Your count:** the meal immediately joins **Meals I had** and your total meal count, because it can no longer change.
4. **The cook:** the plate count on the meal board is final for that meal.
5. **The fix, if you need one:** ask the mess manager. A manager is not bound by the deadlines and can correct any meal of their own running period (Section 8.4).

Warning — the deadline is not a reminder, it is a wall

There is no grace period, no "request a change" button and no appeal inside the application. If you miss the lunch deadline and leave the office, you are billed for that lunch unless a mess manager removes it for you. Set your meals for the whole week in advance — future dates are always open.

5 Monthly View — Dates, Months and Totals

There is no calendar grid in this application

Meal Tracker deliberately has no month-grid calendar. Navigation is done with two separate controls that do two different jobs: a **day navigator** for the meal buttons, and a **month navigator** for your record and your money. Learning which is which takes about ten seconds and removes most of the confusion new users have.

5.1 The day navigator — which day's meals am I editing?

It sits directly under the "My meals" heading and controls **only** the three meal buttons.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
← Prev / Next →	One day back or forward.
The date itself	Shows the full date and weekday. A green Today badge appears when you are on today.
Date box	Opens the device's date picker — the fastest way to jump a long way.
Jump to today	Appears only when you are <i>not</i> on today. One tap returns you.

The same day navigator is used on the mess manager's **Meal Status** and **Guest** tabs, where it selects which date's sheet you are editing.

5.2 The month navigator — which month's record am I reading?

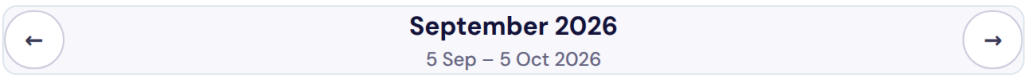


Figure 5.1 — The month navigator: the mess month's name and, underneath, the exact dates it spans — *5 Sep – 5 Oct 2026*. The ← → buttons move a whole mess month at a time and leave the day navigator above untouched.

Rule — a mess month is not a calendar month

September 2026 means **5 September lunch through 5 October breakfast**. So 1–4 October belongs to September's record, and 1–4 September belongs to August's. When a date near the 5th looks "missing", you are almost always looking at the neighbouring mess month.

5.3 How to read your month, top to bottom

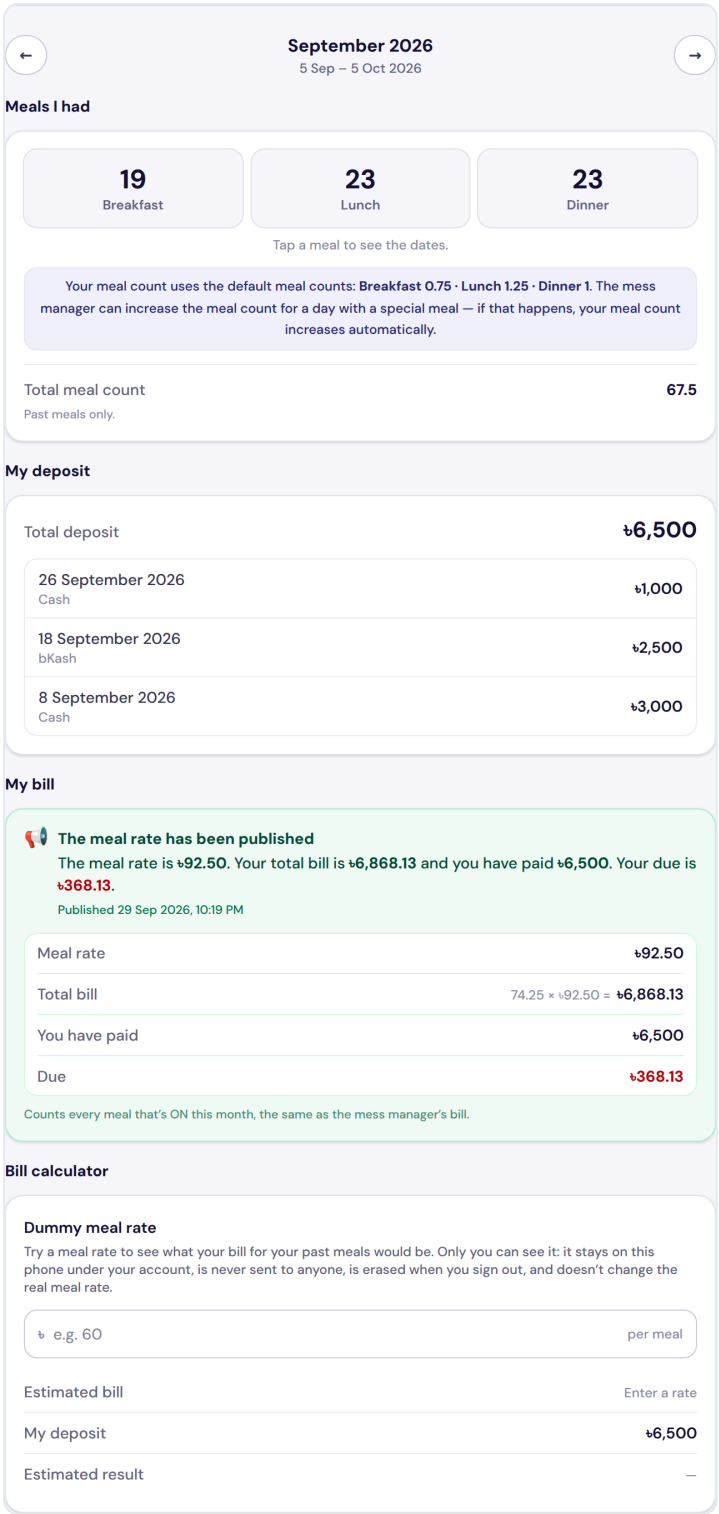
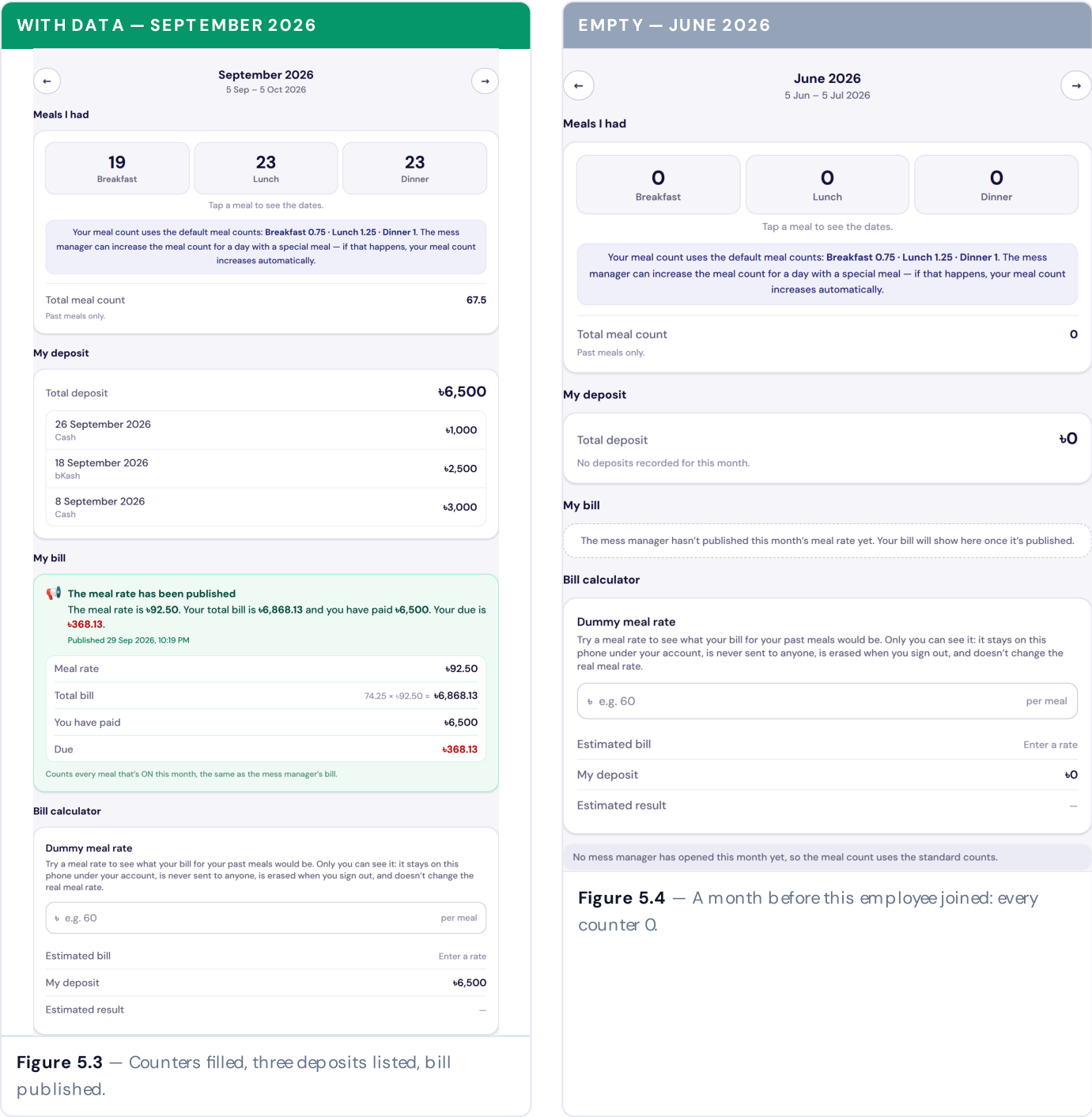


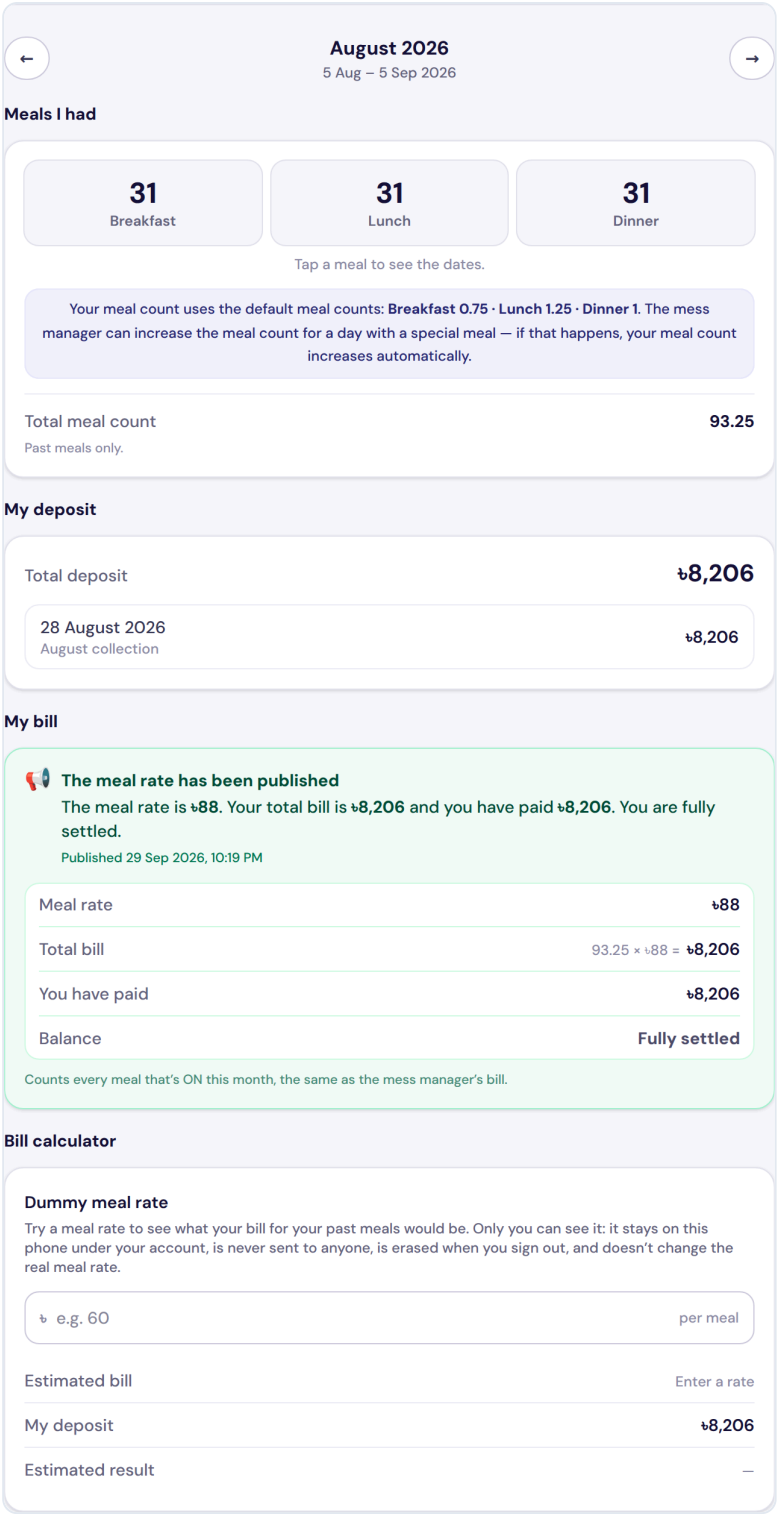
Figure 5.2 — One complete mess month for one employee: counters, deposits, published bill and calculator. This is the whole of an employee's record.

- 1. **Check the month name first.** Everything below it belongs to that month and nothing else.
- 2. **Read the three counters** — breakfasts, lunches, dinners you have *already had*.
- 3. **Tap a counter** if a number looks wrong: you get the exact dates, so you can see which day is in dispute.
- 4. **Read "Total meal count"** — the weighted figure your bill is built from ($19 \times 0.75 + 23 \times 1.25 + 23 \times 1.00 = 67.5$ in Figure 5.2).
- 5. **Read "My deposit"** — every payment the manager has recorded for this month.

6. Read "My bill" — the real numbers, once published.

5.4 A populated month, an empty month, and the handover month





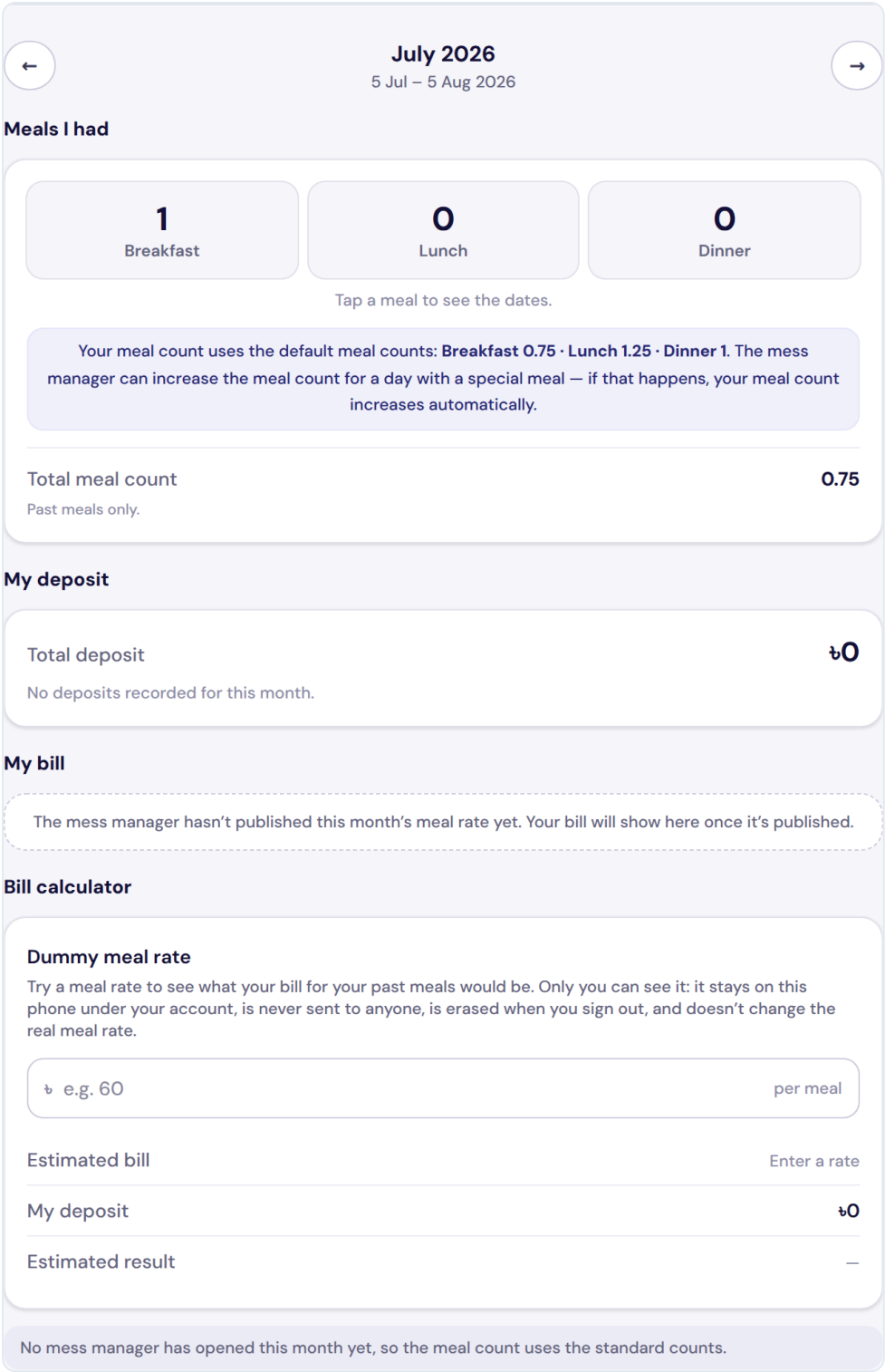


Figure 5.6 — July 2026 for the same employee: a single breakfast, total meal count **0.75**. That is not a bug — July's mess month ends with **5 August breakfast**, and this employee ate breakfast on 5 August. This is the 5th-of-the-month handover seen from the employee's side.

5.5 Why the month total can differ from your bill

NUMBER	COUNT S	WHERE IT APPEARS
Total meal count (Meals I had)	Past meals only	Employee Panel — the counters card, and the bill calculator
Meal count (bill)	Every meal ON in the month, including meals booked for days still to come	Employee Panel — My bill ; Manager — Expense Status, Report, Dashboard

Late in a month the two converge; mid-month they differ by whatever you have booked ahead. Both are correct — they answer different questions ("what have I eaten?" and "what am I on the hook for?").

6 The Mess Manager Panel

The Mess Manager Panel (</admin>) has seven tabs. One account runs one mess month; the whole month's team of about five people shares that one login.

6.1 Layout and navigation

PART OF THE SCREEN	WHAT IT IS
Left sidebar (desktop)	The seven tabs. The current one is highlighted grey.
Scrolling tab row (phone)	The same seven tabs in one horizontal strip, with Sign out as the last item.
Account footer	Pinned to the bottom of the sidebar: the account name (September2026) and the period it owns (<i>5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast</i>). Always check this before you start typing — it tells you which month you are editing.
Top-right buttons	Switch to the Employee Panel or back. Present on every page of the site.

TAB	ADDRESS	WHAT IT IS FOR	DETAILED IN
Dashboard	/admin	The period's status badge and nine month figures.	Section 11
Meal Status	/admin/meals	One date at a time: dish announcement, that date's meal counts, and every employee's ON/OFF.	Sections 6.4, 8
Guest	/admin/guests	Guests per date and the month's guest bill to collect from the office.	Section 10
Expense Status	/admin/expenses	Deposits, the meal rate, and who owes what.	Section 9
Spend	/admin/spending	What the mess spent — bazar, gas, extras.	Section 6.5
Report	/admin/reports	The final month-end table, filterable, with CSV export.	Section 6.6
Employees	/admin/employees	The shared employee list, tokens and logins.	Section 7

6.2 The manager period — the one concept to understand first

Your account owns a **manager period**: a run of meals from the 5th's lunch to the next 5th's breakfast. The period decides three things and nothing else:

1. **Which meals count towards your month's totals and bills.**
2. **Which employees' meals you may switch ON/OFF** — and only while the period is running.
3. **Which dates you may set meal counts, guests and spending for.**

Its state is shown as a badge on the Dashboard and repeated as a notice on Meal Status.

BADGE	MEANS	CAN YOU CHANGE EMPLOYEES' MEALS?
Active Manager Period	Today falls inside your period.	Yes — any meal of your period, at any time, ignoring the employee deadlines.
Manager Period Not Started	Your month has not begun yet.	No — but meal counts, guests, deposits and spending for your month are already open.
Manager Period Completed	Your month is over.	No — everything else about your month stays open to you forever.

ACTIVE — SEPTEMBER 2026

CURRENT MANAGER PERIOD

5 September 2026 Lunch → 5 October 2026 Breakfast

You can change employees' meal status for these meals until 5 October 2026, 11:59 PM.

Active Manager Period

Figure 6.1 — "You can change employees' meal status for these meals until 5 October 2026, 11:59 PM."

COMPLETED — AUGUST 2026

YOUR MANAGER PERIOD

5 August 2026 Lunch → 5 September 2026 Breakfast

Employee meal-status updates are now handled by the September 2026 manager. Everything else about your month stays open to you.

Manager Period Completed

Figure 6.2 — The heading changes from "Current manager period" to "Your manager period".

YOUR MANAGER PERIOD

5 October 2026 Lunch → 5 November 2026 Breakfast

You can change employees' meal status from 5 October 2026. Until then, the September 2026 manager handles it.

Manager Period Not Started

Figure 6.3 — Manager Period Not Started, October 2026: "You can change employees' meal status from 5 October 2026. Until then, the September 2026 manager handles it."

MEAL STATUS — PERIOD COMPLETED

🔒 Your manager period has ended.

Your management period was: 5 August 2026 Lunch → 5 September 2026 Breakfast.

Employee meal-status updates are now handled by the September 2026 manager.

You can still access your previous period's meal records, calculations, cash collection, reports, and other historical information.

Figure 6.4 — The full hand-over notice, naming your period, who is in charge now, and everything you keep.

MEAL STATUS — PERIOD NOT STARTED

🕒 Your manager period hasn't started yet.

Your management period: 5 October 2026 Lunch → 5 November 2026 Breakfast.

Until 5 October 2026, employee meal-status updates are handled by the September 2026 manager. Your month's meal counts, guests, deposits and spending are already open.

Figure 6.5 — The amber equivalent, with the date your period opens.

A finished month loses exactly one power

When a period ends, nothing is locked away and nothing is deleted. The outgoing manager keeps their meal records (read-only), meal counts, deposits, dues, meal rate (test and publish), guests, spending, report, CSV export and every calculation — forever. The **only** thing that stops is switching employees' meals ON and OFF.

6.3 The Dashboard at a glance

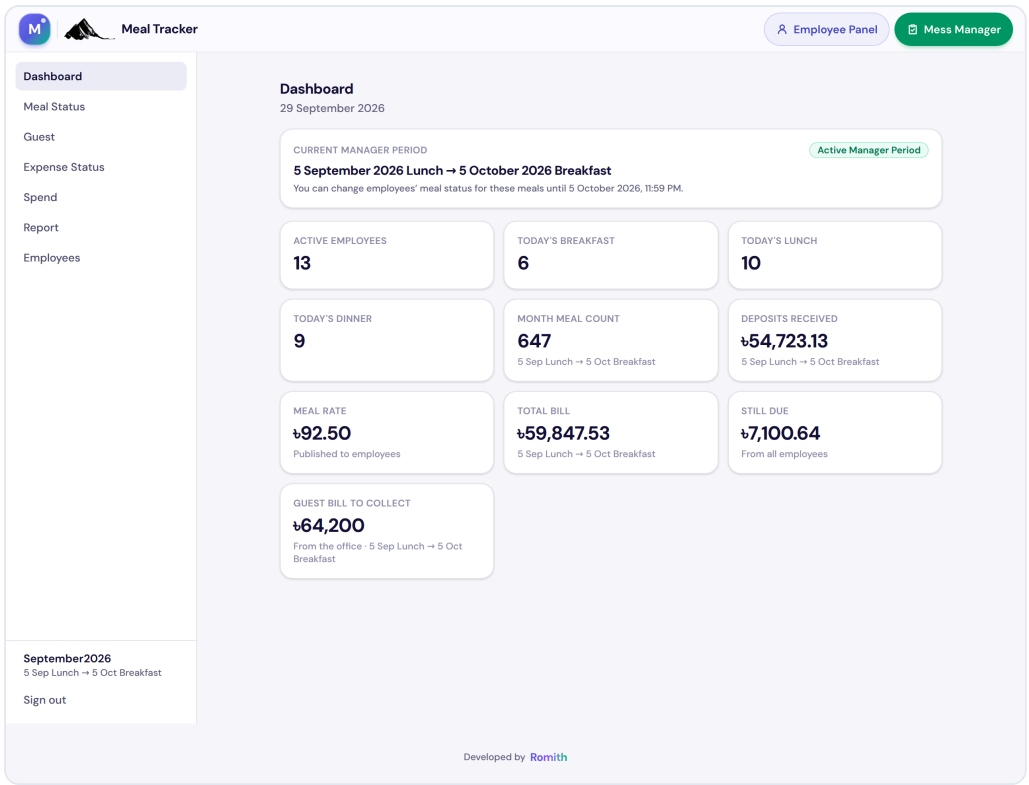


Figure 6.6 — The Dashboard for September 2026 on 29 September. Every card is explained one by one in Section 11.

6.4 Meal Status — the per-date sheet

This is where a manager spends most of their time. One date at a time, top to bottom: deadlines, date picker, what's cooking, that date's meal counts, and the employee sheet.

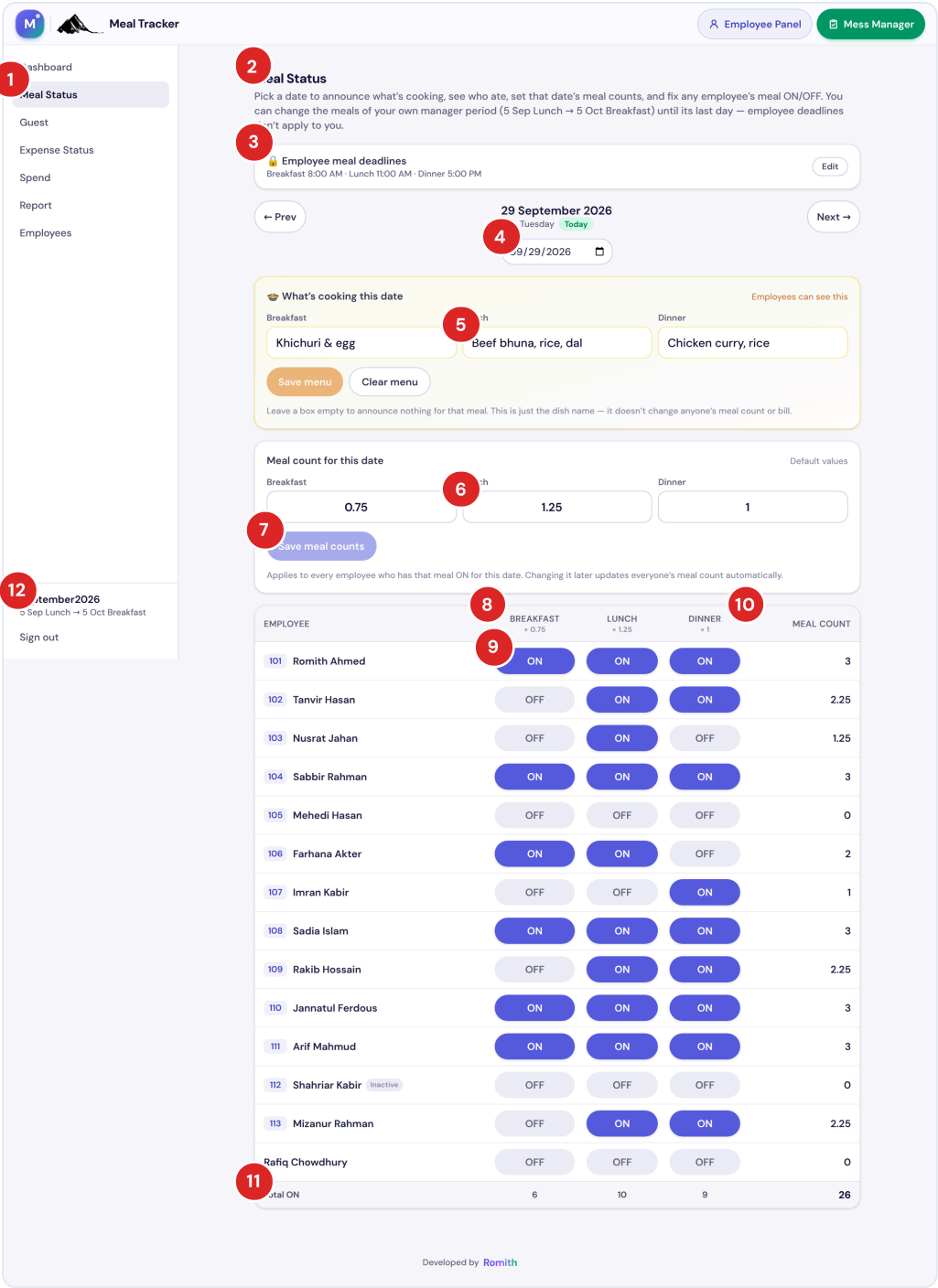


Figure 6.7 — The complete Meal Status tab for 29 September 2026.

#	ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES
1	Tab list	The seven tabs; the current one is highlighted.
2	Page title and blurb	Restates your period and reminds you that employee deadlines do not apply to you.
3	🔒 Employee meal deadlines	Collapsed strip showing the three deadlines in force. Press Edit to change them office-wide.
4	Day navigator	Prev / Next / date picker / Jump to today. Everything below follows this date.
5	🍲 What's cooking this date	Three free-text boxes (max 80 characters). Employees see each dish under that meal. Save menu stores it; Clear menu removes all three.

6	Meal count for this date	The weights used for this date only, 0–10 with two decimals. Defaults 0.75 / 1.25 / 1.00.
7	Save meal counts	Enabled only when a value has actually changed. A Reset to 0.75 / 1.25 / 1 button appears whenever the date is not on the defaults.
8	Column header	The meal, and under it the weight in force (× 1.25) or Not yours on a handover day.
9	ON / OFF button	Same control as the employee's, without the deadline. Saves instantly.
10	Meal count column	That employee's weighted count for this one date, recalculated live as you tap.
11	Total ON row	How many people have each meal ON, and the date's total meal count.
12	Account footer	Which month you are signed in as, and its period.

WHAT'S COOKING — FILLED

What's cooking this date

Employees can see this

Breakfast

Khichuri & egg

Lunch

Beef bhuna, rice, dal

Dinner

Chicken curry, rice

Save menu

Clear menu

Leave a box empty to announce nothing for that meal. This is just the dish name — it doesn't change anyone's meal count or bill.

Figure 6.8 — Three dishes announced. The corner reads "Employees can see this" and a **Clear menu** button appears.

MEAL COUNTS — DEFAULT

Meal count for this date

Default values

Breakfast

0.75

Lunch

1.25

Dinner

1

Save meal counts

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

Figure 6.9 — Corner reads "Default values"; **Save meal counts** is greyed out because nothing has changed.

Meal count for this date

Custom for this date

Breakfast

0.75

Lunch

1.25

Dinner

2

Save meal counts

Reset to 0.75 / 1.25 / 1

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

Figure 6.10 — 16 September: dinner was a biryani night, so its count was raised to **2**. The corner now reads "Custom for this date" and a **Reset to 0.75 / 1.25 / 1** button has appeared. Everyone who had dinner on 16 September was re-priced the instant this was saved.

6.5 Spend — what the mess actually cost

The Spend tab is the mess's cash book for the month: bazar runs, gas, extras. It never touches an employee's bill — it is the evidence behind the meal rate you choose.

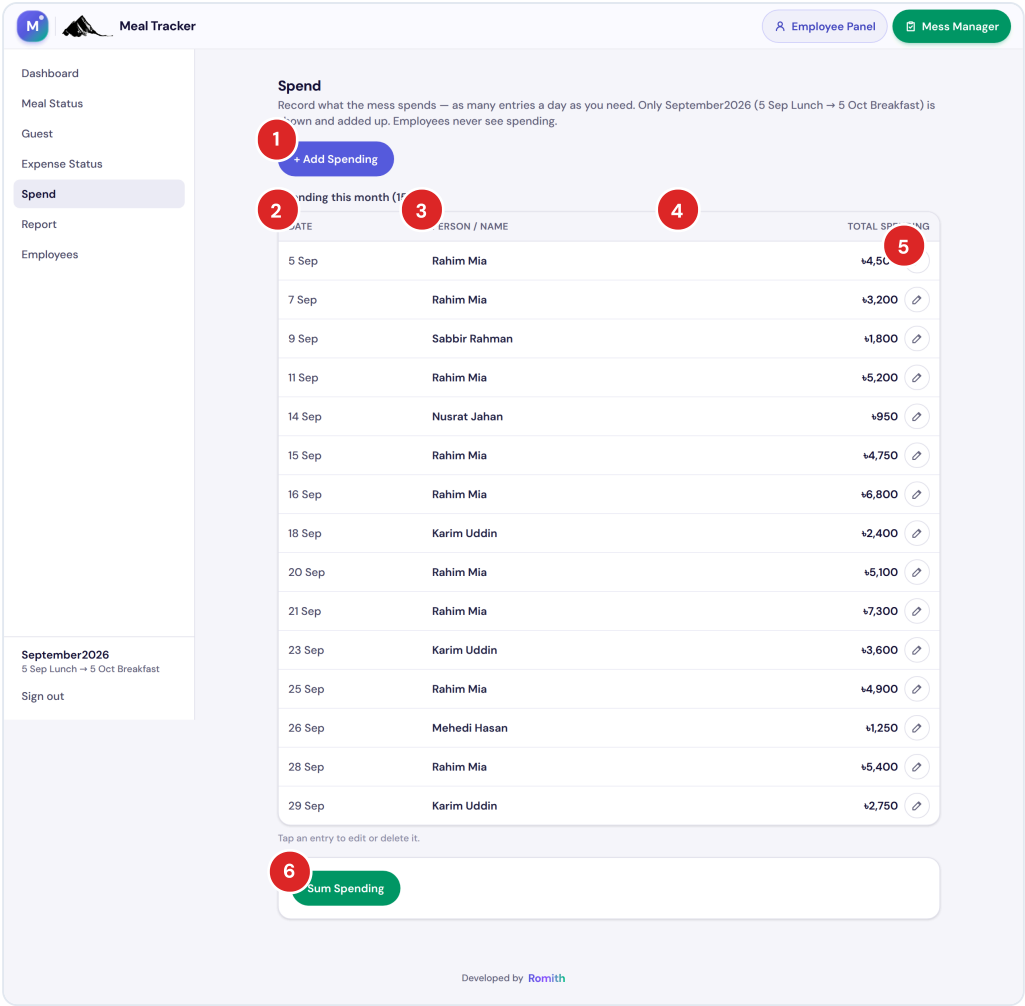


Figure 6.11 — The Spend tab with 15 entries for September 2026.

#	ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES
1	+ Add Spending	Opens the entry dialog. Any number of entries per date.
2	Date	Oldest first; entries on the same date keep the order they were added.
3	Person / Name	Who spent it, 1–80 characters. Free text; names already used this month are suggested while typing.
4	Total Spending	The amount, more than ₹0.
5	Pencil	Opens the same dialog in edit mode. Tapping anywhere on the row does the same.
6	Sum Spending	Asks the database to add up every entry of the month and shows TOTAL MONTHLY SPENDING .

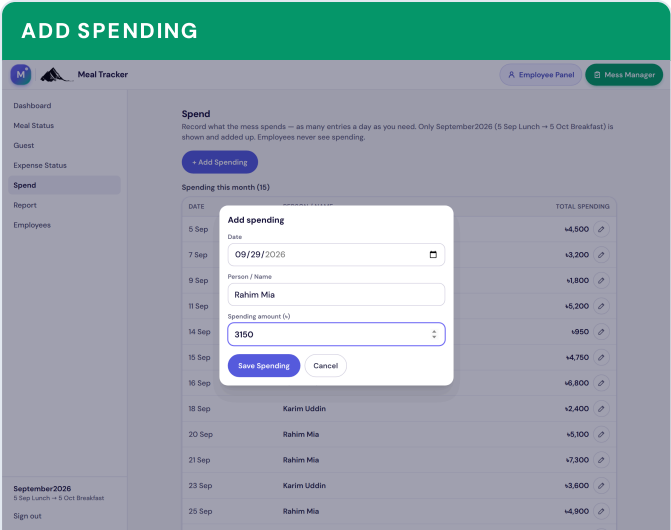


Figure 6.12 — Date, Person/Name, amount. The date box is limited to the mess month.

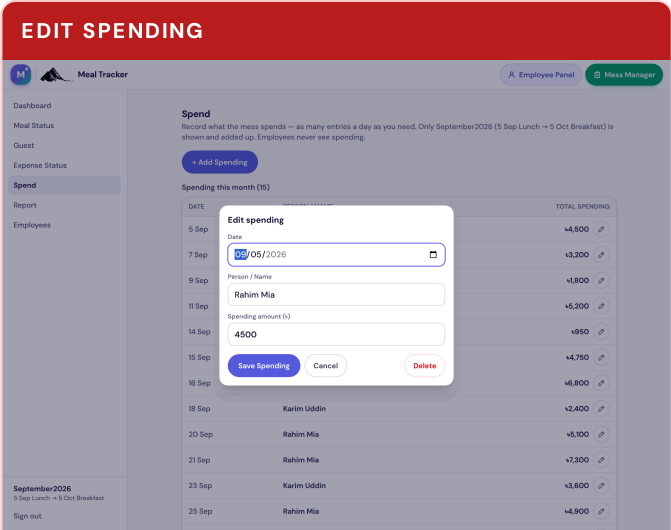


Figure 6.13 — The same dialog opened on an existing entry: the title changes to **Edit spending** and a red **Delete** button appears on the right.

What is different?

The heading (**Add spending** → **Edit spending**), the pre-filled values, and the extra **Delete** button. Deleting asks for confirmation and names the entry in full ("Delete 4,500 spent by Rahim Mia on 5 September 2026?"). Escape, **Cancel** or a tap outside closes the dialog without saving.

Sum Spending

TOTAL MONTHLY SPENDING:

₹59,900

15 entries · September2026 (5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast)

Figure 6.14 — **Sum Spending** pressed: **TOTAL MONTHLY SPENDING ₹59,900**, with *15 entries · September2026 (5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast)* underneath. The total is computed in the database, not in the browser, and recalculates automatically if you add or edit an entry while it is on screen.

Rules for spending entries

- The date must be **inside your mess month**. Both 5ths count, so a payment made on the 5th can be recorded by either month — but never by both.
- You can change an entry's date, name and amount, but you can never move it to another month.
- There are no blank rows: a date with no spending simply does not appear.
- **Employees never see spending**. It exists only on this tab.

6.6 Report — the month-end table

The Report tab is the Expense Status table in its final, printable form: one row per employee, with the breakfast/lunch/dinner breakdown added and an **Export CSV** button.

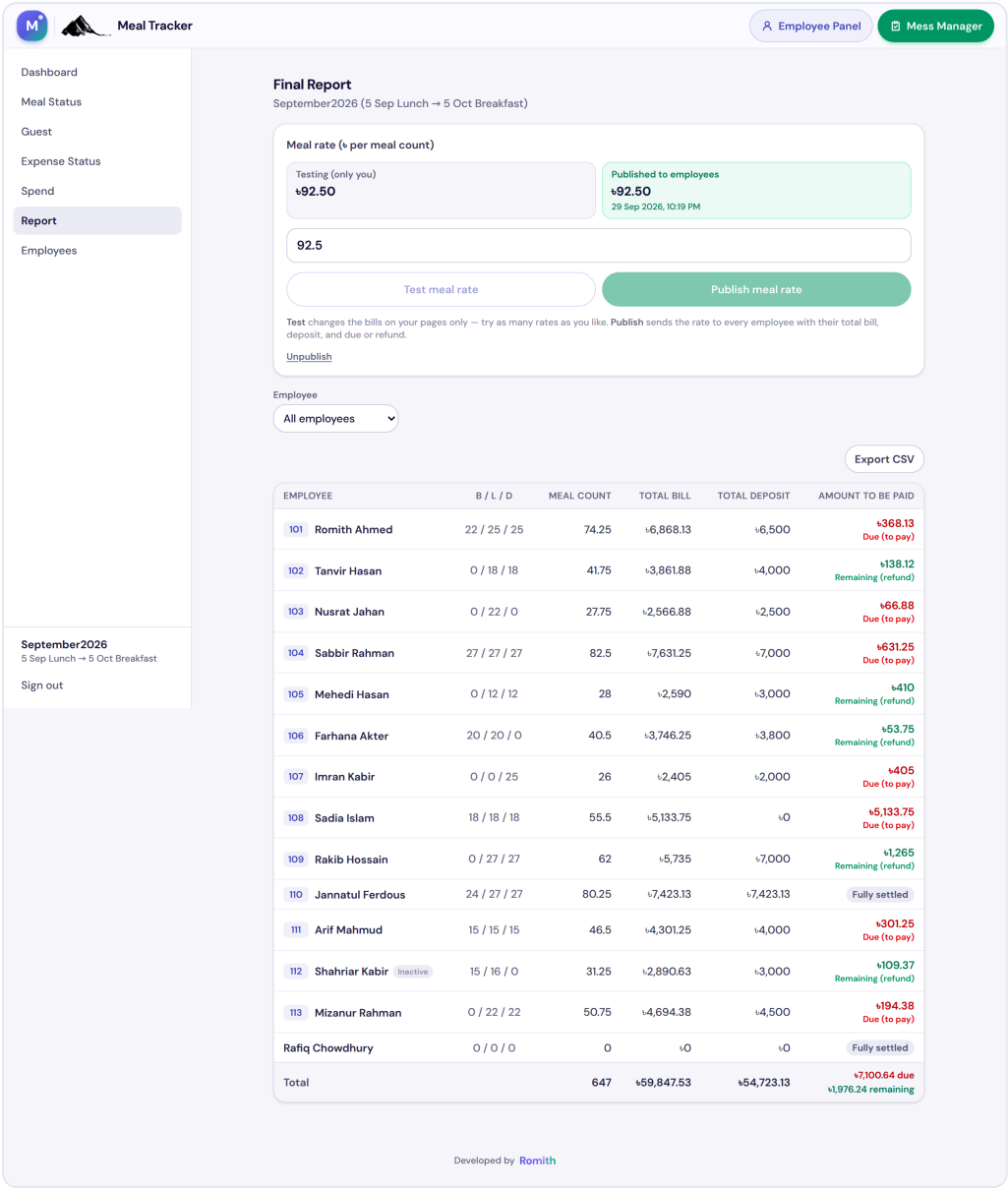


Figure 6.15 — Final Report for September2026. The meal rate card is repeated here so the rate can be adjusted and the effect seen without changing tabs.

COLUMN	WHAT IT CONTAINS
Employee	Token badge and name. Inactive employees are listed with a grey Inactive tag — they stay in the report for any month in which they ate or deposited.
B / L / D	How many breakfasts, lunches and dinners — plain counts, not weighted.
Meal Count	The weighted total: $\Sigma (\text{meal ON} \times \text{that date's weight})$.
Total Bill	Meal Count $\times$ meal rate. A dash until a rate is set.
Total Deposit	Everything recorded for that employee in this month.
Amount to be Paid	Deposit – bill, spelled out as Due (to pay) , Remaining (refund) or Fully settled — never a bare negative number.

ALL EMPLOYEES					
EMPLOYEE	B / L / D	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	22 / 25 / 25	74.25	₹6,868.13	₹6,500	₹368.13 Due (to pay)
102 Tanvir Hasan	0 / 18 / 18	41.75	₹3,861.88	₹4,000	₹138.12 Remaining (refund)
103 Nusrat Jahan	0 / 22 / 0	27.75	₹2,566.88	₹2,500	₹66.88 Due (to pay)
104 Sabbir Rahman	27 / 27 / 27	82.5	₹7,631.25	₹7,000	₹631.25 Due (to pay)
105 Mehedi Hasan	0 / 12 / 12	28	₹2,590	₹3,000	₹410 Remaining (refund)
106 Farhana Akter	20 / 20 / 0	40.5	₹3,746.25	₹3,800	₹53.75 Remaining (refund)
107 Imran Kabir	0 / 0 / 25	26	₹2,405	₹2,000	₹405 Due (to pay)
108 Sadia Islam	18 / 18 / 18	55.5	₹5,133.75	₹0	₹5,133.75 Due (to pay)
109 Rakib Hossain	0 / 27 / 27	62	₹5,735	₹7,000	₹1,265 Remaining (refund)
110 Jannatul Ferdous	24 / 27 / 27	80.25	₹7,423.13	₹7,423.13	Fully settled
111 Arif Mahmud	15 / 15 / 15	46.5	₹4,301.25	₹4,000	₹301.25 Due (to pay)
112 Shahriar Kabir Inactive	15 / 16 / 0	31.25	₹2,890.63	₹3,000	₹109.37 Remaining (refund)
113 Mizanur Rahman	0 / 22 / 22	50.75	₹4,694.38	₹4,500	₹194.38 Due (to pay)
Rafiq Chowdhury	0 / 0 / 0	0	₹0	₹0	Fully settled
Total		647	₹59,847.53	₹54,723.13	₹7,100.64 due ₹1,976.24 remaining

Figure 6.16 — The footer row totals meal count, bill and deposits, then splits the balance into total due and total remaining.

Meal Tracker

Dashboard

Meal Status

Guest

Expense Status

Spend

Report

Employees

Final Report

September 2026 (5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast)

Meal rate (₹ per meal count)

Testing (only you)
₹92.50

Published to employees
₹92.50
28 Sep 2026, 10:19 PM

92.5

Test meal rate

Publish meal rate

Test changes the bills on your pages only — try as many rates as you like. Publish sends the rate to every employee with their total bill, deposit, and due or refund.

Unpublish

Employee

108 - Sadia Islam

Export CSV

EMPLOYEE	B / L / D	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
108 Sadia Islam	18 / 18 / 18	55.5	₹5,133.75	₹0	₹5,133.75 Due (to pay)
Total		55.5	₹5,133.75	₹0	₹5,133.75 due ₹0 remaining

September 2026

5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast

Sign out

Developed by Romith

Figure 6.17 — The **Employee** dropdown narrows the table to one person — useful when someone queries their bill at the counter.

What is different?

Only the rows shown. The filter runs in the browser on data the page already has, so it is instant and does not re-query the database; the choice is remembered in the address bar (`?employee=...`) so the filtered view can be bookmarked or shared with a colleague who is also signed in as this month.

Export CSV

Export CSV downloads the full (unfiltered) table as `mess-report-September2026.csv` — one row per employee, eleven columns, ready to open in Excel, Google Sheets or Numbers.

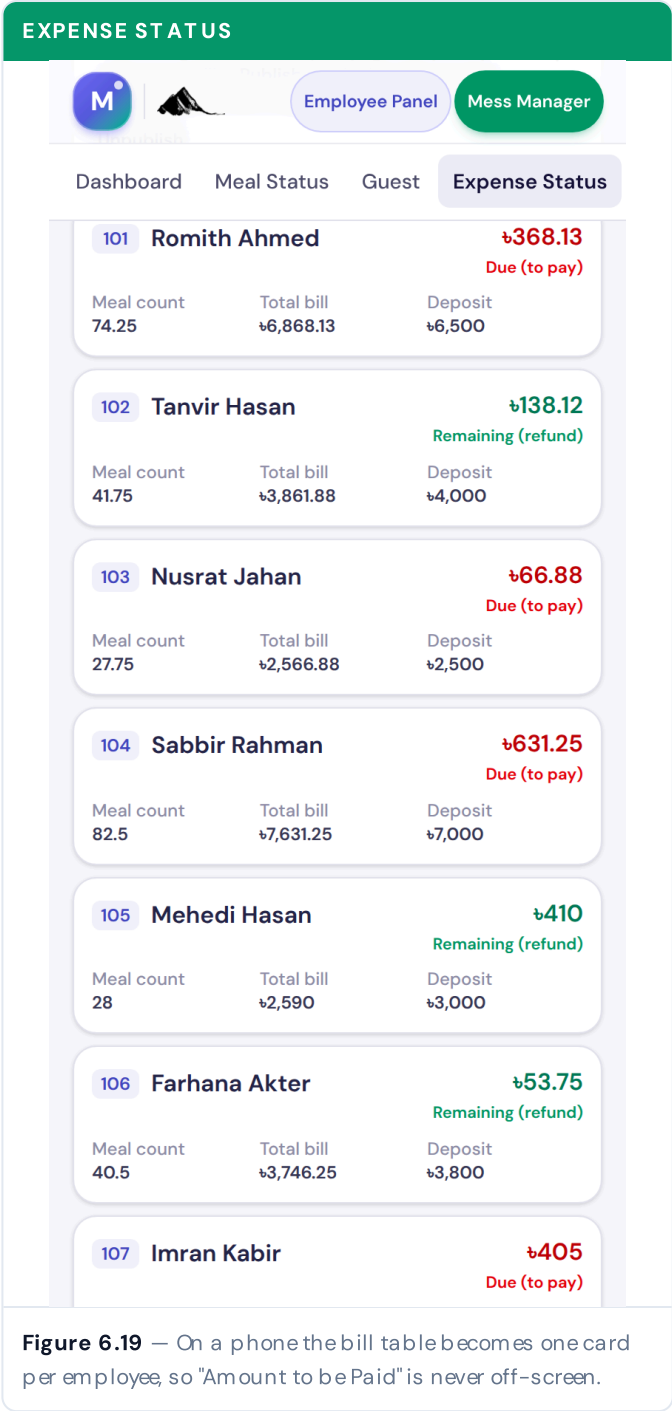
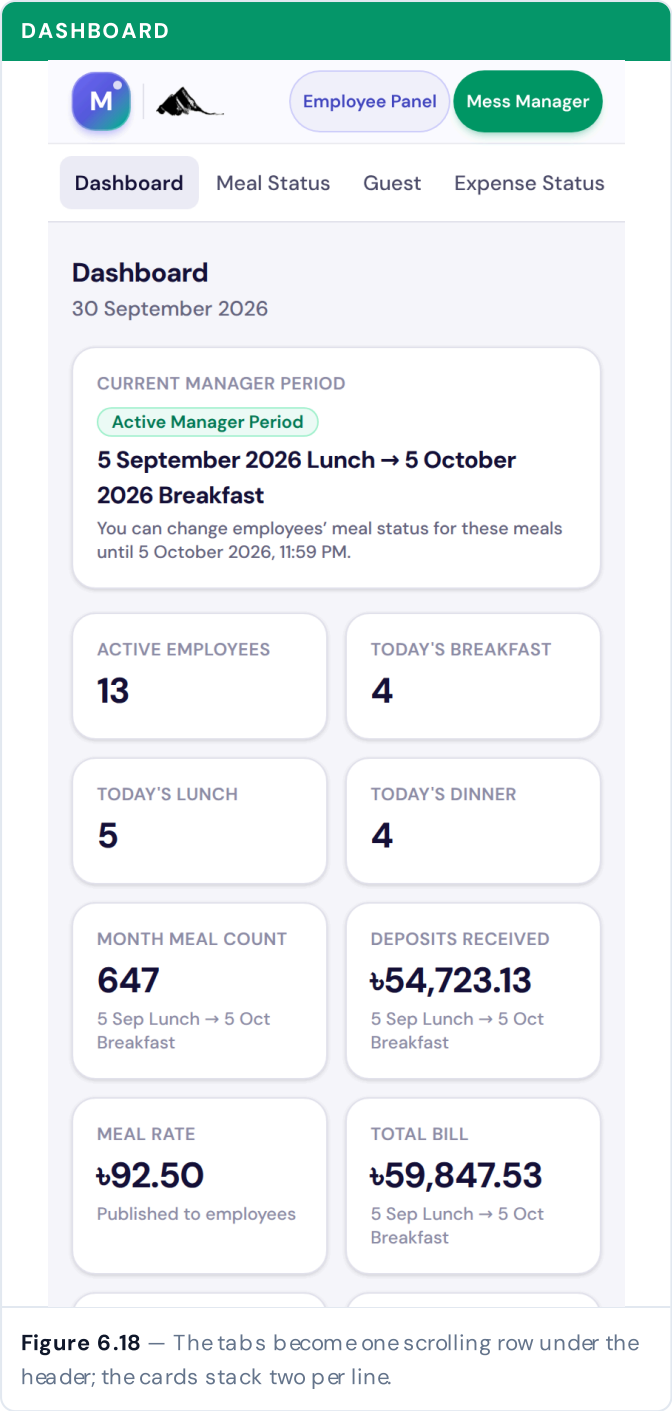
COLUMN ORDER IN THE FILE

Token, Employee, Breakfasts, Lunches, Dinners, Meal Count, Meal Rate, Total Bill, Total Deposit, Amount to be Paid, Status

```
Token,Employee,Breakfasts,Lunches,Dinners,Meal Count,Meal Rate>Total Bill>Total Deposit,Amount to be Paid>Status
101,Romith Ahmed,22,25,25,74.25,92.50,6868.13,6500.00,368.13,368.13 due
102,Tanvir Hasan,0,18,18,41.75,92.50,3861.88,4000.00,-138.12,138.12 remaining (refund)
108,Sadia Islam,18,18,18,55.50,92.50,5133.75,0.00,5133.75,5133.75 due
```

Three real lines from the exported file. In the CSV, **Amount to be Paid** is a plain number: positive means the employee owes, negative means a refund. The **Status** column spells the same thing out in words.

6.7 The panel on a phone



7 Employee Management

The **Employees** tab holds the office employee list. Unlike every other manager tab, this list is **shared by every month** — August, September and October all see and edit the same people. A name added in September is there in October.

7.1 The employee list

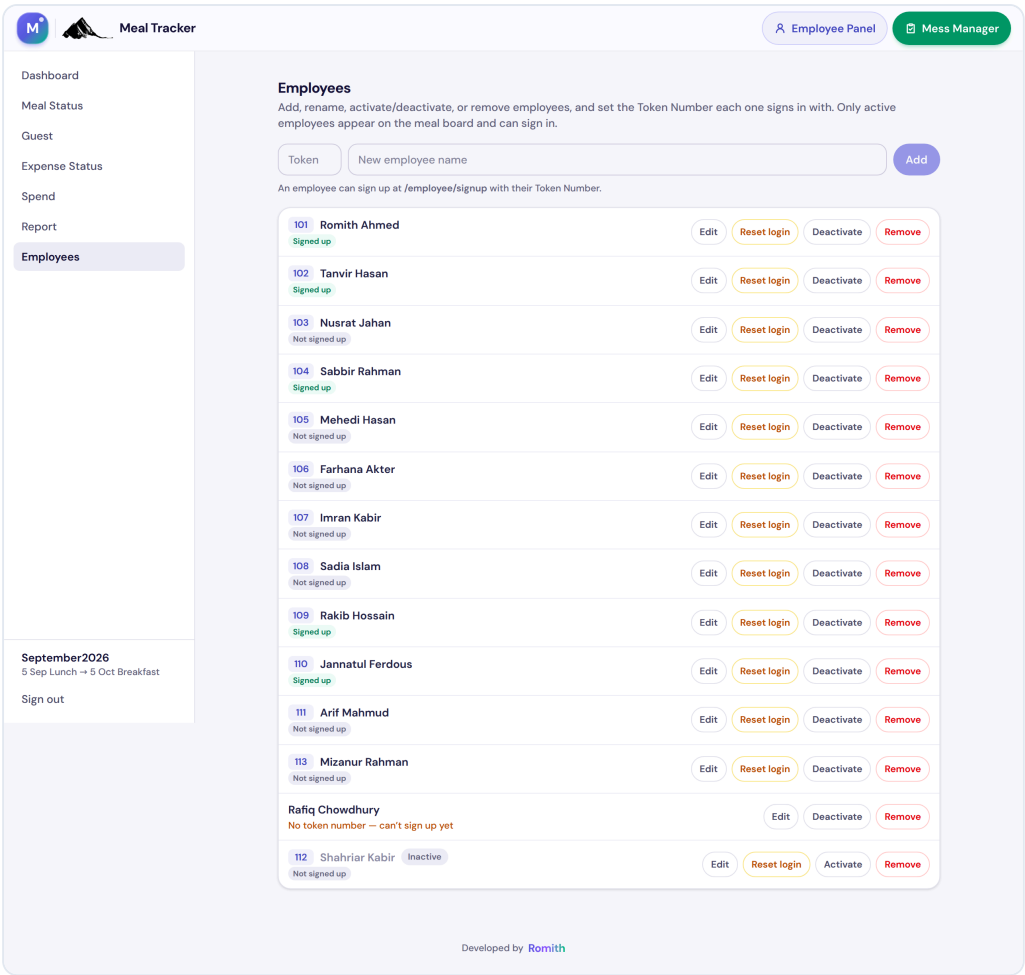


Figure 7.1 — The Employees tab with 14 people. Each row shows the token badge, the name, the sign-up status, and four buttons.

ELEMENT	WHAT IT MEANS
Token badge	The employee's Token Number (TKN). This is their username. Tokens are unique across the office; the list is ordered by token, then by name.
Signed up	This token already has a login. The employee can sign in.
Not signed up	The token exists but nobody has claimed it yet. Tell the employee to visit <code>/employee/signup</code> .
No token number — can't sign up yet	The employee has no token, so there is nothing to sign in with. Give them one with Edit .
Inactive	Deactivated: struck-through name, hidden from the public meal board, cannot sign up, and cannot change meals or see their bill if already signed up.

7.2 Adding an employee

The form at the top of the tab: a **Token** box, a **name** box, and **Add**.

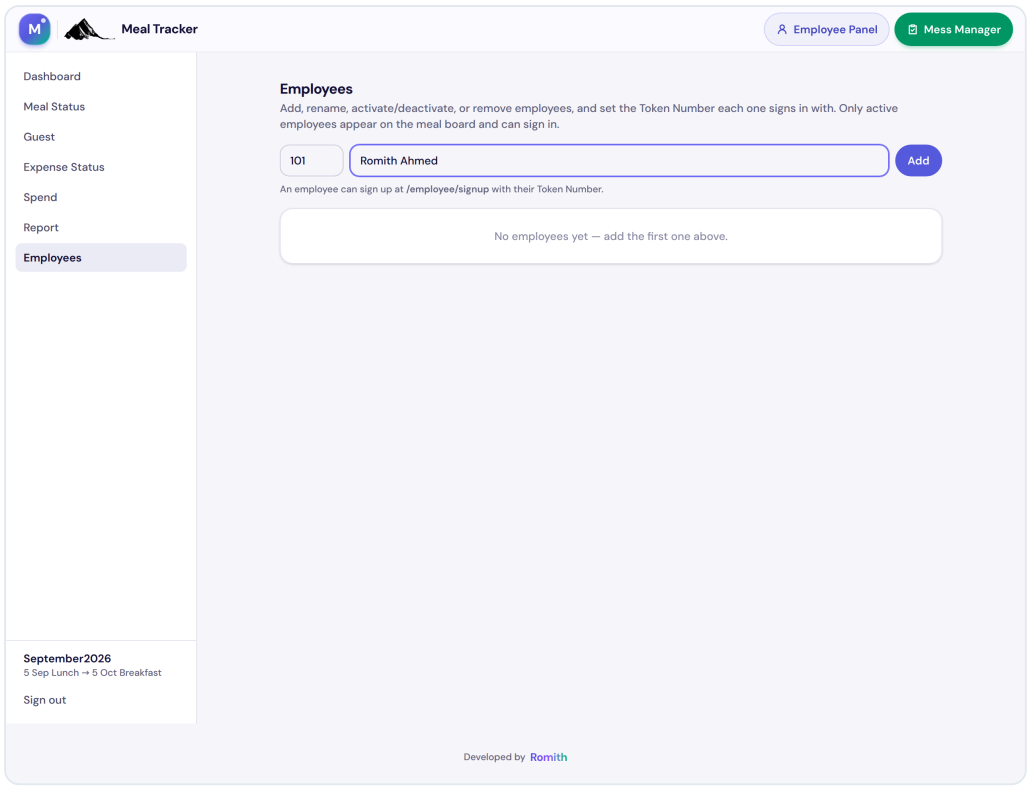


Figure 7.2 — Adding token 101, "Romith Ahmed", to an empty list. Note the reminder underneath: "An employee can sign up at `/employee/signup` with their Token Number."

- The **name** is required; the **token** is optional but an employee without one cannot sign in.
- A token must be a whole number and must not already be in use — if it is, you get "Token N is already used by another employee." and nothing is saved.
- New employees are active immediately and appear on the meal board straight away.

7.3 Editing a name or token

Meal Tracker

Employee Panel | Mess Manager

Employees

Add, rename, activate/deactivate, or remove employees, and set the Token Number each one signs in with. Only active employees appear on the meal board and can sign in.

Token | New employee name | Add

An employee can sign up at /employee/signup with their Token Number.

101	Romith Ahmed	Signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
102	Tanvir Hasan	Signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
103	Nusrat Jahan	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
104	Sabbir Rahman	Signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
105	Mehedi Hasan	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
106	Farhana Akter	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
107	Imran Kabir	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
108	Sadia Islam	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
109	Rakib Hossain	Signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
110	Jannatul Ferdous	Signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
111	Arif Mahmud	Not signed up	Edit	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
113	Mizanur Rahman		Save	Reset login	Deactivate	Remove
	Rafiq Chowdhury	No token number — can't sign up yet	Edit	Deactivate	Remove	
112	Shahriar Kabir	Inactive	Edit	Reset login	Activate	Remove

September 2026
5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast
Sign out

Developed by Romith

Figure 7.3 — Edit turns the row into two input boxes (token and name) and the button becomes **Save**. Enter saves too. No other row is affected.

Rule — a signed-up employee's token is frozen

The Token Number *is* the login. Once an employee has signed up, changing their token is refused: *"This employee has already signed up with their token. Reset their login first, then change the token."* Their name can still be corrected at any time.

7.4 Reset login — the password recovery route

There is no "forgot password" e-mail anywhere in this application. **Reset login** is the entire recovery mechanism, and it is in the mess manager's hands.

1. Press **Reset login** beside the employee.
2. Confirm the warning, which names the employee and their token and states that their meals and deposits stay.
3. The row goes back to **Not signed up** and a green message appears: *"<Name> can now sign up again at /employee/signup."*
4. The employee signs up again with the same token and a new password.

Use it for a forgotten password, or when the wrong person claimed a token.

Reset login deletes only the login

It does not touch the employee record, their meal history, or their deposits. It is safe.

7.5 Deactivate / Activate

Use this when somebody leaves, goes on long leave, or has not joined yet.

DEACTIVATING AN EMPLOYEE...	EFFECT
Public meal board	They disappear from it entirely.
Meal Status sheet	They stay, tagged Inactive , so history remains visible and correctable.
Their own panel	Sign-in still works, but the panel shows <i>"Account deactivated — please contact the mess manager."</i>
Sign-up	Blocked.
Reports	They still appear in any month where they ate or deposited, so their final bill is never lost.
Deposit dropdown	They are removed from the "Record a deposit" employee list.

Activate reverses all of it.

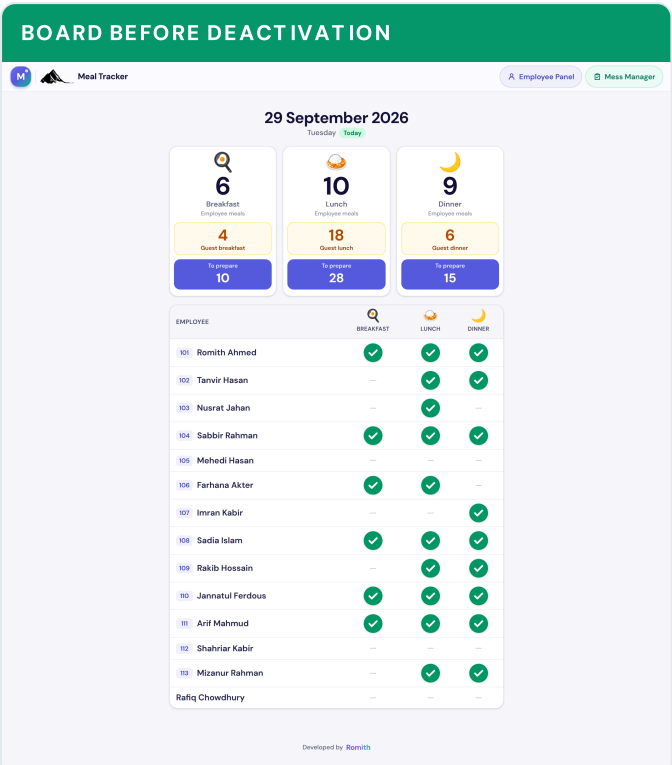


Figure 7.4 — 14 people listed, including token 112 Shahriar Kabir.

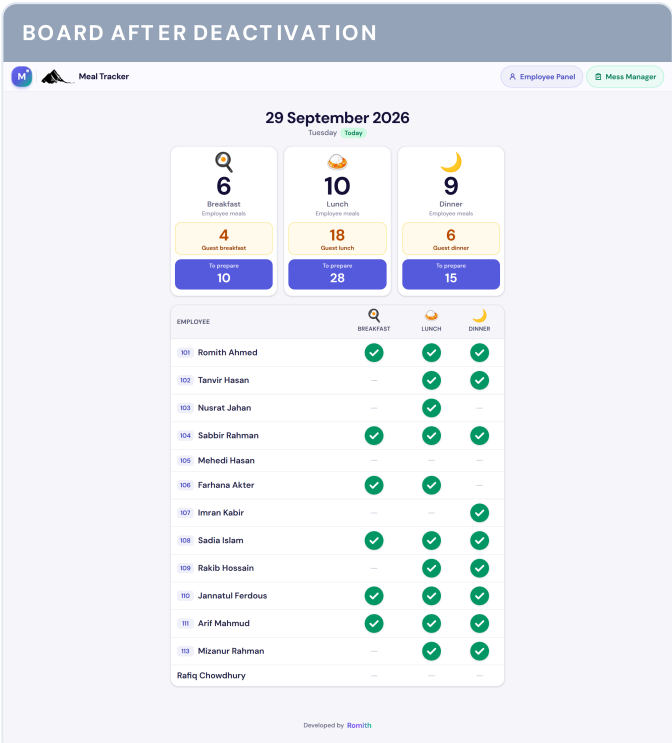


Figure 7.5 — 13 people. Shahriar Kabir left on 20 September and no longer appears for the cook.

What is different?

One row is gone from the cook's board — and nothing else. Shahriar Kabir's 31.25 meal count and his ₳3,000 deposit are still in September's Expense Status and Report (tagged **Inactive**), so his final settlement still happens.

7.6 Remove — and why it usually refuses

Remove deletes the employee outright. It is allowed **only** if the person has no meal history and no deposits in any month. Otherwise the application refuses:

"This employee has meal history and can't be deleted. Deactivate them instead."

This is deliberate, and the database enforces it independently of the application. Billing records must never silently disappear. For anyone who has ever eaten, **Deactivate** is the correct action — removal is only for a row typed in by mistake.

7.7 Empty state

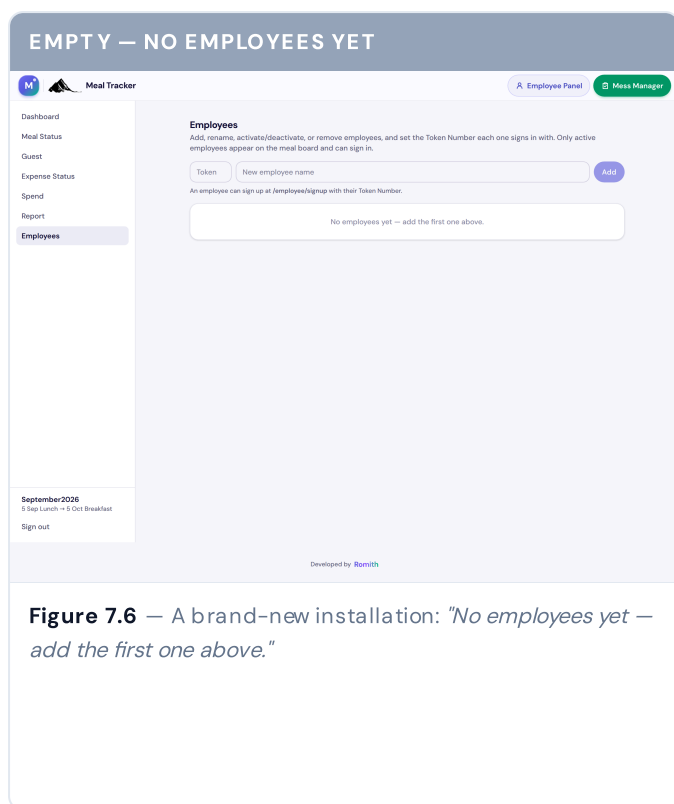


Figure 7.6 — A brand-new installation: "No employees yet — add the first one above."

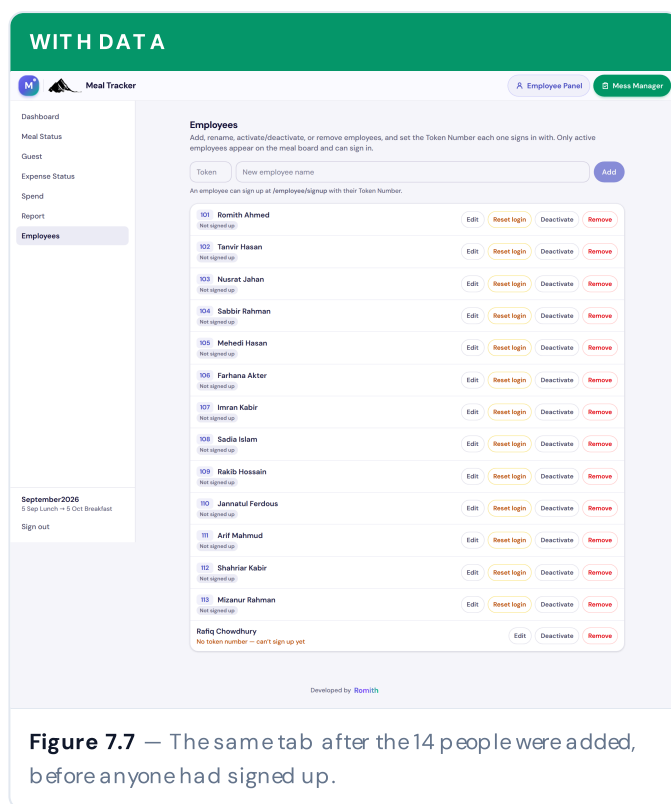


Figure 7.7 — The same tab after the 14 people were added, before anyone had signed up.

What is different?

The dashed empty-state line is replaced by the list. The add form at the top never changes — it is in exactly the same place either way, which is why the empty state says "above". Note that in Figure 7.7 every row still reads

Not signed up: adding an employee does **not** create their login — they must sign up themselves.

7.8 Who can do all this

Any mess manager account — the current month's, a past month's, or a future month's. The employee list is office-wide and is not tied to a manager period. This is the one place where an outgoing manager can still change something that affects the current month, so treat it with care and agree changes with the month's team.

8 Meal Data & the Monthly Meal Table

Every meal in the system is one row: *this employee, this date, breakfast yes/no, lunch yes/no, dinner yes/no*. Everything else — plate counts, meal counts, bills, reports, the CSV — is calculated from those rows when it is displayed. Nothing is stored twice, so nothing can go stale.

8.1 The daily meal sheet

EMPLOYEE	BREAKFAST × 0.75	LUNCH × 1.25	DINNER × 1	MEAL COUNT
101 Romith Ahmed	ON	ON	ON	3
102 Tanvir Hasan	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
103 Nusrat Jahan	OFF	ON	OFF	1.25
104 Sabbir Rahman	ON	ON	ON	3
105 Mehedi Hasan	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
106 Farhana Akter	ON	ON	OFF	2
107 Imran Kabir	OFF	OFF	ON	1
108 Sadia Islam	ON	ON	ON	3
109 Rakib Hossain	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
110 Jannatul Ferdous	ON	ON	ON	3
111 Arif Mahmud	ON	ON	ON	3
112 Shahriar Kabir Inactive	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
113 Mizanur Rahman	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
Rafiq Chowdhury	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
Total ON	6	10	9	26

Figure 8.1 — The meal sheet for 29 September 2026. One row per employee, three ON/OFF buttons, and that employee's meal count for the date on the right.

PART OF THE TABLE	WHAT IT SHOWS
Employee column	Token badge and name. Inactive employees remain, tagged Inactive , so history stays visible and correctable.
Column header	The meal, with the weight in force for this date underneath — × 0.75 , × 1.25 , × 1 — or Not yours on a handover day.
ON / OFF	The employee's choice. Tap to correct it. Saves instantly; several taps in a row save in parallel.
Meal count	That one person on that one date: Σ (meal ON $\times$ that meal's weight). $0.75 + 1.25 + 1 = 3$ for a full day on default weights.
Total ON (footer)	How many people have each meal ON, and the date's total meal count across everyone.

8.2 Meal counts (weights) — how a date is priced

Weights are stored **once per date**, not per employee. That is what makes a correction instant and consistent.

default weights

:

breakfast 0.75 · lunch 1.25 · dinner 1.00

allowed range

:

0 to 10, two decimal places

where stored

:

one row per customised date, belonging to one manager period

no row

:

the date uses the defaults

DEFAULT DATE

Meal count for this date

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

Default values

0.75

1.25

1

Save meal counts

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

Figure 8.2 — 29 September. Corner: *Default values*. No Reset button. **Save meal counts** is disabled until something changes.

CUSTOMISED DATE

Meal count for this date

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

Custom for this date

0.75

1.25

2

Save meal counts

Reset to 0.75 / 1.25 / 1

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

Figure 8.3 — 16 September, biryani night: dinner raised to **2**. Corner: *Custom for this date*, plus a **Reset to 0.75 / 1.25 / 1** button.

What is different?

Three things: the dinner box reads **2** instead of **1**; the corner label flips from *Default values* to *Custom for this date*; and a **Reset** button appears. In the table below, the dinner column header changes from **× 1** to **× 2** and every diner's meal count for that date rises by 1.00 — automatically, with nothing else to press.

Meal Tracker 0.1.0 · September 2026

Page 46 of 108

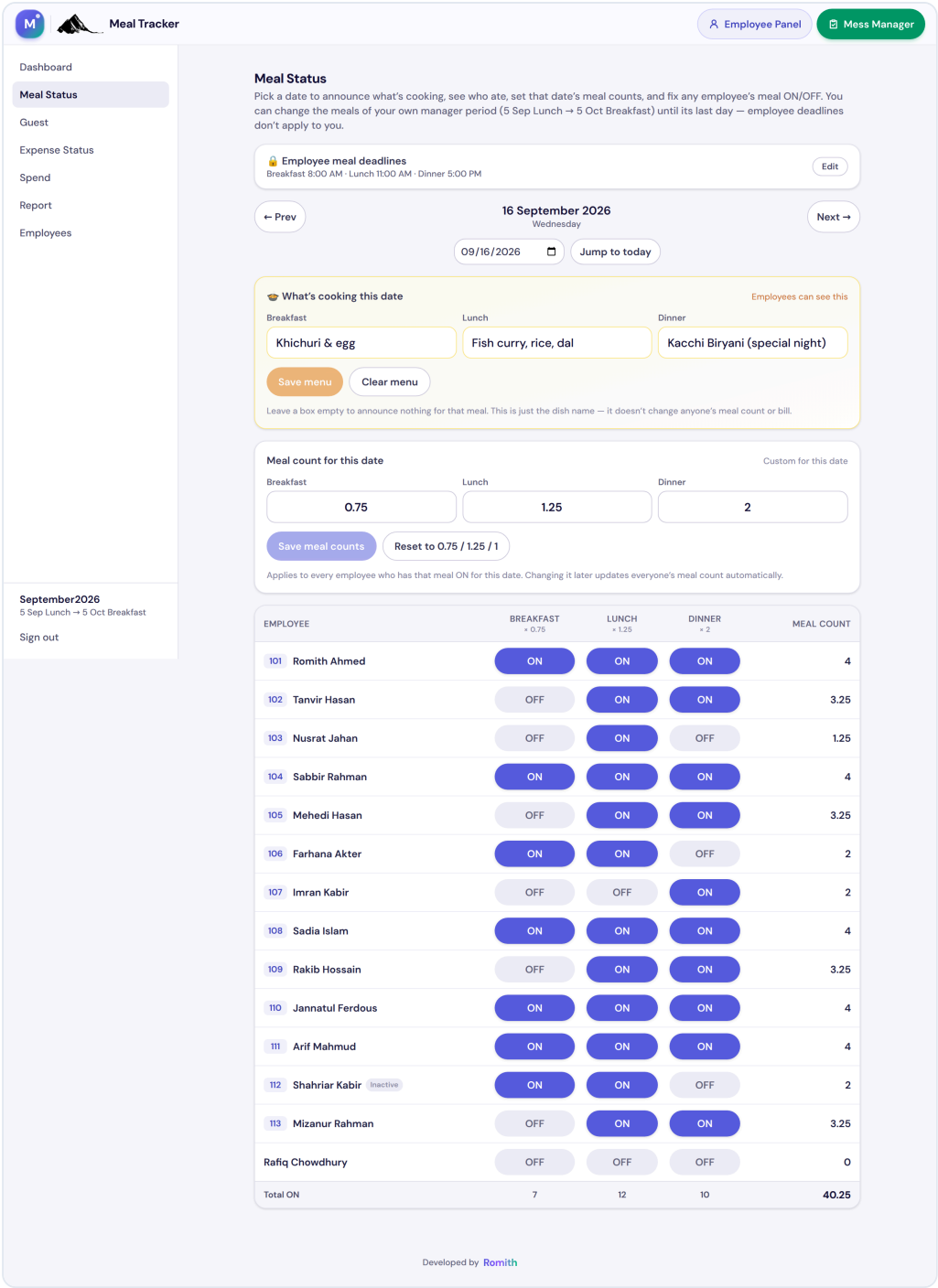
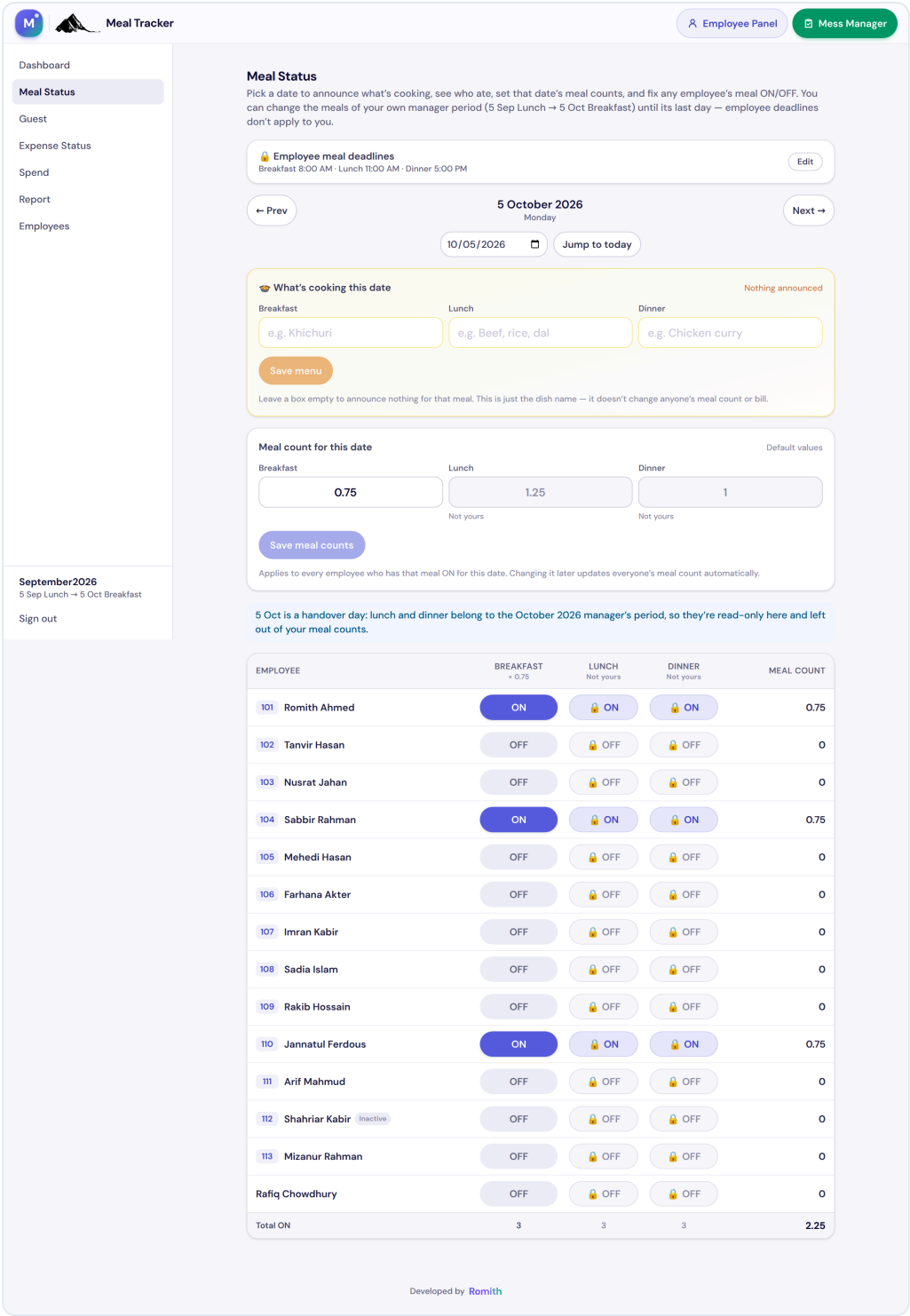
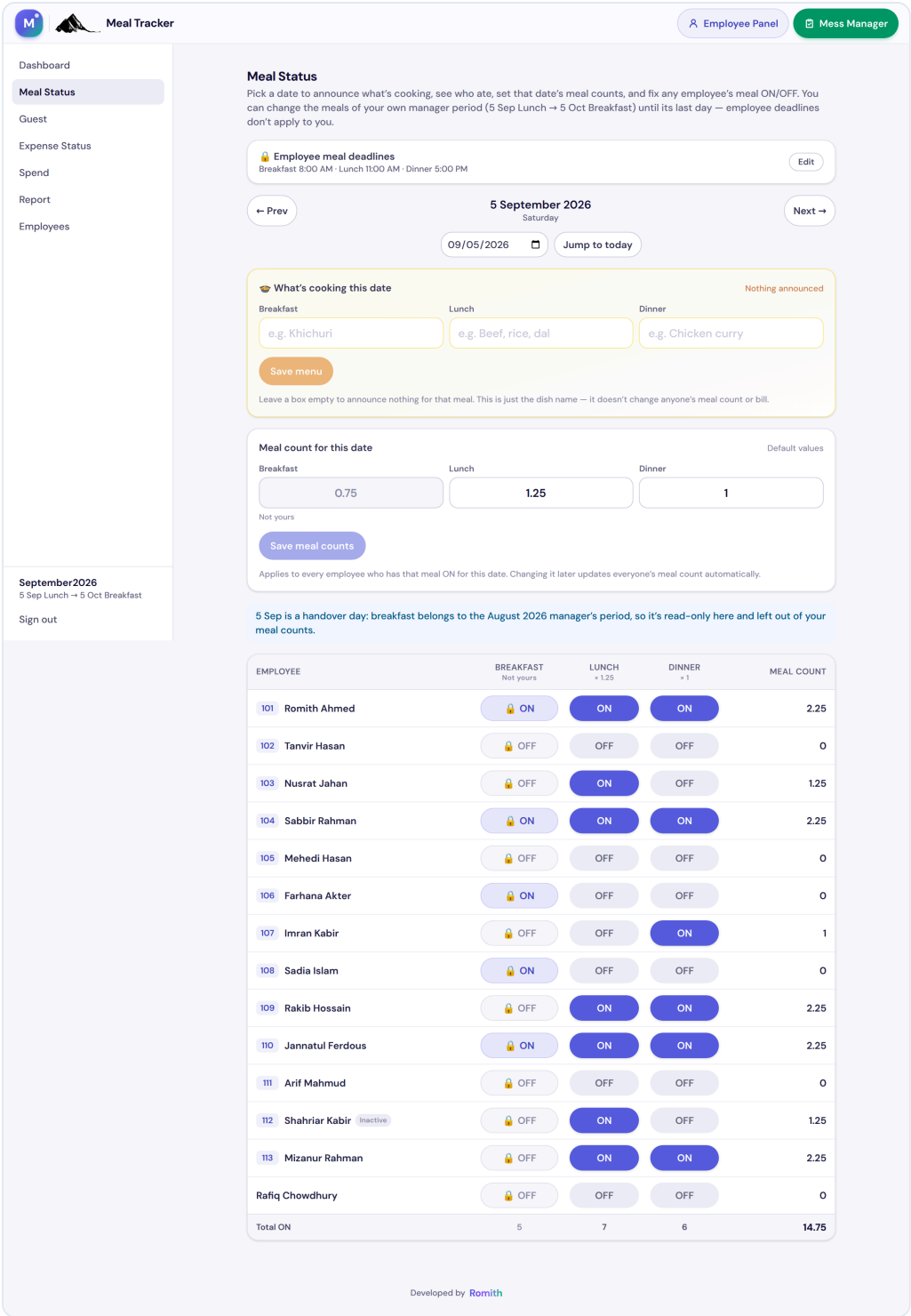


Figure 8.4 — The whole page for 16 September: the raised dinner weight, the announced biryani, and its effect on every employee's meal count in one view.

8.3 Handover days — the 5th of the month

On the 5th, two managers are in charge of the same date. The outgoing month owns **breakfast**; the incoming month owns **lunch and dinner**. The application makes this visible rather than silently ignoring it.





MEAL	BELONGS TO
4 Sep dinner, 5 Sep breakfast	August's manager
5 Sep lunch, 5 Sep dinner, 6 Sep ... 4 Oct, 5 Oct breakfast	September's manager
5 Oct lunch, 5 Oct dinner, 6 Oct breakfast ...	October's manager

Every meal belongs to exactly one month — there is no gap and no overlap, and the boundary follows real calendar dates, so February, leap years and December→January need no special handling.

8.4 Making a correction

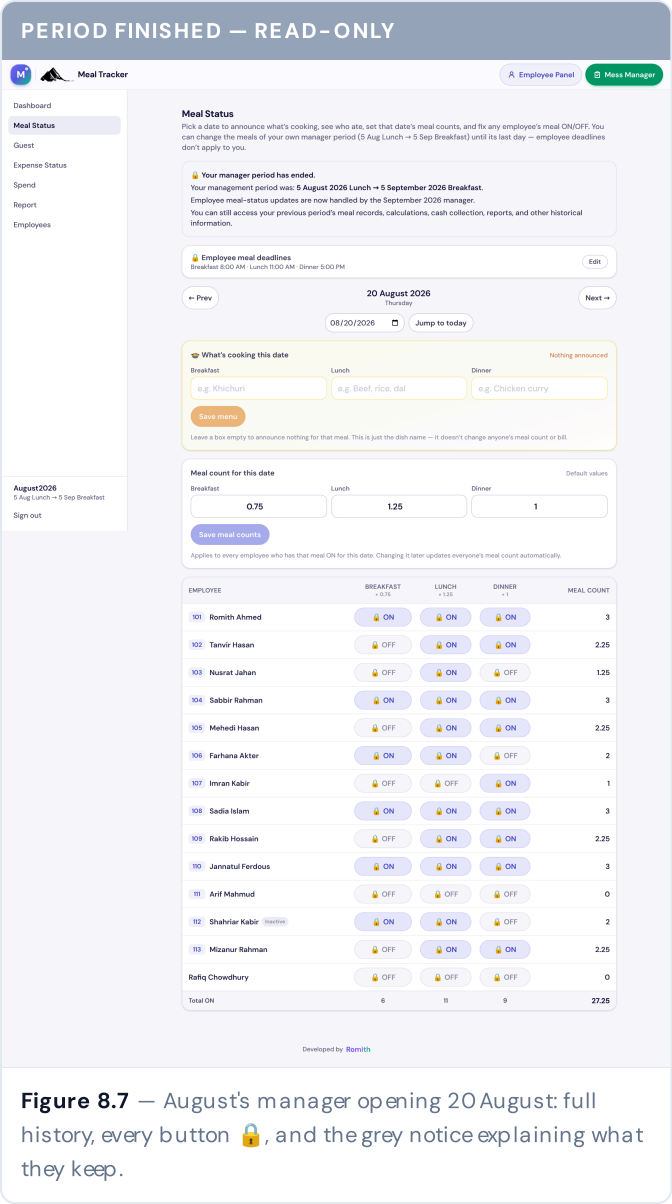
An employee who missed a deadline comes to you. The fix takes four taps:

1. Open **Meal Status**.
2. Navigate to the date in question.
3. Find the employee's row (rows are ordered by token).
4. Tap the meal. It saves instantly — the row's meal count and the footer totals update as you watch.

Rule — what a manager may correct

SITUATION	ALLOWED?
A meal of your own period, your period is running	Yes , at any time of day — deadlines do not apply to managers.
A meal of your own period, your period has ended	No . Everything is  and the page becomes a read-only record.
A meal of your own period, your period has not started	No — the current month's manager handles it until your first day.
A meal belonging to another month (e.g. the other half of the 5th)	No . Shown  and labelled Not yours .
A date outside your mess month entirely	No . The sheet is not even loaded (Figure 8.8).

These are not screen-level restrictions. The database re-checks every single meal a write touches and rejects the whole write if any part of it is not yours — so a modified request, a copied URL or a direct API call gets exactly the same answer.



Notice the two customised dates pulling their weight: 21 September (a festival lunch, breakfast 1.00 / lunch 1.50) and 16 September (biryani night, dinner 2.00). Every other date used the defaults. The answer, **74.25**, is the one shown everywhere — the employee's bill, the manager's Expense Status, the Report and the CSV.

8.6 Empty state

EMPTY — NO EMPLOYEES AT ALL

Meal Tracker

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Dashboard

Meal Status

Guest

Expense Status

Spend

Report

Employees

Meal Status

Pick a date to announce what's cooking, see who ate, set that date's meal counts, and fix any employee's meal ON/OFF. You can change the meals of your own manager period (5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast) until its last day — employee deadlines don't apply to you.

Employee meal deadlines

Breakfast 8:00 AM - Lunch 11:00 AM - Dinner 5:00 PM

Edit

← Prev

29 September 2026

Next →

Tuesday

Today

09/29/2026

📅

What's cooking this date

Nothing announced

Employees can see this

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

e.g. Khichuri

e.g. Beef, rice, dal

e.g. Chicken curry

Save menu

Leave a box empty to announce nothing for that meal. This is just the dish name — it doesn't change anyone's meal count or bill.

Meal count for this date

Default values

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

0.75

1.25

1

Save meal counts

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

September 2026

5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast

Sign out

Developed by Romith

Figure 8.9 — A new installation: the dish and meal-count forms are fully usable, but the sheet says "No employees yet."

WITH DATA

Meal Tracker

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Dashboard

Meal Status

Guest

Expense Status

Spend

Report

Employees

Meal Status

Pick a date to announce what's cooking, see who ate, set that date's meal counts, and fix any employee's meal ON/OFF. You can change the meals of your own manager period (5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast) until its last day — employee deadlines don't apply to you.

Employee meal deadlines

Breakfast 8:00 AM - Lunch 11:00 AM - Dinner 5:00 PM

Edit

← Prev

29 September 2026

Next →

Tuesday

Today

09/29/2026

📅

What's cooking this date

Employees can see this

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

Khichuri & egg

Beef bhuna, rice, dal

Chicken curry, rice

Save menu

Clear menu

Leave a box empty to announce nothing for that meal. This is just the dish name — it doesn't change anyone's meal count or bill.

Meal count for this date

Default values

Breakfast

Lunch

Dinner

0.75

1.25

1

Save meal counts

Applies to every employee who has that meal ON for this date. Changing it later updates everyone's meal count automatically.

September 2026

5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast

Sign out

EMPLOYEE	BREAKFAST + 0.75	LUNCH + 1.25	DINNER + 1	MEAL COUNT
101 Romith Ahmed	ON	ON	ON	3
102 Tanvir Hasan	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
103 Nusrat Jahan	OFF	ON	OFF	1.25
104 Sabbir Rahman	ON	ON	ON	3
105 Mehedi Hasan	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
106 Farhana Akter	ON	ON	OFF	2
107 Imran Kabir	OFF	OFF	ON	1
108 Sadia Islam	ON	ON	ON	3
109 Rakib Hossain	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
110 Jannatul Ferdous	ON	ON	ON	3
111 Arif Mahmud	ON	ON	ON	3
112 Shahriar Kabir <i>Resistant</i>	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
113 Mizanur Rahman	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
Rafiq Chowdhury	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
Total ON	6	10	9	26

Developed by Romith

Figure 8.10 — The same page once employees exist and have made their choices.

What is different?

Only the table area. Everything above it — deadlines, date navigation, "What's cooking", "Meal count for this date" — is present and working in both states, because those settings belong to the date, not to the people. The empty state is a dashed box reading "No employees yet.", and the **Total ON** footer row disappears entirely rather than showing zeros.

Meal Tracker 0.1.0 · September 2026

Page 52 of 108

9 Expense Status — Deposits, Meal Rate, Dues

Expense Status is where the money lives: the cash employees hand in, the rate the mess settles on, and the resulting due or refund for every person. It is one page with four stacked parts.

9.1 The page at a glance

Expense Status
Record money employees hand in — before, during, or at the end of the month — and see who still owes and who has money left.

1 Record a deposit

2 Amount (\$)

3 Select employee...

4 (optional)

5 Record deposit

6 Rate (\$ per meal count)

7 Published to employees

8 Test meal rate

9 Publish meal rate

10 Publish meal rate

11 EMPLOYEE

12 MEAL CO.

13 TOTAL

14 TOTAL DEPT.

15 AMOUNT TO BE PAID

16 Deposit history (18)

EMPLOYEE	MEAL CO.	TOTAL	TOTAL DEPT.	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	74.25	+6,868.13	+6,500	+368.13 Due (to pay)
102 Tanvir Hasan	41.75	+3,861.88	+4,000	+138.12 Remaining (refund)
103 Nusrat Jahan	27.75	+2,566.88	+2,500	+66.88 Due (to pay)
104 Sabbir Rahman	82.5	+7,631.25	+7,000	+631.25 Due (to pay)
105 Mehedi Hasan	28	+2,590	+3,000	+410 Remaining (refund)
106 Farhana Akter	40.5	+3,746.25	+3,800	+53.75 Remaining (refund)
107 Imran Kabir	26	+2,405	+2,000	+405 Due (to pay)
108 Sadia Islam	55.5	+5,133.75	+0	+5,133.75 Due (to pay)
109 Rakib Hossain	62	+5,735	+7,000	+1,265 Remaining (refund)
110 Jannatul Ferdous	80.25	+7,423.13	+7,423.13	Fully settled
111 Arif Mahmud	46.5	+4,301.25	+4,000	+301.25 Due (to pay)
112 Shahriar Kabir	31.25	+2,890.63	+3,000	+109.37 Remaining (refund)
113 Mizanur Rahman	50.75	+4,694.38	+4,500	+194.38 Due (to pay)
114 Chowdhury	0	+0	+0	Fully settled
Total	647	+58,847.53	+54,723.13	+4,124.40 due

Developed by Romith

Figure 9.1 — The complete Expense Status tab for September 2026, with a published rate of ₹92.50 and 18 deposits recorded.

#	ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES
1	Employee name (dropdown)	Who the deposit is from. Lists active employees only, as "token · name".
2	Deposit amount (₹)	Must be more than ₹0. Paisa allowed.
3	Date received	Defaults to today. It can be <i>any</i> date — before, during or after the month — because it records when the cash actually changed hands.
4	Note (optional)	Up to 200 characters: "Cash", "bKash", "Advance for October", "Final settlement". The employee sees this note under the deposit in their own panel.
5	Add deposit	Saves it. Greyed out until an employee and an amount above zero are chosen. A green confirmation names the employee and amount.
6	Testing (only you)	The rate the tables on <i>your</i> pages are using right now. Employees never see it.
7	Published to employees	The rate employees can see, with the time it was published. Green once published, grey ("Not yet") before.
8	Rate box	Type the rate here, then press one of the two buttons.
9	Test meal rate	Applies the rate to your own pages only. Press it as often as you like.
10	Publish meal rate	Sends the rate to every employee with their bill, deposit and due/refund. Asks for confirmation first.
11	Meal Count	The employee's weighted meal count for the month.
12	Total Bill	Meal Count × the <i>testing</i> rate. A dash until a rate is set.
13	Total Deposit	Everything recorded for that person in this month.
14	Amount to be Paid	Deposit – bill, in words and colour. Never a bare minus sign.
15	Total row	Month totals, then total due (red) and total remaining (green) side by side.
16	Deposit history (18)	Every deposit newest first, with a Remove button on each.

9.2 Recording a deposit

Record a deposit

Employee name

Select employee... ▼

Deposit amount (₹)

Date received

09/29/2026 📅

Note (optional)

Add deposit

Figure 9.2 — Record a deposit. Four fields, one button.

1. Pick the employee.
2. Type the amount they handed over.
3. Set the date they handed it over (today by default).

4. Add a note if it helps — the employee will read it.

5. Press **Add deposit**. The table above and the history below both update immediately.

Any number of deposits, any time

An employee can pay in one lump or in five instalments; the system simply adds them up. A deposit can be recorded before the month starts (an advance) or after it ends (a late settlement) — what matters is the *month* you are signed in as, not the date on the deposit.

113	Mizanur Rahman	27 September 2026 · bKash	₳2,000	Remove
101	Romith Ahmed	26 September 2026 · Cash	₳1,000	Remove
106	Farhana Akter	24 September 2026 · bKash	₳1,800	Remove
109	Rakib Hossain	22 September 2026 · bKash	₳2,000	Remove
112	Shahriar Kabir	21 September 2026 · Final settlement — left 20 Sep	₳3,000	Remove
104	Sabbir Rahman	20 September 2026 · Cash	₳3,000	Remove
111	Arif Mahmud	19 September 2026 · Cash — joined 15 Sep	₳4,000	Remove
101	Romith Ahmed	18 September 2026 · bKash	₳2,500	Remove
110	Jannatul Ferdous	16 September 2026 · Full month, paid in one go	₳7,423.13	Remove
105	Mehedi Hasan	15 September 2026 · Cash	₳3,000	Remove
107	Imran Kabir	14 September 2026 · Cash	₳2,000	Remove
103	Nusrat Jahan	12 September 2026 · bKash	₳2,500	Remove
113	Mizanur Rahman	11 September 2026 · Cash	₳2,500	Remove
102	Tanvir Hasan	10 September 2026 · Cash	₳4,000	Remove
106	Farhana Akter	9 September 2026 · Cash	₳2,000	Remove
101	Romith Ahmed	8 September 2026 · Cash	₳3,000	Remove
109	Rakib Hossain	7 September 2026 · Cash	₳5,000	Remove
104	Sabbir Rahman	2 September 2026 · Advance, before the month	₳4,000	Remove

Figure 9.3 — Deposit history (18): newest first, showing token, name, date, note and amount. **Remove** asks for confirmation — “Remove ₳3,000 deposit from Romith Ahmed?” — and then deletes that one deposit. A deposit cannot be edited; remove it and add it again.

9.3 The meal rate: Test, then Publish

The rate is the single number that turns meal counts into money. It has two independent values.

	TEST MEAL RATE	PUBLISH MEAL RATE
Who sees the effect	Only this manager account, on Expense Status and Report.	Every employee, in My bill , plus the manager's own pages.
How often	As many times as you like, all month.	Whenever the figure is final. Re-publishing simply replaces it.
Confirmation	None — it is harmless.	Yes, a confirmation box, because it is visible to the whole office.
Undo	Type another rate and test again; clear the box and press to remove the test rate.	Unpublish (the small grey link under the buttons) — employees stop seeing a rate and a bill.

PUBLISHED — THE NORMAL STATE

Meal rate (¢ per meal count)

Testing (only you)

¥92.50

Published to employees

¥92.50

29 Sep 2026, 10:19 PM

92.5

Test meal rate

Publish meal rate

Test changes the bills on your pages only — try as many rates as you like. Publish sends the rate to every employee with their total bill, deposit, and due or refund.

Unpublish

Figure 9.4

Both boxes read ¥92.50. The right-hand box is green and stamped with the publication time.

TESTING A DIFFERENT RATE

Meal rate (¢ per meal count)

Testing (only you)

¥95

Published to employees

¥92.50

29 Sep 2026, 10:19 PM

95

Test meal rate

Publish meal rate

Test changes the bills on your pages only — try as many rates as you like. Publish sends the rate to every employee with their total bill, deposit, and due or refund.

Unpublish

Testing ¥95 — bills below use it. Employees don't see it until you publish.

Figure 9.5

Testing ¥95 while ¥92.50 stays published. The message spells it out: "Testing ¥95 — bills below use it. Employees don't see it until you publish."

What is different?

Only the left ("Testing") box and the confirmation line. The green **Published to employees** box is untouched at ¥92.50 — which is exactly the point: **testing never leaks**. Meanwhile the whole bill table below silently re-prices to ¥95 for the manager's eyes only.

BILLS AT THE PUBLISHED ₹92.50				
EMPLOYEE	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	74.25	₹6,868.13	₹6,500	₹368.13 Due (to pay)
102 Tanvir Hasan	41.75	₹3,861.88	₹4,000	₹138.12 Remaining (refund)
103 Nusrat Jahan	27.75	₹2,566.88	₹2,500	₹66.88 Due (to pay)
104 Sabbir Rahman	82.5	₹7,631.25	₹7,000	₹631.25 Due (to pay)
105 Mehedi Hasan	28	₹2,590	₹3,000	₹410 Remaining (refund)
106 Farhana Akter	40.5	₹3,746.25	₹3,800	₹53.75 Remaining (refund)
107 Imran Kabir	26	₹2,405	₹2,000	₹405 Due (to pay)
108 Sadia Islam	55.5	₹5,133.75	₹0	₹5,133.75 Due (to pay)
109 Rakib Hossain	62	₹5,735	₹7,000	₹1,265 Remaining (refund)
110 Jannatul Ferdous	80.25	₹7,423.13	₹7,423.13	Fully settled
111 Arif Mahmud	46.5	₹4,301.25	₹4,000	₹301.25 Due (to pay)
112 Shahriar Kabir Inactive	31.25	₹2,890.63	₹3,000	₹109.37 Remaining (refund)
113 Mizanur Rahman	50.75	₹4,694.38	₹4,500	₹194.38 Due (to pay)
Rafiq Chowdhury	0	₹0	₹0	Fully settled
Total	647	₹59,847.53	₹54,723.13	₹7,100.64 due ₹1,976.24 remaining

Figure 9.6 — Total bill ₹59,847.53 · ₹7,100.64 due · ₹1,976.24 remaining.

THE SAME TABLE WHILE TESTING ₹95				
EMPLOYEE	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	74.25	₹7,053.75	₹6,500	₹553.75 Due (to pay)
102 Tanvir Hasan	41.75	₹3,966.25	₹4,000	₹33.75 Remaining (refund)
103 Nusrat Jahan	27.75	₹2,636.25	₹2,500	₹136.25 Due (to pay)
104 Sabbir Rahman	82.5	₹7,837.50	₹7,000	₹837.50 Due (to pay)
105 Mehedi Hasan	28	₹2,660	₹3,000	₹340 Remaining (refund)
106 Farhana Akter	40.5	₹3,847.50	₹3,800	₹47.50 Due (to pay)
107 Imran Kabir	26	₹2,470	₹2,000	₹470 Due (to pay)
108 Sadia Islam	55.5	₹5,272.50	₹0	₹5,272.50 Due (to pay)
109 Rakib Hossain	62	₹5,890	₹7,000	₹1,110 Remaining (refund)
110 Jannatul Ferdous	80.25	₹7,623.75	₹7,423.13	₹200.62 Due (to pay)
111 Arif Mahmud	46.5	₹4,417.50	₹4,000	₹417.50 Due (to pay)
112 Shahriar Kabir Inactive	31.25	₹2,968.75	₹3,000	₹31.25 Remaining (refund)
113 Mizanur Rahman	50.75	₹4,821.25	₹4,500	₹321.25 Due (to pay)
Rafiq Chowdhury	0	₹0	₹0	Fully settled
Total	647	₹61,465	₹54,723.13	₹8,256.87 due ₹1,515 remaining

Figure 9.7 — Every bill, due and refund has moved — on this screen only.

What is different?

Every number in the **Total Bill** and **Amount to be Paid** columns, and both figures in the footer. **Meal Count** and **Total Deposit** do not move — they are facts, not opinions. This is the intended way to choose a rate: try a few, watch how much cash you would collect, then publish the one that matches what the mess actually spent.

9.4 Reading the "Amount to be Paid" column

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
₹368.13 · Due (to pay)	The bill is bigger than the deposits.	Collect ₹368.13 from that employee.
₹1,265 · Remaining (refund)	They paid more than their bill.	Refund it, or carry it into next month as an advance.
Fully settled	Deposit and bill are equal (to the paisa).	Nothing.
— (a dash)	No meal rate has been set yet, so there is no bill to compare against.	Test a rate.

Real examples from Figure 9.1

- **108 Sadia Islam** — 55.5 meal count, ₳5,133.75 bill, **no deposit at all** → the whole bill is due. This is what an employee who never pays looks like.
- **109 Rakib Hossain** — paid ₳7,000 against a ₳5,735 bill → ₳1,265 **Remaining (refund)**. Employees *can* pay more than they owe.
- **110 Jannatul Ferdous** — paid ₳7,423.13 for a ₳7,423.13 bill → **Fully settled**.
- **112 Shahriar Kabir** — **Inactive**: he left on 20 September, but his 31.25 meal count and ₳3,000 settlement are still here.
- **Rafiq Chowdhury** — no token, no meals, no deposits: 0 everywhere and **Fully settled**. A brand-new joiner who has not started eating.

9.5 Where the meal rate comes from

The application does not choose the rate for you — it gives you the two numbers you need:

Spend tab	→ TOTAL MONTHLY SPENDING	= ₳59,900
Dashboard	→ Month meal count	= 647

meal rate $\approx$ ₳59,900 $\div$ 647 = ₳92.58 → published as ₳92.50		
check	: 647 $\times$ ₳92.50 = ₳59,847.53 collected against ₳59,900 spent	

Rounding the rate down slightly leaves the mess a few taka short; rounding up leaves a small surplus. Either is normal — the team decides. Guest meals are billed to the office separately and are not part of this arithmetic.

9.6 Empty state

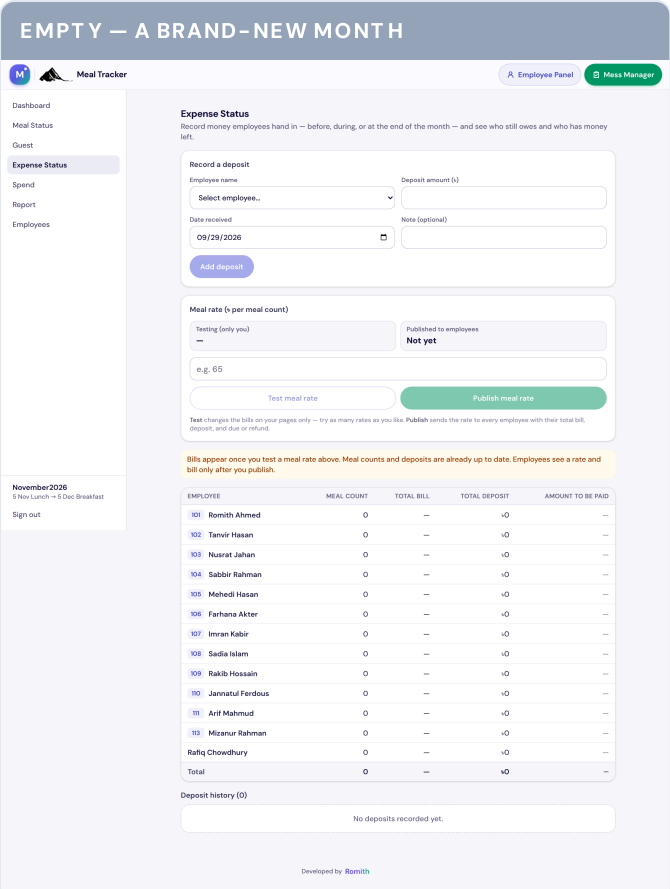


Figure 9.8 — November 2026, nothing recorded yet.

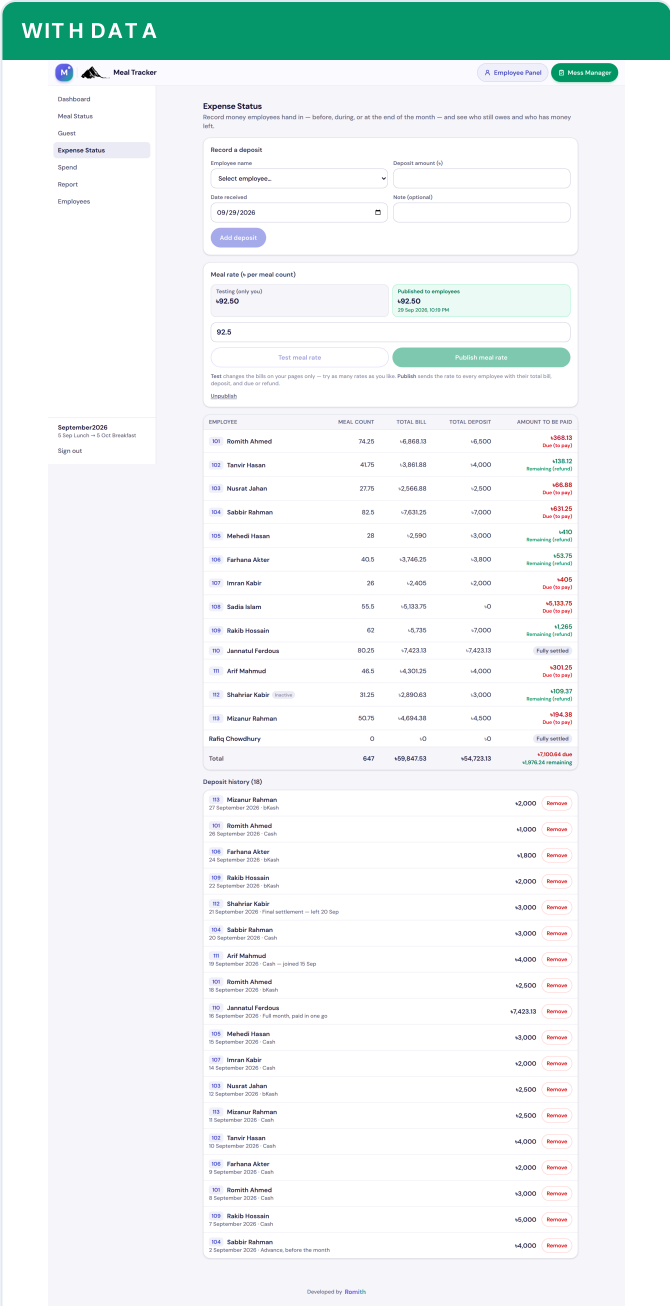


Figure 9.9 — September 2026 at month end.

What is different?

- An amber strip appears under the rate card: "Bills appear once you test a meal rate above. Meal counts and deposits are already up to date. Employees see a rate and bill only after you publish."
- The rate card shows — for testing and **Not yet** for published; there is no **Unpublish** link and no timestamp.
- The table still lists **every active employee** — 0 meal count, +0 deposit, and a dash in both **Total Bill** and **Amount to be Paid**, because without a rate there is nothing to compare. That is the honest empty state: the people exist, the month has not happened yet. (Note that the inactive employee, 112 Shahriar Kabir, is *not* listed — a month shows inactive people only if they ate or deposited in it.)
- **Deposit history (0)** becomes a dashed box: "No deposits recorded yet."

M Meal Tracker

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Dashboard

Meal Status

Guest

Expense Status

Spend

Report

Employees

October2026

5 Oct Lunch → 5 Nov Breakfast

Sign out

Expense Status

Record money employees hand in — before, during, or at the end of the month — and see who still owes and who has money left.

Record a deposit

Employee name

Select employee...

Deposit amount (৳)

Date received

09/29/2026

Note (optional)

Add deposit

Meal rate (৳ per meal count)

Testing (only you)

—

Published to employees

Not yet

e.g., 65

Test meal rate

Publish meal rate

Test changes the bills on your pages only — try as many rates as you like. Publish sends the rate to every employee with their total bill, deposit, and due or refund.

Bills appear once you test a meal rate above. Meal counts and deposits are already up to date. Employees see a rate and bill only after you publish.

EMPLOYEE	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	2.25	—	৳3,000	—
102 Tanvir Hasan	0	—	৳0	—
103 Nusrat Jahan	0	—	৳0	—
104 Sabbir Rahman	2.25	—	৳3,500	—
105 Mehedi Hasan	0	—	৳0	—
106 Farhana Akter	0	—	৳0	—
107 Imran Kabir	0	—	৳0	—
108 Sadia Islam	0	—	৳0	—
109 Rakib Hossain	0	—	৳0	—
110 Jannatul Ferdous	2.25	—	৳0	—
111 Arif Mahmud	0	—	৳0	—
113 Mizanur Rahman	0	—	৳0	—
Rafiq Chowdhury	0	—	৳0	—
Total	6.75	—	৳6,500	—

Deposit history (2)

104 Sabbir Rahman

29 September 2026 · Advance for October

৳3,500

Remove

101 Romith Ahmed

28 September 2026 · Advance for October

৳3,000

Remove

Developed by Romith

Figure 9.10 — A halfway state worth knowing: **October 2026**, whose period has not started, already holds two advance deposits (৳3,000 and ৳3,500, both noted "Advance for October"). Deposits can be collected long before the month begins.

10 Guest Meals

Guests are people who eat at the mess but are not on the employee list — visitors, clients, a contractor's team. **The office pays for guest meals, not the employees.** Guest counts therefore never touch anyone's meal count or bill; they produce a separate "bill to collect" from the office.

10.1 The fixed guest rates

MEAL	PER GUEST	EXAMPLE
 Breakfast	₺60	4 guests → $4 \times ₺60 = ₺240$
 Lunch	₺150	18 guests → $18 \times ₺150 = ₺2,700$
 Dinner	₺150	6 guests → $6 \times ₺150 = ₺900$

These three rates are fixed in the application and cannot be changed from any screen. They have nothing to do with the employee meal rate, which changes every month.

10.2 The Guest tab at a glance

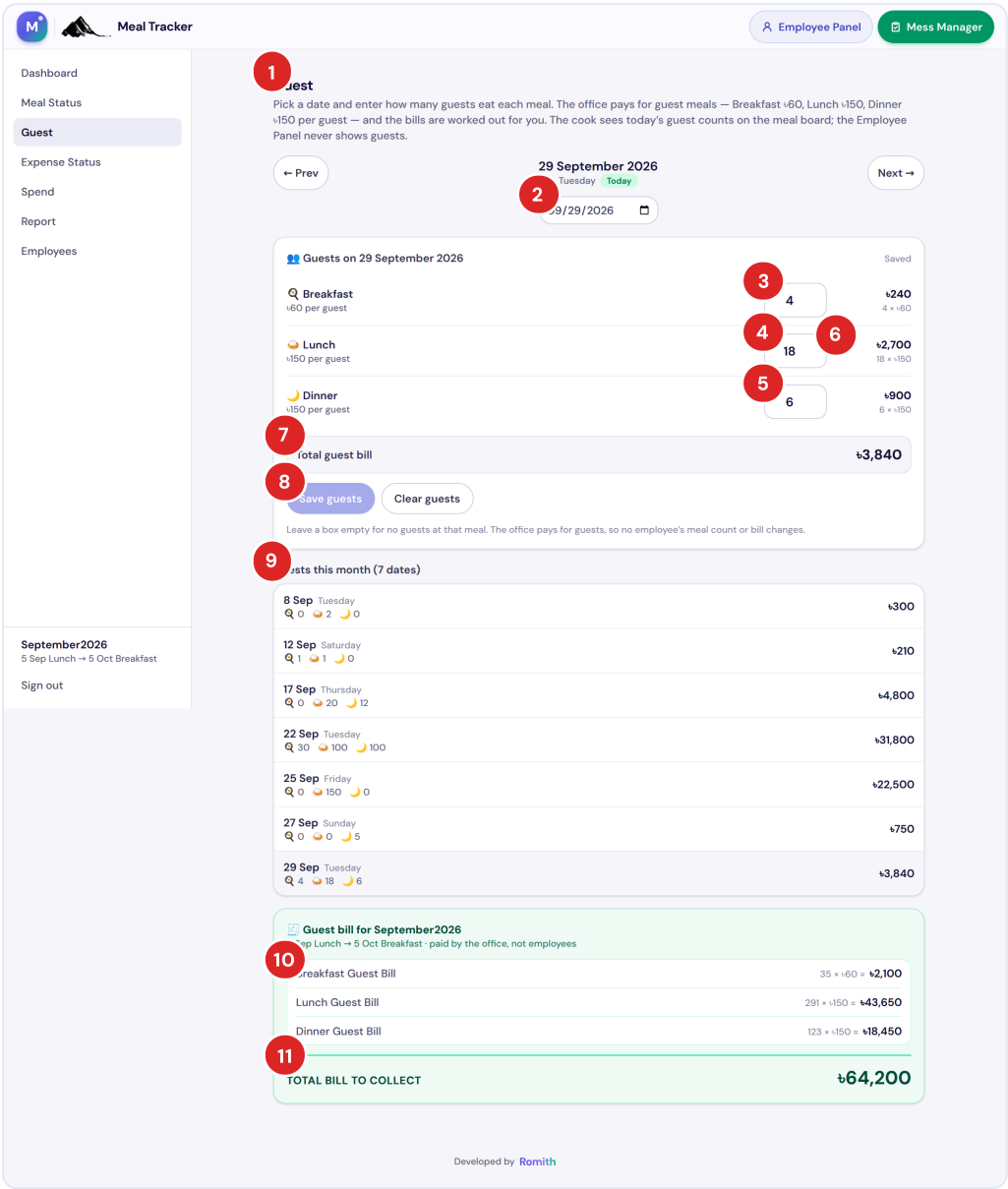


Figure 10.1 — The Guest tab on 29 September 2026, with guests declared for seven dates this month.

#	ELEMENT	WHAT IT DOES
1	Page title and blurb	Restates the three rates and reminds you that the cook sees today's counts while employees never see guests at all.
2	Day navigator	Which date you are declaring guests for. Same control as Meal Status.
3	Breakfast guests	A whole number from 0 to 10,000. Blank means 0.
4	Lunch guests	Same.
5	Dinner guests	Same.
6	Per-meal bill	Calculated <i>as you type</i> : the amount, with the working (18 × ₺150) underneath.
7	Total guest bill	The three added up, for this date.

8	Save guests	Writes the date's counts. Enabled only when something has changed. A Clear guests button appears beside it whenever the date has any guests saved.
9	Guests this month (n)	Every date with guests, oldest first — tap one to jump to it and edit it. The currently selected date is tinted.
10	Per-meal month totals	Breakfast / Lunch / Dinner guest bill for the whole month, each showing its working.
11	Total bill to collect	The month's grand total, to be invoiced to the office. Also appears on the Dashboard as "Guest bill to collect".

10.3 Declaring guests, step by step

1. Open the **Guest** tab and navigate to the date.

2. Type the number of guests for each meal. Leave a box empty for none.

3. Watch the bill on the right of each row and the total at the bottom — they update as you type.

4. Press **Save guests**. The confirmation reads: *"Guests saved for 29 September 2026. The cook sees them on the meal board."*

Saving a date again overwrites it

There is exactly one guest record per date per month — never a second one. If ten more guests turn up, change the number and save again; do not try to add a second entry. **Clear guests** (with confirmation) removes the date's record entirely.

10.4 Any size of party — worked examples

The same form handles one guest and one hundred and fifty. These are real screenshots from four different dates of the demo month.

A HANDFUL — 29 SEP

Guests on 29 September 2026

Breakfast

4

₺240

Lunch

18

₺2,700

Dinner

6

₺900

Total guest bill

₺3,840

Save guests

Clear guests

Leave a box empty for no guests at that meal. The office pays for guests, so no employee's meal count or bill changes.

Figure 10.2 — $4 \cdot 18 \cdot 6$ guests $\rightarrow$ $\text{₺}240 + \text{₺}2,700 + \text{₺}900 = \text{₺}3,840$.

A BIG EVENT — 22 SEP

Guests on 22 September 2026

Breakfast

30

₺1,800

Lunch

100

₺15,000

Dinner

100

₺15,000

Total guest bill

₺31,800

Save guests

Clear guests

Leave a box empty for no guests at that meal. The office pays for guests, so no employee's meal count or bill changes.

Figure 10.3 — $30 \cdot 100 \cdot 100$ guests $\rightarrow$ $\text{₺}1,800 + \text{₺}15,000 + \text{₺}15,000 = \text{₺}31,800$.

ONE MEAL ONLY — 25 SEP

Guests on 25 September 2026

Saved

Breakfast

60 per guest

0

0 × 60

Lunch

150 per guest

150

22,500
150 × 150

Dinner

150 per guest

0

0 × 150

Total guest bill

22,500

Save guests

Clear guests

Leave a box empty for no guests at that meal. The office pays for guests, so no employee's meal count or bill changes.

Figure 10.4 — 150lunch guests and nothing else→ 22,500.

Empty boxes contribute 0 and are not an error.

NO GUESTS — 24 SEP

Guests on 24 September 2026

No guests

Breakfast

60 per guest

0

0 × 60

Lunch

150 per guest

0

0 × 150

Dinner

150 per guest

0

0 × 150

Total guest bill

0

Save guests

Leave a box empty for no guests at that meal. The office pays for guests, so no employee's meal count or bill changes.

Figure 10.5 — A date with nobody expected: three empty boxes, a 0 total, the corner reading No guests, and no Clear guests button.

- What is different between a date with guests and a date without?

- The corner label: **Saved** (or **Not saved yet** while you are typing) versus **No guests**.
 - The per-meal amounts and the total: real money versus 0.
 - The **Clear guests** button exists only when something is saved.
 - The date appears in — or is absent from — the "Guests this month" list below. There are never blank rows for empty dates.

What the form refuses

Guests must be whole numbers from 0 to 10,000. Type "2.5" or "abc" and the box turns red, its amount becomes a dash with the hint "Whole number", and **Save guests** is disabled until it is fixed.

10.5 The month's list and the bill to collect

GUESTS THIS MONTH

Guests this month (7 dates)

8 Sep Tuesday	Q 0 2 0	300
12 Sep Saturday	Q 1 1 0	210
17 Sep Thursday	Q 0 20 12	4,800
22 Sep Tuesday	Q 30 100 100	31,800
25 Sep Friday	Q 0 150 0	22,500
27 Sep Sunday	Q 0 0 5	750
29 Sep Tuesday	Q 4 18 6	3,840

Figure 10.6 — Seven dates, each with its weekday, its Q / / counts and its own bill. Tap any row to edit that date.

GUEST BILL FOR THE MONTH

Guest bill for September 2026

5 Sep Lunch → 5 Oct Breakfast · paid by the office, not employees

Breakfast Guest Bill	35 × 60 = 2,100
Lunch Guest Bill	291 × 150 = 43,650
Dinner Guest Bill	123 × 150 = 18,450
TOTAL BILL TO COLLECT	64,200

Figure 10.7 — The green card: each meal's total with its working, then TOTAL BILL TO COLLECT 64,200.

Breakfast : 35 guests × 60 = 2,100

Lunch : 291 guests × 150 = 43,650

Dinner : 123 guests × 150 = 18,450

TOTAL BILL TO COLLECT = 64,200 (from the office)

No bill is ever stored. Only the guest counts are saved; every amount on this page — per meal, per date, per month — is recalculated from those counts each time the page is drawn, so it cannot drift out of date.

10.6 What the cook sees



Figure 10.8 — The public meal board on a day with guests. Each meal card gains two extra blocks: an amber **guest** count and an indigo **To prepare** total. On 29 September the cook must prepare 10 breakfasts (6 + 4), 28 lunches (10 + 18) and 15 dinners (9 + 6).

Guests are never mixed into the employee count

The big number at the top of each card stays the employee count; guests sit underneath it, clearly labelled, and only the indigo "To prepare" box adds the two together. The cook's board never shows any money. If no guests are declared for today, the amber and indigo blocks do not appear at all and the board looks exactly as it would without the feature.

10.7 Guests on the 5th (handover day)

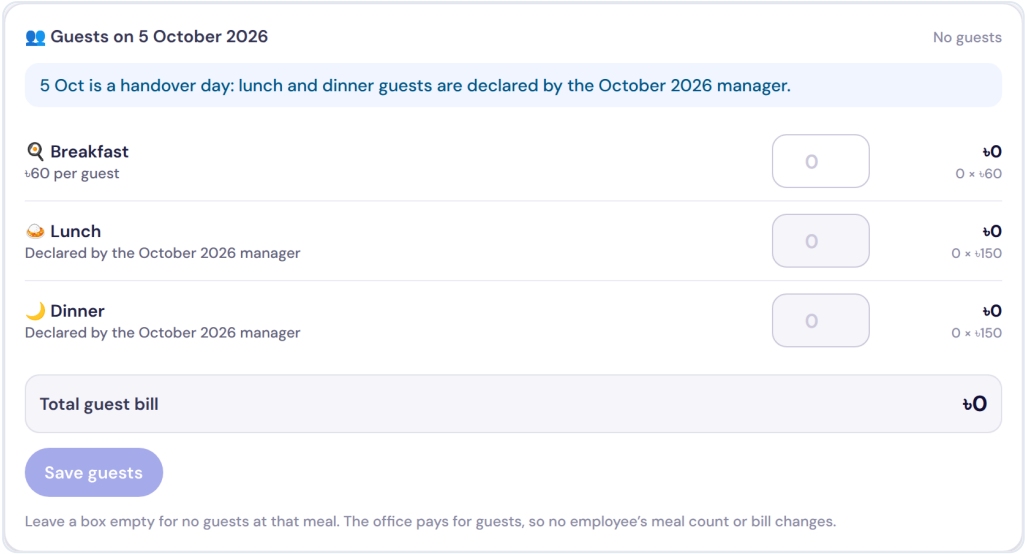


Figure 10.9 — 5 October seen by the **September** manager. Breakfast is theirs to declare; lunch and dinner are greyed out and labelled "Declared by the October 2026 manager." A blue strip above the boxes says the same thing in a sentence.

Each month keeps its own guest record for the 5th, so a date + meal still has exactly one guest count — and each month's guest bill contains only its own meals.

10.8 Empty state

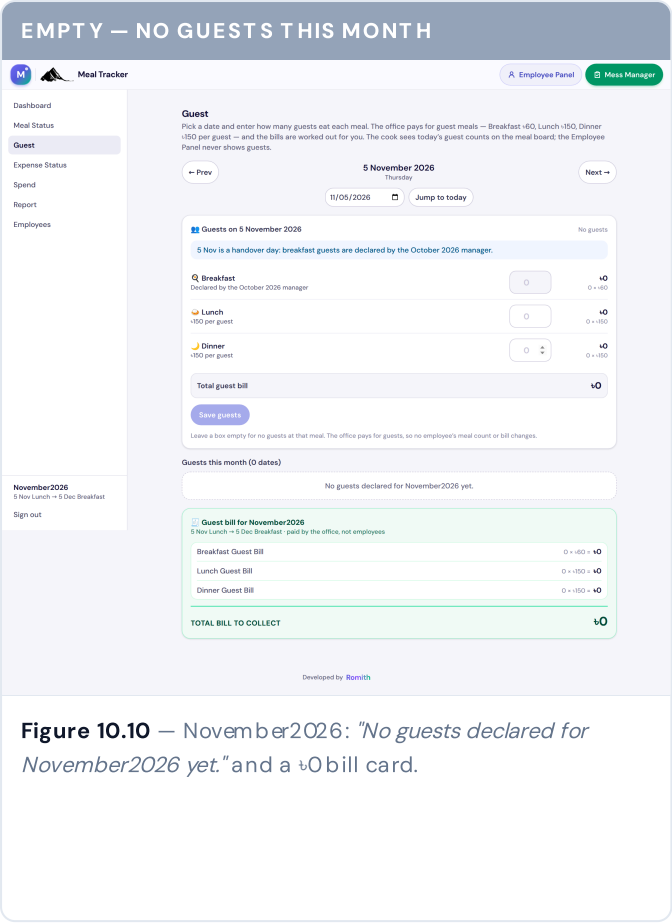


Figure 10.10 — November 2026: "No guests declared for November 2026 yet." and a 0 bill card.

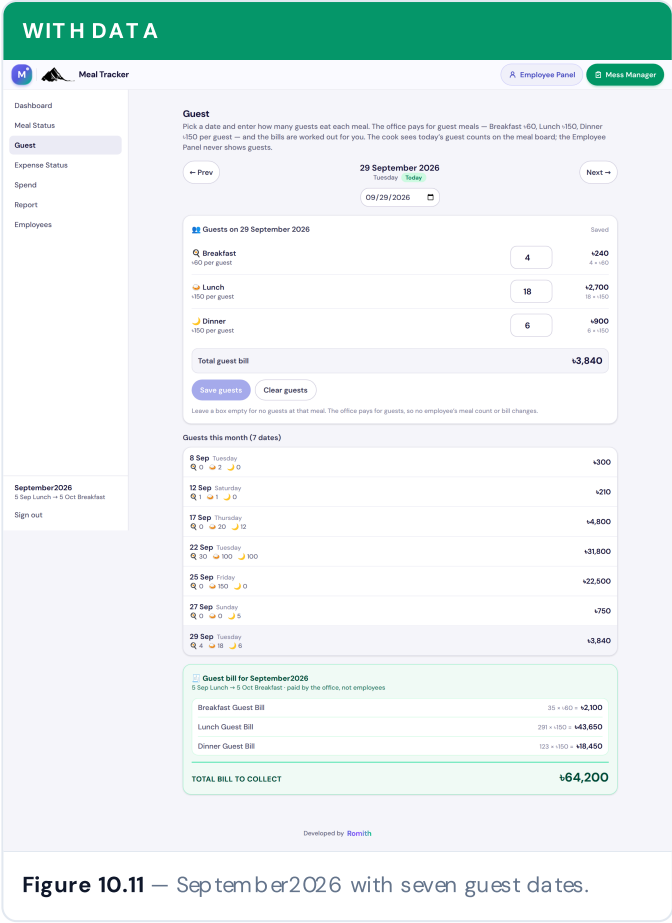


Figure 10.11 — September 2026 with seven guest dates.

What is different?

The entry form is **identical** and fully usable in both — you can declare guests on day one of a month. Below it, the list of dates is replaced by a dashed "no guests declared" box, the heading counter reads (**0 dates**), and the green card shows **0 × +60**, **0 × +150**, **0 × +150** and a total of **0**. The card never disappears — it is the month's running invoice and starts at zero.

One more detail worth knowing: because today (29 September) is outside November's period, the date navigator has opened on **5 November** — the first date the period owns. Every dated manager tab does this, so you always start somewhere you are allowed to type.

11 Dashboard Analytics

The Dashboard is the manager's one-screen answer to "where is this month?". It is a status card plus nine figures. There are no charts in this application — every figure is a single number with a label and a one-line hint telling you which period it covers.

11.1 The Dashboard, card by card

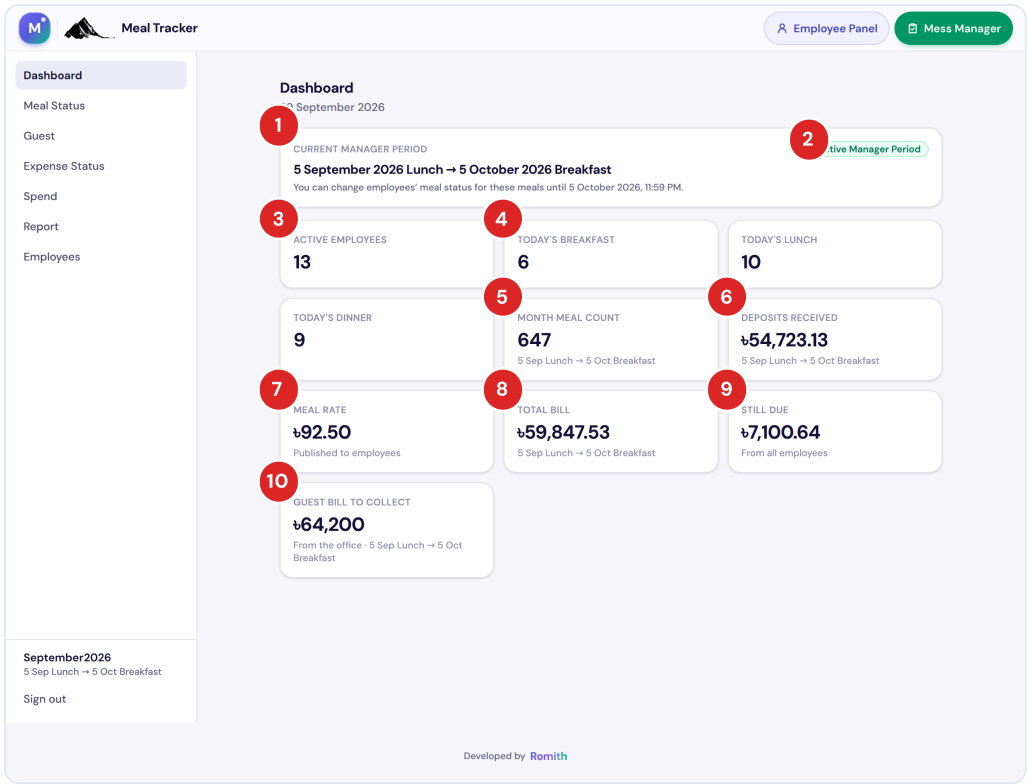


Figure 11.1 — The September 2026 Dashboard on 29 September.

#	CARD	WHERE T HE NUMBER COMES FROM	PERIOD IT COVERS
1	Manager period card	Your account's own period, read from the database.	Fixed: 5 Sep lunch → 5 Oct breakfast.
2	Status badge	Whether today falls inside the period.	Right now.
3	Active employees	How many employees are marked active on the shared list.	Right now — not tied to any month.
4	Today's breakfast / lunch / dinner	How many employees have that meal ON today.	Today only. Shows — when the meal belongs to the neighbouring month.
5	Month meal count	Every employee's weighted meal count added up.	The whole period, including meals already booked for days still to come.

6	Deposits received	Every deposit recorded in this month.	The whole period.
7	Meal rate	The rate currently being tested, with the publish state in the hint.	The whole period.
8	Total bill	Month meal count × meal rate.	The whole period. — until a rate is set.
9	Still due	The dues only, added up (refunds are not netted off).	The whole period. — until a rate is set.
10	Guest bill to collect	The Guest tab's total, recalculated from the guest counts.	The whole period. Owed by the <i>office</i> , not by employees.

11.2 Reading each figure properly

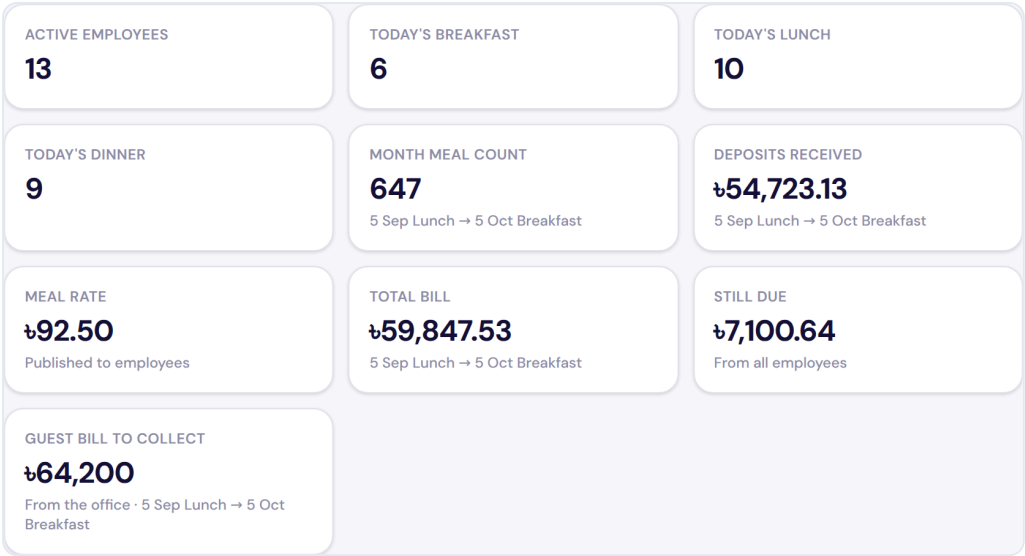


Figure 11.2 — The nine figures, close up.

CARD	WHAT IT IS TELLING YOU
Active employees — 13	The size of the mess right now. It does not change when the month changes, and it drops the moment somebody is deactivated. (The office has 14 people on the list; one is inactive.)
Today's breakfast — 6 Today's lunch — 10 Today's dinner — 9	Exactly what the cook's board shows, minus guests. Use these to sanity-check the kitchen at a glance. They change live as employees tap, until each deadline passes.
Month meal count — 647	The single most important operational number: it is the divisor when you work out the meal rate. It rises during the month and includes meals booked ahead, so late in the month it is close to final.
Deposits received — ¥54,723.13	Cash actually in hand for this month. Compare it with Total bill to see how much collecting is left.
Meal rate — ¥92.50	The hint under it is the important part. See the table in 11.3.

Total bill — ₺59,847.53	What the mess will collect from employees at the current rate. Compare with Total monthly spending on the Spend tab (₺59,900) to see whether the rate covers costs.
Still due — ₺7,100.64	The sum of every <i>negative</i> balance. Employees who overpaid are not subtracted — so this is literally "cash still to collect", not a net position.
Guest bill to collect — ₺64,200	Invoice the office for this. It is not part of Total bill and never affects an employee.

Still due is a collection target, not a profit figure

In this month ₺7,100.64 is due and ₺1,976.24 is owed back as refunds (visible in the Expense Status footer). The Dashboard shows only the first number, because the manager's job is to collect it. To see both together, look at the footer row of Expense Status or Report.

11.3 The Meal rate card's hint — four possible states

VALUE SHOWN	HINT UNDERNEATH	MEANING
—	<i>Not set yet</i>	No rate has been entered. Bills are dashes everywhere.
₺95	<i>Testing — not published</i>	You are trying a rate. Employees see nothing at all.
₺92.50	<i>Published to employees</i>	The tested and published rates match. This is the settled state.
₺95	<i>Testing · published ₺92.50</i>	You are experimenting <i>after</i> publishing. Employees still see ₺92.50 until you publish again.

11.4 Do the numbers update by themselves?

CARD	REFRESH BEHAVIOUR
Today's breakfast / lunch / dinner	Recalculated every time you open or reload the Dashboard. They do not auto-refresh while you watch — only the public meal board does that (every 60 seconds).
Month meal count, Deposits, Total bill, Still due, Guest bill	Recalculated from the underlying records on every page load. They are never cached, so they cannot be stale.
Meal rate	Changes the instant you press Test or Publish.

11.5 The Dashboard in the other two period states

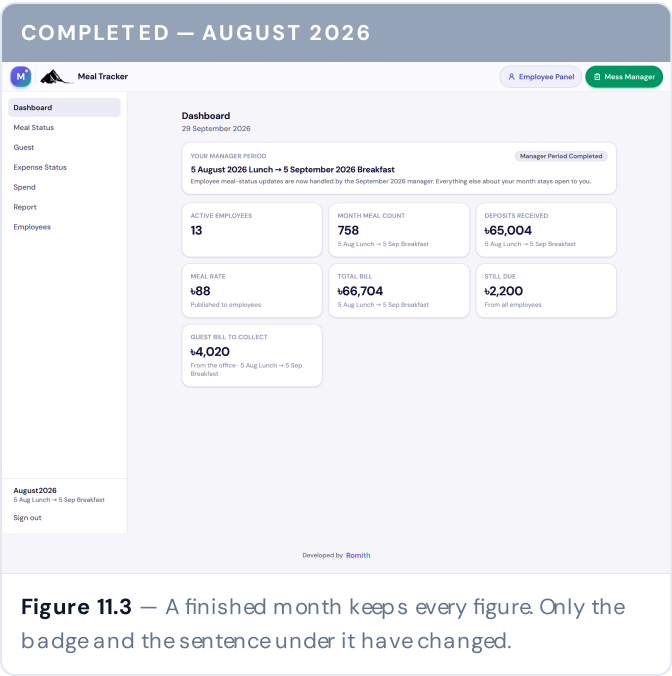


Figure 11.3 — A finished month keeps every figure. Only the badge and the sentence under it have changed.

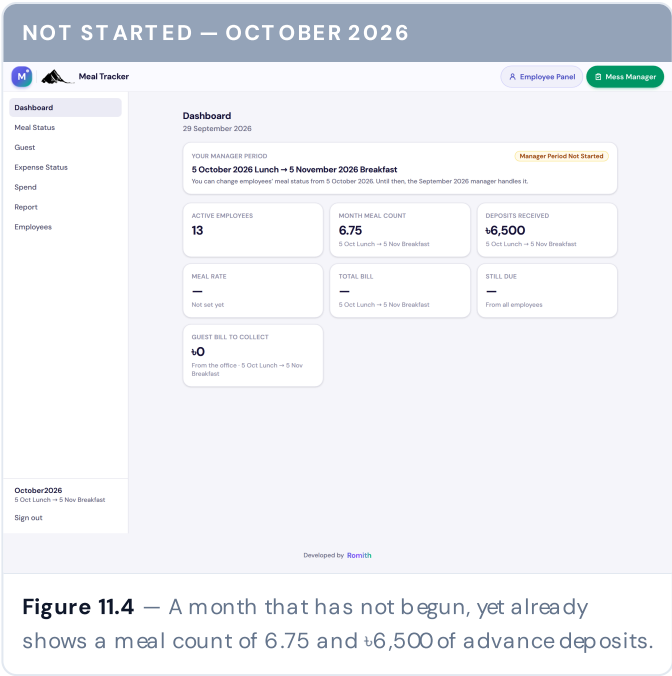


Figure 11.4 — A month that has not begun, yet already shows a meal count of 6.75 and ¥6,500 of advance deposits.

What is different?

- **August (completed)** — all nine figures are still populated, because the month happened. "Today's breakfast/lunch/dinner" are **absent entirely**: today is not inside that period, so there is no "today" to report.
- **October (not started)** — the same three cards are absent for the same reason. Total bill and Still due are dashes because no rate has been set, and Guest bill is ¥0. But two figures are already alive: **Deposits received ¥6,500** (two employees paid in advance) and **Month meal count 6.75** — three employees have already switched on 5 October's lunch and dinner, which are October's meals: $3 \times (1.25 + 1.00) = 6.75$. A month starts filling up before its first day.

11.6 Empty state

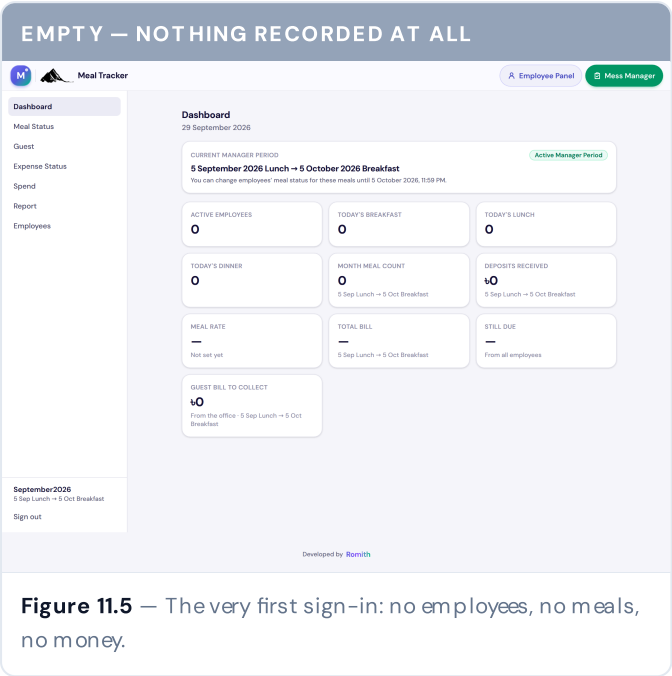


Figure 11.5 — The very first sign-in: no employees, no meals, no money.

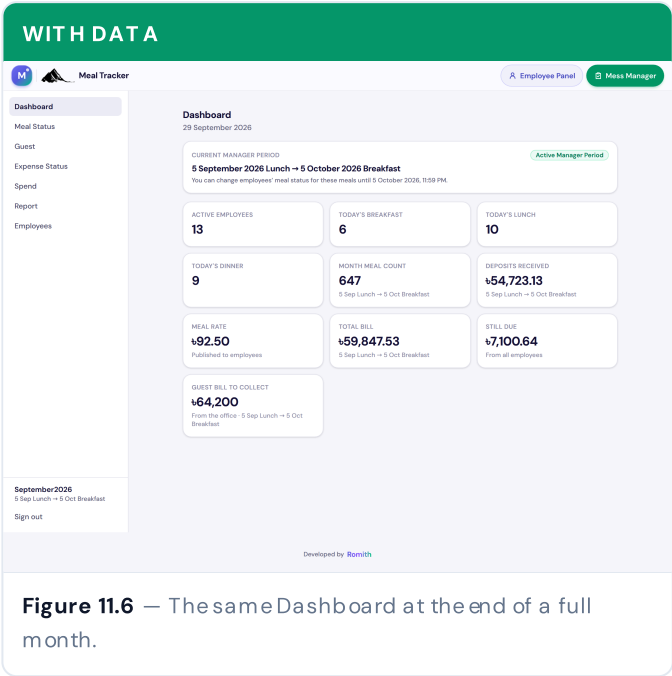


Figure 11.6 — The same Dashboard at the end of a full month.

What is different?

- The layout is identical — **no card disappears**, and no "nothing here yet" message is shown.
- Counts read **0**; money reads **¥0**; Meal rate, Total bill and Still due read **—**.
- The Meal rate hint reads *Not set yet* rather than *Published to employees*.
- The period card and its **Active Manager Period** badge look exactly the same, because the period exists from the moment the account is created.

A zero here means "nothing has been recorded", never "something failed". If a figure genuinely cannot be loaded, the Dashboard says so in a red box with a **Try again** button instead of showing a zero.

12

Empty States

An empty screen in this application always means "nothing has been recorded yet" — never "something broke". Failures look completely different: a red box with a **Try again** button. This section shows every empty state so nobody ever has to guess.

YOU SEE...	IT MEANS
Dashed box with a grey sentence	No records of this kind exist yet. Normal. The sentence usually tells you what to do next.
0 or 0.0	The records exist but add up to nothing.
— (a dash)	The number cannot be worked out yet — almost always because no meal rate has been set.
Amber strip	A rule is stopping you: outside your mess month, period not started, deadline passed.
Red box + Try again	A genuine failure (usually the connection). Not an empty state. Your saved data is safe.

12.1

No employees yet

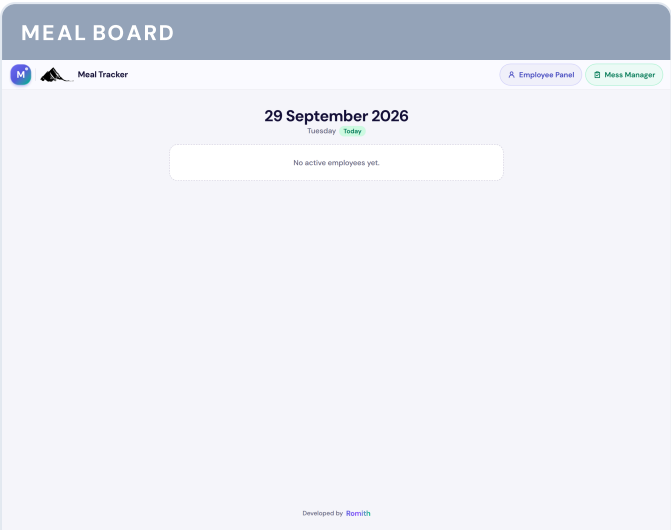


Figure 12.1 — "No active employees yet." The date header still shows, so the cook knows the page loaded.

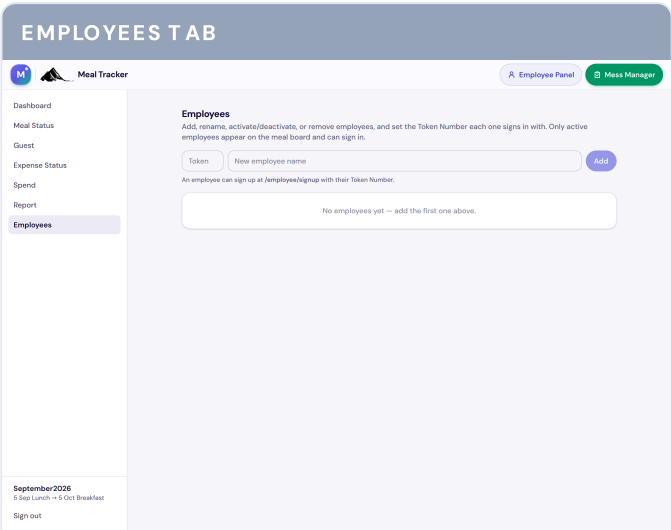


Figure 12.2 — "No employees yet — add the first one above."

Why it appears: a brand-new installation, or every employee has been deactivated. **What to do:** a mess manager adds people on the Employees tab (Section 7.2).

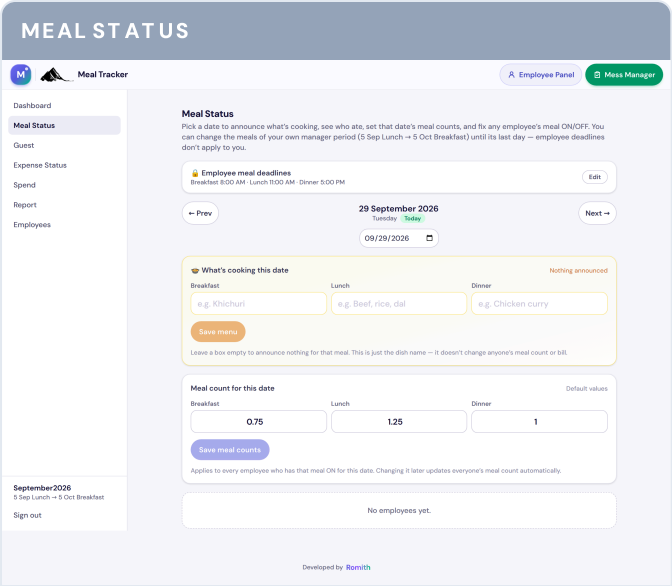


Figure 12.3 — “No employees yet.” in place of the sheet; the date’s menu and meal counts are still editable.

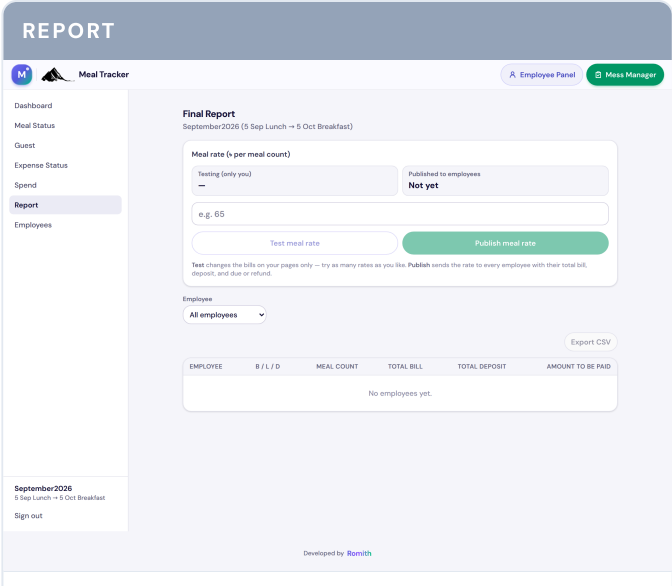


Figure 12.4 — “No employees yet.” across the table, and Export CSV is greyed out because there is nothing to export.

12.2 No meals recorded

There is no separate “no meals” screen. A date on which nobody has chosen anything simply shows every button OFF, and the **Total ON** row reads 0 / 0 / 0 with a meal count of 0. On the employee's side the same thing shows as three OFF buttons (Figures 4.5 and 4.6). This is deliberate: “no record” and “not eating” are the same statement.

12.3 No guest meals

MMeal Tracker

Dashboard

Meal Status

Guest

Expense Status

Spend

Report

Employees

November2026

5 Nov Lunch → 5 Dec Breakfast

Sign out

Employee Panel

Mess Manager

Guest

Pick a date and enter how many guests eat each meal. The office pays for guest meals — Breakfast ₪60, Lunch ₪150, Dinner ₪150 per guest — and the bills are worked out for you. The cook sees today's guest counts on the meal board; the Employee Panel never shows guests.

← Prev

5 November 2026
Thursday

Next →

11/05/2026

Jump to today

👤 Guests on 5 November 2026

No guests

5 Nov is a handover day: breakfast guests are declared by the October 2026 manager.

🔍 Breakfast

Declared by the October 2026 manager

0

₪0

0 × ₪60

🍽️ Lunch

₪150 per guest

0

₪0

0 × ₪150

🍲 Dinner

₪150 per guest

0

₪0

0 × ₪150

Total guest bill

₪0

Save guests

Leave a box empty for no guests at that meal. The office pays for guests, so no employee's meal count or bill changes.

Guests this month (0 dates)

No guests declared for November2026 yet.

📄 Guest bill for November2026

5 Nov Lunch → 5 Dec Breakfast - paid by the office, not employees

Breakfast Guest Bill

0 × ₪60 = ₪0

Lunch Guest Bill

0 × ₪150 = ₪0

Dinner Guest Bill

0 × ₪150 = ₪0

TOTAL BILL TO COLLECT

₪0

Developed by Romith

Figure 12.5 — “No guests declared for November2026 yet,” the heading counter reads (0 dates), and the green card totals ₪0 with its workings shown as 0 × ₪60 and so on. The entry form above is fully usable — this is where you break the empty state.

Meal Tracker 0.1.0 · September 2026

Page 74 of 108

12.4 No spending

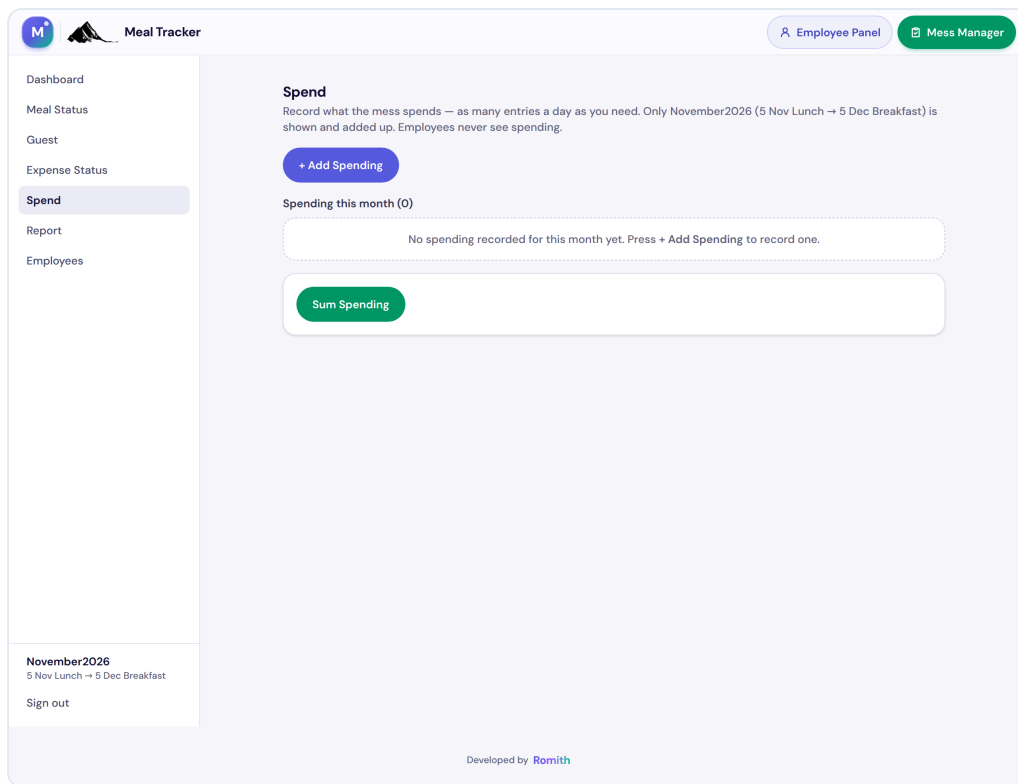


Figure 12.6 — “No spending recorded for this month yet. Press + **Add Spending** to record one.” The heading reads **Spending this month (0)** and **Sum Spending** still works — pressing it returns 0 over 0 entries.

12.5 No deposits and no meal rate

Meal Tracker Employee Panel Mess Manager

Dashboard
Meal Status
Guest
Expense Status
Spend
Report
Employees

Expense Status
Record money employees hand in — before, during, or at the end of the month — and see who still owes and who has money left.

Record a deposit

Employee name: Deposit amount (v):

Date received: Note (optional):

Add deposit

Meal rate (v per meal count)

Testing (only you): Published to employees: **Not yet**

e.g. 65

Test meal rate **Publish meal rate**

Test changes the bills on your pages only — try as many rates as you like. Publish sends the rate to every employee with their total bill, deposit, and due or refund.

Bills appear once you test a meal rate above. Meal counts and deposits are already up to date. Employees see a rate and bill only after you publish.

EMPLOYEE	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	0	—	0	—
102 Tanvir Hasan	0	—	0	—
103 Nusrat Jahan	0	—	0	—
104 Sabbir Rahman	0	—	0	—
105 Mehedi Hasan	0	—	0	—
106 Farhana Akter	0	—	0	—
107 Imran Kabir	0	—	0	—
108 Sadia Islam	0	—	0	—
109 Rakib Hossain	0	—	0	—
110 Jannatul Ferdous	0	—	0	—
111 Arif Mahmud	0	—	0	—
113 Mizanur Rahman	0	—	0	—
Rafiq Chowdhury	0	—	0	—
Total	0	—	0	—

Deposit history (0)

No deposits recorded yet.

November 2026
5 Nov Lunch → 5 Dec Breakfast
Sign out

Developed by Romith

Figure 12.7 — Expense Status for a month that has not started. Three empty states stacked: the amber strip explaining that bills need a rate, a table of real employees with zeros and dashes, and **Deposit history (0)** — “No deposits recorded yet.”

Why the table is not empty

The bill table always lists every active employee, even with no data. That is not a bug: the list of people is a fact about the office, while their meals and money are facts about the month. Seeing the names with zeros is how you confirm the month is set up correctly.

12.6 No monthly data (Dashboard and Report)

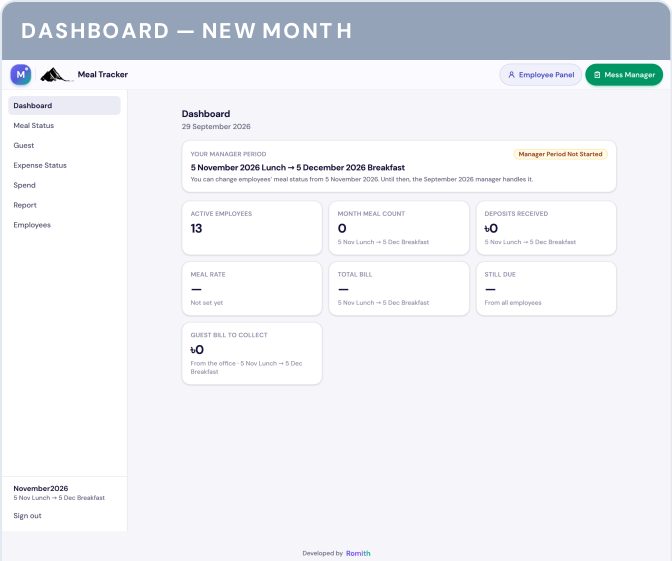


Figure 12.8 — Every card is present; counts are 0, money is 0, and rate/bill/due are dashes.

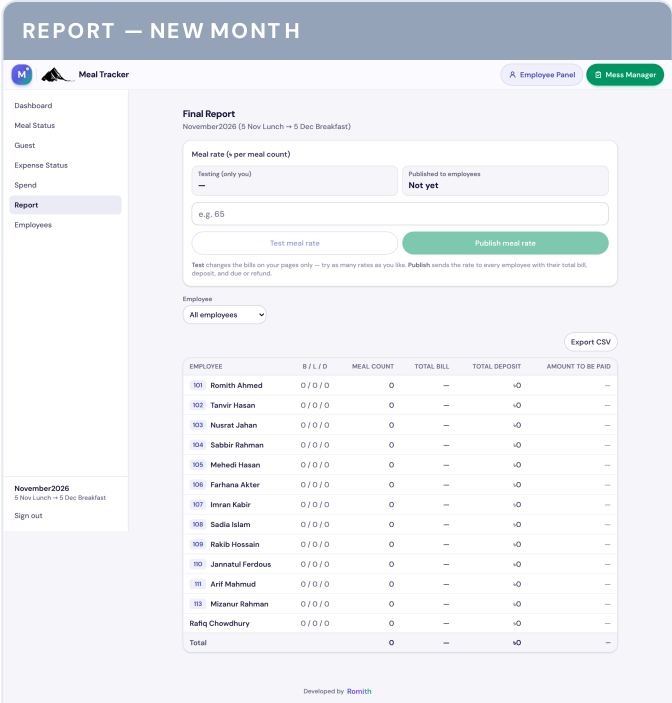


Figure 12.9 — Employees listed with 0/0/0 meals, dashes for bills, and a Total row of zeros.

12.7 An employee's empty month

←

June 2026
5 Jun – 5 Jul 2026

→

Meals I had

0
Breakfast

0
Lunch

0
Dinner

Tap a meal to see the dates.

Your meal count uses the default meal counts: **Breakfast 0.75 · Lunch 1.25 · Dinner 1**. The mess manager can increase the meal count for a day with a special meal — if that happens, your meal count increases automatically.

Total meal count

0

Past meals only.

My deposit

Total deposit

₹0

No deposits recorded for this month.

My bill

The mess manager hasn't published this month's meal rate yet. Your bill will show here once it's published.

Bill calculator

Dummy meal rate

Try a meal rate to see what your bill for your past meals would be. Only you can see it: it stays on this phone under your account, is never sent to anyone, is erased when you sign out, and doesn't change the real meal rate.

₹ e.g. 60

per meal

Estimated bill

Enter a rate

My deposit

₹0

Estimated result

—

No mess manager has opened this month yet, so the meal count uses the standard counts.

Figure 12.10 — June 2026 for an employee who was not in the mess then. Counters 0, "No deposits recorded for this month.", a dashed **My bill** box, and the grey footnote "No mess manager has opened this month yet, so the meal count uses the standard counts." Tapping a counter would show "No lunch this month."

12.8 Summary — every empty state in one table

WHERE	EXACT WORDING	WHAT TO DO NEXT
Meal board	No active employees yet.	Manager adds employees.

Employees tab	<i>No employees yet — add the first one above.</i>	Use the form at the top.
Meal Status sheet	<i>No employees yet.</i>	Same.
Expense Status / Report table	<i>No employees yet.</i>	Same.
Deposit history	<i>No deposits recorded yet.</i>	Record one above when cash comes in.
Guest month list	<i>No guests declared for <Month> yet.</i>	Nothing, unless guests are expected.
Spend table	<i>No spending recorded for this month yet. Press + Add Spending to record one.</i>	Add the first bazar entry.
Employee — My deposit	<i>No deposits recorded for this month.</i>	Hand cash to the mess manager.
Employee — My bill	<i>The mess manager hasn't published this month's meal rate yet. Your bill will show here once it's published.</i>	Wait for month end; use the calculator meanwhile.
Employee — meal dates	<i>No <meal> this month.</i>	Nothing — you had none.
Employee — unmanaged month	<i>No mess manager has opened this month yet, so the meal count uses the standard counts.</i>	Nothing.
Expense Status, no rate	<i>Bills appear once you test a meal rate above...</i>	Test a rate.

12.9 What a real failure looks like

Empty states are calm and grey. Failures are red and offer a retry.

MESSAGE	WHEN
Could not load dashboard stats. / Could not load meal records. / Could not load expense status. / Could not load the report. / Could not load guest meals. / Could not load spending. / Could not load employees.	One part of a page could not be fetched. Shown in a red strip with Try again . The rest of the page still works.
Something went wrong while loading this page — usually a dropped connection. Your saved data is safe.	The whole page failed. A Try again button reloads it in place.
Can't load your mess month / Can't load your account	The session loaded but the month or employee behind it could not be read. Retry, then sign out and in.
Couldn't save a meal (outlined in red). Check your connection and tap it again.	A meal toggle failed. The value was rolled back — tap it again.
Couldn't load today's guests, so these counts are employees only.	On the meal board: the employee counts are right, the guest counts are missing. Ask the manager whether guests are expected.

12.10 And what "loading" looks like

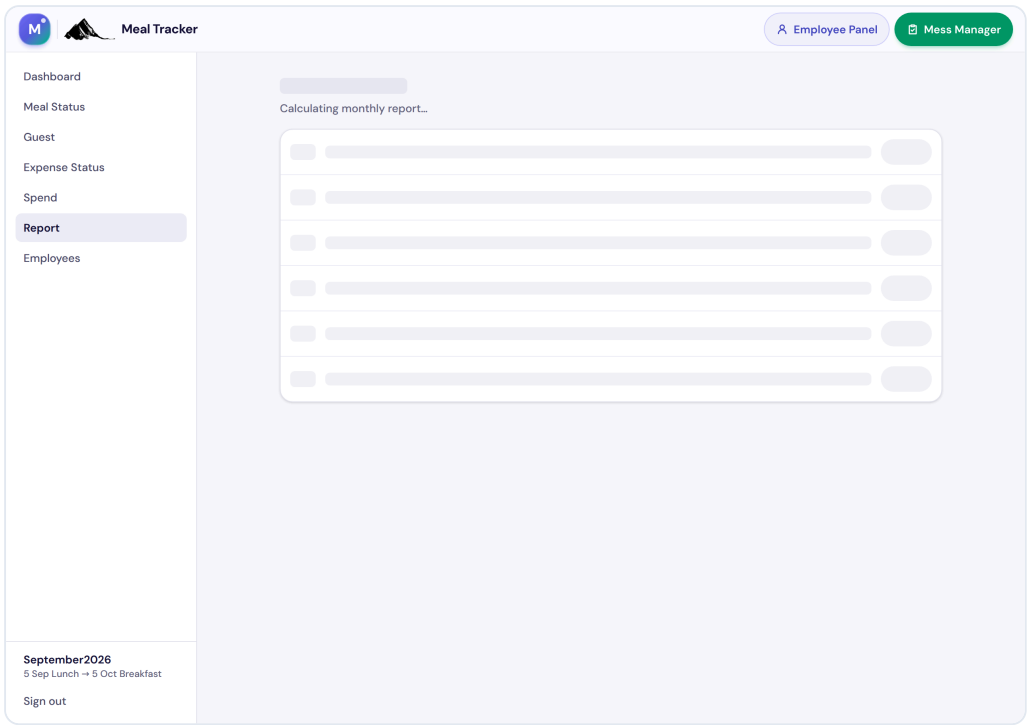


Figure 12.11 — Moving to a tab whose data is still arriving: a grey skeleton of the table plus a status line (here "Calculating monthly report..."). It appears instantly so the app never looks frozen, and is replaced by real content as soon as the data lands. A skeleton that never resolves means the connection dropped — the red box above will follow.

Each screen has its own wording, so the message doubles as confirmation that you pressed the right tab:

SCREEN	LOADING MESSAGE
Meal board (/)	<i>Loading employees...</i>
Employee Panel	<i>Loading...</i>
Mess Manager Panel (entering)	<i>Opening Mess Manager...</i>
Dashboard	<i>Loading dashboard...</i>
Meal Status	<i>Loading meal status...</i>
Guest	<i>Loading guest meals...</i>
Expense Status	<i>Loading deposits and balances...</i>
Spend	<i>Loading spending...</i>
Report	<i>Calculating monthly report...</i>
Employees	<i>Loading employees...</i>

13 Status, Colour & Icon Guide

The application uses a small, consistent visual vocabulary. Learn these twenty signs and every screen becomes readable at a glance.

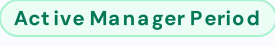
13.1 Colours and what they always mean

COLOUR	USED FOR	NEVER USED FOR
Indigo	ON, the active choice, primary buttons, the Employee Panel.	Warnings.
Emerald	Money coming back (refunds), published things, confirmations, the Mess Manager Panel, ticks on the meal board.	Errors.
Slate / grey	OFF, inactive, settled, historical, "nothing here yet".	Anything urgent.
Amber	A rule is stopping you: deadlines passed, date outside your month, period not started. Also guest counts on the cook's board and the "what's cooking" card.	Failures.
Red	Money owed, destructive buttons (Remove, Delete), and genuine failures.	Ordinary information.
Sky blue	Handover-day explanations on the 5th.	Anything else.

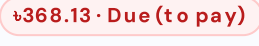
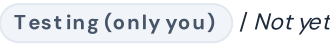
13.2 Meal buttons

VISUAL	MEANING	WHAT YOU SHOULD DO
 solid indigo	Eating this meal; still changeable.	Nothing, unless your plan changes.
 pale grey	Not eating; still changeable.	Tap it if you will be eating.
	Eating, and locked — you are being billed for it.	Ask the mess manager if this is wrong.
	Not eating, and locked.	Ask the mess manager if you need it added.
...	Saving right now.	Wait half a second.
Red outline	The save failed and the value was rolled back.	Check your connection and tap again.

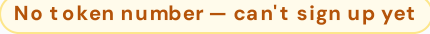
13.3 Manager period badges

BADGE	MEANING	WHAT YOU CAN DO
	Today is inside your month.	Everything, including changing employees' meals.
	Your month begins later.	Meal counts, guests, deposits, spending. Not meal ON/OFF.
	Your month is over.	Everything except meal ON/OFF — forever.

13.4 Money statuses

VISUAL	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
	Bill > deposits.	Manager: collect it. Employee: pay it.
	Deposits > bill.	Manager: refund or carry forward.
	Exactly equal.	Nothing.
—	No meal rate set, so no bill exists.	Manager: test a rate.
	Employees can see this rate and their bills.	Nothing.
	Private to the manager / never published.	Publish when final.

13.5 Employee statuses

VISUAL	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
	The token has a login.	Nothing. Reset login if the password is lost.
	Nobody has claimed the token.	Ask the employee to visit /employee/signup .
	No token assigned.	Press Edit and give them one.
 + struck-through name	Deactivated.	Activate if they are back.
 token badge	The employee's Token Number.	It is also their username.

13.6 Icons and symbols

ICON	WHERE	MEANING
	Meal board, Guest tab, meal lists	Breakfast.
	Same	Lunch.
	Same	Dinner.
	Meal buttons, meal-date chips, deadline settings, finished periods	Cannot be changed from here.
	Meal Status notice	Your manager period has not started.
	Employee "My bill"	The meal rate has been published.
	Meal Status	"What's cooking this date."
	Guest tab	Guests on this date.
	Guest tab	The month's guest bill.
	Meal board	This employee is eating this meal.
	Meal board	This employee is not eating this meal.
	Date navigators and the meal board	The date shown is today (Bangladesh time).
Not yours	Meal Status / Guest on the 5th	That meal belongs to the neighbouring month's manager.

13.7 The meal board's three blocks

BLOCK	COLOUR	MEANING
Big number at the top	Black on white	Employee meals — how many staff are eating.
Middle block	Amber	Guests — declared by the mess manager. Appears only when guests exist today.
Bottom block	Indigo, white text	To prepare — employees + guests. The number the cook cooks to.

No guests today? The board looks like it always did

The amber and indigo blocks are drawn only when at least one guest is declared for today, so a normal day shows just the three plate counts.

14 Role & Permission Guide

Three roles exist: the **public visitor** (the cook), the **employee**, and the **mess manager**. Every rule below is enforced inside the database, so it holds even if someone edits a URL, replays a form, or calls the API directly.

14.1 Feature-by-feature comparison

FEAT URE	PUBLIC (NO LOGIN)	EMPLOYEE	MESS MANAGER
Today's meal board (plate counts, ticks)	View	View	View
Today's guest counts on the board	View	View	View
Any other date's meal sheet	—	Own meals only	View all
Own meals ON/OFF — today before the deadline	—	Edit	Edit anyone's
Own meals ON/OFF — today after the deadline	—	Locked	Edit anyone's
Own meals ON/OFF — any past date	—	Locked	Own running period only
Own meals ON/OFF — any future date	—	Edit	Own running period only
Another employee's meals	—	Never	Edit (own period)
Announced dish for a date	—	View	Edit (any date)
Employee meal deadlines	—	View	Edit (office-wide)
Meal counts / weights for a date	—	See the defaults quoted	Edit (own period's dates)
Own meal history and totals	—	View	View everyone's
Own deposits	—	View	Add / remove (own month)
Another employee's deposits or bill	—	Never	View (own month)
Meal rate — test	—	—	Yes (own month)
Meal rate — publish / unpublish	—	—	Yes (own month)
Own published bill and due/refund	—	View	View everyone's

Private "dummy rate" calculator	—	Use	—
Guest counts and guest bills	Today's counts only	Never	Edit (own period's meals)
Mess spending	—	Never	Add / edit / delete (own month)
Monthly report + CSV export	—	—	Own month
Employee list — add / rename / token	—	—	Yes (shared by all months)
Activate / deactivate an employee	—	—	Yes
Reset an employee's login	—	—	Yes
Delete an employee	—	—	Only if they have no meals and no deposits
Another month's data	—	—	Never

14.2 The historical-data rule

WHO	CAN THEY CHANGE HISTORY?
Employee	No. A past date is refused outright. The only route is to ask a mess manager.
The month's own manager, while running	Yes — any meal of their own period, any date within it, ignoring deadlines.
The month's own manager, after it ends	No. Meals become a read-only record; everything else about the month stays editable forever.
Any other month's manager	No — they cannot even read another month's data.

The one shared thing

The **employee list** is office-wide, not per month: any manager account — past, present or future — can add, rename, deactivate or reset a login. Agree changes before making them.

14.3 What is blocked at the database, not just on screen

- An employee writing another employee's meal row.
- Anyone writing a meal on a past date, or today after its deadline (managers excepted).
- A manager writing a meal outside their own running period — one forbidden meal rejects the whole write.
- A manager reading or writing another month's data, or changing any period's dates (only the meal rate fields can be updated).
- Deleting a login, a manager profile, a period, or an employee that still has records attached.
- A signed-out visitor reading deposits, bills, guest bills, spending or anyone's phone number.

A padlock or a greyed-out field is only reflecting a rule the database would enforce anyway.

15 The Monthly Workflow

One mess month from beginning to end, in the order things actually happen. The example throughout is September 2026: **5 September lunch → 5 October breakfast**.

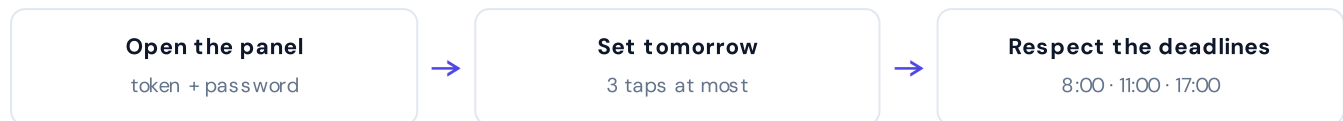
BEFORE THE MONTH STARTS — any time before the 5th

1. **The team signs up once** at `/admin/signup` as `September2026` and shares the password (Section 2.4).
2. **Check the employee list**. Add joiners with their Token Numbers, deactivate leavers, reset any lost logins (Section 7).
3. **Chase sign-ups**. Anyone still marked `Not signed up` cannot set their own meals.
4. **Collect advance deposits** if that is your office's habit — Expense Status accepts them before the month begins (Figure 9.10).
5. **Confirm the deadlines**. Meal Status →  Employee meal deadlines.

Your Dashboard reads `Manager Period Not Started` throughout. That is expected: everything except employees' meal ON/OFF is already yours.

DURING THE MONTH — 5 September to 5 October

Every day (employees, 10 seconds):



Every day (mess manager, 2 minutes):

1. **Announce the dish** on Meal Status →  What's cooking this date.
2. **Glance at the Dashboard** — today's breakfast/lunch/dinner tell the cook what to expect.
3. **Fix any corrections** employees ask for, on the date in question (Section 8.4).
4. **Declare guests** the moment you hear about them — the cook's board picks them up within a minute (Section 10.3).
5. **Record the bazar** on the Spend tab, same day, with the name of whoever paid.
6. **Record deposits** as cash comes in, with a note (Cash / bKash / ...).

Occasionally: raise a date's meal count for a special meal — a biryani night at dinner 200 (Section 8.2). Do it on the day, not at month end, so nobody is surprised.

END OF THE MONTH — from 5 October

1. **Close the meal data.** Walk the last few days on Meal Status and settle any outstanding corrections. After 5 October, 11:59 PM this becomes impossible.

2. **Total the spending.** Spend → **Sum Spending** → **TOTAL MONTHLY SPENDING ₺59,900.**

3. **Read the month meal count.** Dashboard → **647.**

4. **Work out the rate.** ₺59,900 ÷ 647 = ₺92.58 → round to **₺92.50.**

5. **Test it.** Expense Status → type 92.5 → **Test meal rate.** Nobody else sees anything yet.

6. **Check the table.** Total bill ₺59,847.53 against ₺59,900 spent — close enough. Try ₺93 or ₺95 if you want the mess to end in surplus (Figure 9.7).

7. **Publish it. Publish meal rate** → confirm. Every employee's **My bill** fills in within seconds with their rate, bill, deposit and due or refund.

8. **Collect and refund.** Work down the **Amount to be Paid** column; record each payment as a deposit, and watch the red rows turn to **Fully settled**.

9. **Invoice the office** for the guest bill — ₺64,200 (Guest tab, Figure 10.7).

10. **Export the CSV** from Report and file it. That is the month's permanent record.

11. **Hand over.** On the 5th the incoming team takes the lunch and dinner; you keep the breakfast, and you keep everything else about your month forever.

15.1 The handover day, hour by hour

5 OCTOBER	WHOSE MEAL	WHO MAY CHANGE IT
Breakfast	September	The September manager (their last act).
Lunch	October	The October manager (their first act).
Dinner	October	The October manager.

Both managers are "active" all day, each for their own meals only. Each month also keeps its own meal-count row and its own guest row for the 5th, so the day is split cleanly down the middle with no double-counting. A spending entry dated the 5th may be recorded by either month — but only once.

15.2 What survives into the next month

THING	CARRIED OVER?
Employee list, tokens, logins	Yes — it is office-wide and never resets.
Meal deadlines	Yes — one office-wide setting.
Meal counts / weights	No — each month sets its own, and unset dates use the defaults.
Meal rate	No — every month calculates its own from its own spending.
Deposits, dues, refunds	No — each month's money is its own. A refund can be re-recorded as an advance deposit in the new month.
Guests, spending, reports	No — strictly per month.
Employees' meal choices	No — nothing is copied forward. Everyone starts the new month with every meal OFF until they choose.

The one deadline a manager must not miss

Employee meal ON/OFF becomes uneditable at **11:59 PM on the period's last day** — 5 October for September's team. Every other task (rate, collection, refunds, reports, CSV) can be done at leisure afterwards. Settle the meal data first, then take your time over the money.

16

Common User Scenarios

Scenario 1 — "I want lunch tomorrow"

Situation. It is Tuesday evening. Romith will be in the office tomorrow and wants breakfast, lunch and dinner.

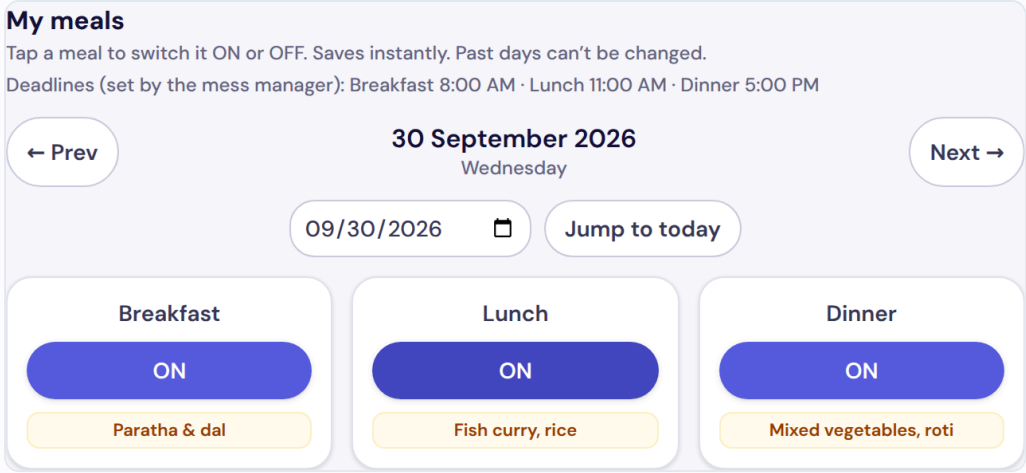


Figure 16.1 — 30 September, all three meals ON and still editable.

Steps.

1. Open `/employee` and sign in with the Token Number.
2. Press **Next** → once — the date becomes 30 September and the "Today" badge disappears.
3. Tap any meal that is not already ON. Each tap saves instantly.
4. There is no banner and no padlock, because future dates are always editable.

Result. Romith is counted in tomorrow's plate count from the moment he taps. He can change his mind any time up to 8:00 AM for breakfast, 11:00 AM for lunch and 5:00 PM for dinner tomorrow.

Scenario 2 — "I forgot to cancel breakfast before the deadline"

Situation. It is 9:30 AM. Breakfast was ON but Romith did not come in. The 8:00 AM deadline has passed.

The screenshot shows the 'My meals' app interface. At the top, it says 'My meals' and provides instructions: 'Tap a meal to switch it ON or OFF. Saves instantly. Past days can't be changed.' Below this, it lists deadlines: 'Deadlines (set by the mess manager): Breakfast 8:00 AM · Lunch 11:00 AM · Dinner 11:00 PM'. The date is '29 September 2026', Tuesday, with 'Today' highlighted. Navigation buttons '← Prev' and 'Next →' are present. A date selector shows '09/29/2026'. An amber banner with a lock icon states: 'Breakfast, Lunch locked. The meal selection deadline has passed. Please contact the Mess Manager for corrections.' Below the banner, it says 'Change before: Dinner 11:00 PM'. There are three meal cards: 'Breakfast' with a locked 'ON' button and 'Khichuri & egg' below it; 'Lunch' with a locked 'ON' button and 'Beef bhuna, rice, dal' below it; and 'Dinner' with an 'ON' button and 'Chicken curry, rice' below it.

Figure 16.2 — The amber banner names the locked meals and tells him exactly what to do: "Please contact the Mess Manager for corrections."

Steps.

1. Romith cannot fix this himself — the button has a padlock and the database would refuse the change anyway.
2. He tells the mess manager, naming the date and the meal.
3. The manager opens **Meal Status**, navigates to that date, finds row 101 and taps **Breakfast** off.
4. Romith's meal count for that date drops by 0.75 immediately.

Result. Corrected — but only because the manager's period is still running. Ask on the day; after the period ends nobody can change it.

Scenario 3 — "I need to correct someone's meal"

Situation. Two employees tell the manager they were marked wrongly for 29 September.

EMPLOYEE	BREAKFAST × 0.75	LUNCH × 1.25	DINNER × 1	MEAL COUNT
101 Romith Ahmed	ON	ON	ON	3
102 Tanvir Hasan	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
103 Nusrat Jahan	OFF	ON	OFF	1.25
104 Sabbir Rahman	ON	ON	ON	3
105 Mehedi Hasan	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
106 Farhana Akter	ON	ON	OFF	2
107 Imran Kabir	OFF	OFF	ON	1
108 Sadia Islam	ON	ON	ON	3
109 Rakib Hossain	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
110 Jannatul Ferdous	ON	ON	ON	3
111 Arif Mahmud	ON	ON	ON	3
112 Shahriar Kabir Inactive	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
113 Mizanur Rahman	OFF	ON	ON	2.25
Rafiq Chowdhury	OFF	OFF	OFF	0
Total ON	6	10	9	26

Figure 16.3 — The manager's sheet. Every button is live; the meal count column and the Total ON row update as you tap.

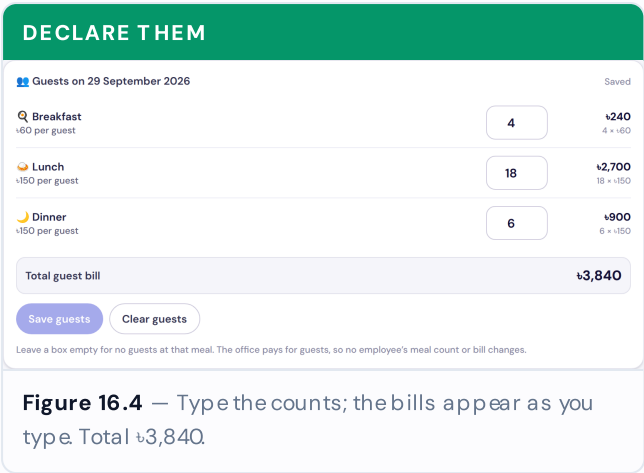
Steps.

1. **Meal Status** → set the date.
2. Find the rows by token badge (rows are ordered by token).
3. Tap the wrong meals. Each saves on its own; several taps in a row save in parallel.
4. Check the **Total ON** footer to confirm the day's count is what you expect.

Result. Fixed in seconds, with no Save button and no page reload. If a tap is refused — "That meal can't be changed from your account" — the meal belongs to another month or your period has just ended.

Scenario 4 — "Eighteen guests are coming for lunch"

Situation. A client team of 18 will eat lunch today, plus 4 at breakfast and 6 at dinner.



Scenario 5 — "I have paid, but it still says I owe money"

Situation. Romith deposited ₦6,500 over three payments, yet his panel shows ₦368.13 due.

 **The meal rate has been published**
The meal rate is ₦92.50. Your total bill is ₦6,868.13 and you have paid ₦6,500. Your due is ₦368.13.
Published 29 Sep 2026, 10:19 PM

Meal rate	₦92.50
Total bill	74.25 × ₦92.50 = ₦6,868.13
You have paid	₦6,500
Due	₦368.13

Counts every meal that's ON this month, the same as the mess manager's bill.

Figure 16.6 — The card shows the whole calculation, so the answer is on screen.

How to read it.

meal count 74.25 × meal rate ₦92.50 = total bill ₦6,868.13

you have paid = ₦6,500.00

due = ₦ 368.13

Paying is not the same as paying *enough*. Check the three deposits listed under **My deposit** — if one is missing, the manager has not recorded it yet.

Result. Hand ₦368.13 to the mess manager. They record it as a deposit, and the row turns to **Fully settled** on both screens.

Scenario 6 — "The dashboard is completely empty"

Situation. A new manager signs in and sees zeros everywhere.

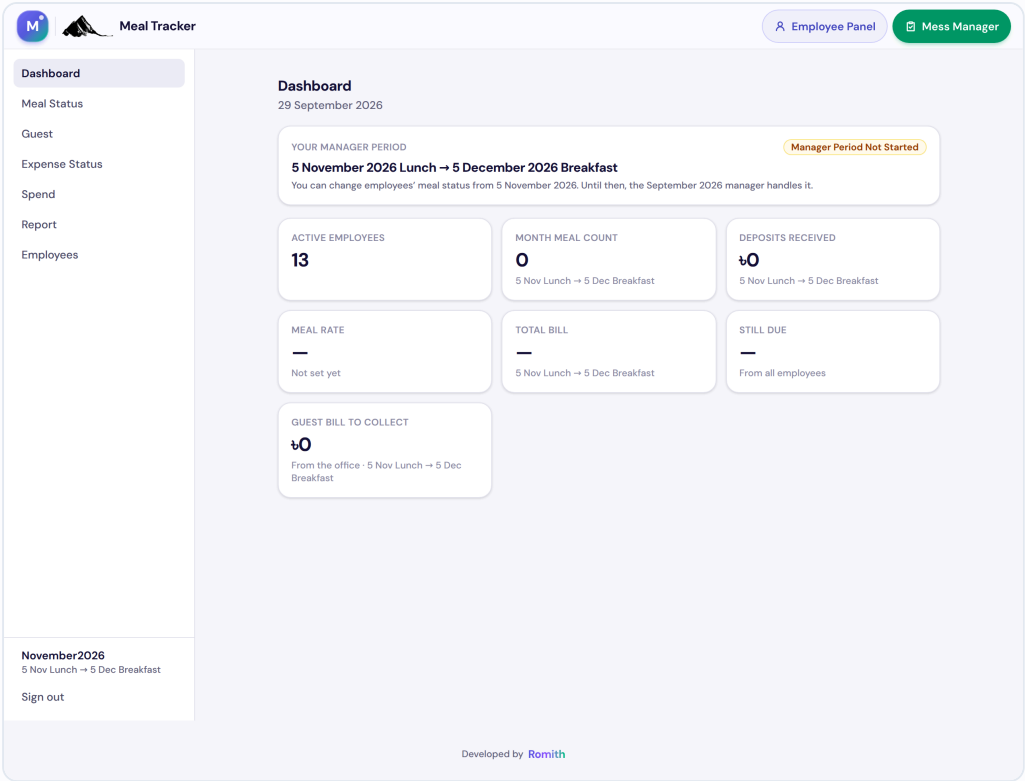


Figure 16.7 — Nothing is wrong. Every card is present; there is simply nothing recorded yet.

How to tell an empty month from a broken one.

EMPTY (NORMAL)	BROKEN (NEEDS ATTENTION)
Grey zeros and dashes, all cards present.	A red box: "Could not load dashboard stats." with a Try again button.
Badge shows a normal period state.	"Can't load your mess month" — the connection failed.

Result. Check the account footer to confirm you signed in as the right month, then start the month: add or check employees, and record the first bazar entry.

Scenario 7 — "Month end: review and close the bill"

Situation. It is 5 October. September's team must settle up.

EMPLOYEE	B / L / D	MEAL COUNT	TOTAL BILL	TOTAL DEPOSIT	AMOUNT TO BE PAID
101 Romith Ahmed	22 / 25 / 25	74.25	₹6,868.13	₹6,500	₹368.13 Due (to pay)
102 Tanvir Hasan	0 / 18 / 18	41.75	₹3,861.88	₹4,000	₹138.12 Remaining (refund)
103 Nusrat Jahan	0 / 22 / 0	27.75	₹2,566.88	₹2,500	₹66.88 Due (to pay)
104 Sabbir Rahman	27 / 27 / 27	82.5	₹7,631.25	₹7,000	₹631.25 Due (to pay)
105 Mehedi Hasan	0 / 12 / 12	28	₹2,590	₹3,000	₹410 Remaining (refund)
106 Farhana Akter	20 / 20 / 0	40.5	₹3,746.25	₹3,800	₹53.75 Remaining (refund)
107 Imran Kabir	0 / 0 / 25	26	₹2,405	₹2,000	₹405 Due (to pay)
108 Sadia Islam	18 / 18 / 18	55.5	₹5,133.75	₹0	₹5,133.75 Due (to pay)
109 Rakib Hossain	0 / 27 / 27	62	₹5,735	₹7,000	₹1,265 Remaining (refund)
110 Jannatul Ferdous	24 / 27 / 27	80.25	₹7,423.13	₹7,423.13	Fully settled
111 Arif Mahmud	15 / 15 / 15	46.5	₹4,301.25	₹4,000	₹301.25 Due (to pay)
112 Shahrar Kabir Inactive	15 / 16 / 0	31.25	₹2,890.63	₹3,000	₹109.37 Remaining (refund)
113 Mizanur Rahman	0 / 22 / 22	50.75	₹4,694.38	₹4,500	₹194.38 Due (to pay)
Rafiq Chowdhury	0 / 0 / 0	0	₹0	₹0	Fully settled
Total		647	₹59,847.53	₹54,723.13	₹7,100.64 due ₹1,976.24 remaining

Figure 16.8 — The Report table, with the footer row that closes the month: 647 meal count · ₹59,847.53 billed · ₹54,723.13 deposited · ₹7,100.64 due · ₹1,976.24 remaining.

Steps.

1. **Spend** → **Sum Spending** → ₹59,900 spent over 15 entries.
2. **Dashboard** → month meal count 647.
3. $₹59,900 \div 647 = ₹92.58$ → test **92.5** on Expense Status and check the table.
4. **Publish meal rate** → confirm. Employees see their bills immediately.
5. Work down **Amount to be Paid**: collect from the red rows, refund the green ones, recording each as a deposit.
6. **Guest** tab → invoice the office ₹64,200.
7. **Report** → **Export CSV** → file `mess-report-September2026.csv`.

Result. The month is closed. Every figure stays available to the September team forever; only employees' meal ON/OFF stops being editable after 5 October, 11:59 PM.

17 Frequently Asked Questions

17.1 Meals and deadlines

Q. Why can't I change yesterday's meal?

A. Previous days are locked for every employee, always, with no exception and no grace period. Meal records have to stop moving at some point or no bill could ever be trusted. A mess manager can still correct a past date, provided it belongs to their own running period.

Q. Why is today's lunch locked when it is only 11:05?

A. The lunch deadline is 11:00 AM. The lock takes effect at the deadline to the minute, in Bangladesh time, using the server's clock — so a phone set five minutes slow will still show the meal locked.

Q. What exactly happens after a deadline?

A. Four things: the button gets a padlock within 15 seconds; the database rejects any attempt to change that meal; the meal joins your "Meals I had" count because it can no longer change; and the cook's plate count for that meal is final.

Q. Can I set my meals for next week?

A. Yes, as far ahead as you like. Future dates are always editable — the deadline only applies once that day becomes today. This is the recommended way to use the app.

Q. Who can change historical data?

A. Only the mess manager whose own period owns that meal, and only while their period is running (00:00 on its first day to 23:59 on its last, Bangladesh time). After that, nobody — not the next manager, not an administrator through the interface.

Q. The deadline times in this manual do not match my screen.

A. The deadlines are a setting a mess manager can change at any time. The line under "My meals" in your panel always prints the real ones — trust that.

Q. I tapped a meal and it went back to how it was, outlined in red.

A. The save failed — almost always the connection. Tap it again. Nothing was written, so there is nothing to undo.

17.2 Meal counts and money

Q. Why is breakfast only 0.75 of a meal?

A. Because breakfast costs the mess less than lunch. Each meal carries a weight — by default Breakfast 0.75, Lunch 1.25, Dinner 1.00 — so people who eat only breakfast are not billed as if they ate a full lunch.

Q. My meal count went up and I did not eat anything extra.

A. The mess manager raised a date's meal count for a special meal — a biryani night at dinner 2.00, for example. It applies to everyone who had that meal on that date. The note inside "Meals I had" warns that this can happen.

Q. How is my due amount calculated?

A. $\text{meal count} \times \text{meal rate} = \text{total bill}$, then $\text{total deposit} - \text{total bill} = \text{balance}$. A negative balance is shown as a **Due**; a positive one as a **Refund**. Every step is printed on your "My bill" card.

Q. "Meals I had" says 67.5 but my bill says 74.25. Which is right?

A. Both. "Meals I had" counts only meals that can no longer change (past meals). Your bill counts every meal that is ON this month, including ones you have booked for days still to come. By the end of the month the two agree.

Q. Where does the meal rate come from?

A. The month's team divides the mess's total spending (Spend → Sum Spending) by the month's total meal count (Dashboard) and rounds it. The application does not choose it.

Q. Why can't I see the meal rate yet?

A. Because it has not been **published**. A manager can test as many rates as they like during the month; none of them reaches employees until **Publish meal rate** is pressed.

Q. Is the "dummy meal rate" my real bill?

A. No. It is a private what-if calculator. The number you type never leaves your phone, is stored under your own account, is erased when you sign out, and has no connection to the manager's rate.

Q. I paid more than my bill. What happens?

A. Your row shows **Remaining (refund)** with the amount. The mess manager either hands it back or records it as an advance deposit in the next month.

17.3 Guests

Q. How does guest meal billing work?

A. Guests are billed to the office at fixed rates — Breakfast ₺60, Lunch ₺150, Dinner ₺150 — and the month's total appears as "Total bill to collect" on the Guest tab and "Guest bill to collect" on the Dashboard. No employee's meal count or bill changes by a single taka.

Q. Can employees see guest numbers?

A. No. The Employee Panel never shows guests. The cook's public board shows today's guest counts (never any money) so the right amount of food is prepared.

Q. Twenty more guests turned up. Do I add a second entry?

A. No — change the number and save again. There is exactly one guest record per date per month, and saving overwrites it.

Q. Why are the lunch and dinner guest boxes greyed out on the 5th?

A. The 5th is a handover day. The outgoing month declares breakfast guests; the incoming month declares lunch and dinner. Each month declares only its own meals.

17.4 Accounts and access

Q. I forgot my password.

A. There is no reset e-mail. Ask the mess manager to press **Reset login** beside your name, then sign up again at </employee/signup> with the same Token Number and a new password. Your meals and deposits are untouched.

Q. Someone else signed up with my Token Number.

A. The mess manager presses **Reset login**, which deletes that login, and you sign up again immediately. Token numbers are not secret — they are printed on the meal board — so whoever signs up first claims one.

Q. My panel says "Account deactivated".

A. A mess manager has deactivated you. You can still sign in but cannot set meals or see your bill until you are reactivated. Your history is safe.

Q. Can two people use the mess manager account at once?

A. Yes — that is the design. One account per month, shared by the whole team of about five. There is no per-person manager login.

Q. Can I see another month's data?

A. Only by signing in as that month's account. Months are sealed from one another in the database, so changing a URL or an ID returns nothing.

17.5 Months and history

Q. What happens at the beginning of a new month?

A. On the 5th the incoming team takes over from lunch. Nothing is copied forward: every employee starts with all meals OFF, the new month has no rate, no deposits, no guests and no spending. The employee list and the meal deadlines carry over, because they are office-wide.

Q. What happens to the previous month's data?

A. Nothing — it stays exactly as it was, and the previous team keeps full access to it forever. The only thing they lose is the ability to change employees' meal ON/OFF.

Q. Why does 4 October appear in September's report?

A. Because a mess month runs 5th to 5th. September 2026 means 5 September lunch through 5 October breakfast, so 1–4 October belong to September.

Q. Why is my dashboard empty at the start of a month?

A. Because nothing has been recorded yet. Zeros and dashes are the normal empty state. A genuine failure shows a red box with a **Try again** button instead.

17.6 Data and corrections

Q. What should I do if I see incorrect information?

A. Employees: tell the mess manager, naming the date and the meal — tapping a counter in "Meals I had" gives you the exact dates to quote. Managers: correct it on Meal Status for that date (meals), or Expense Status (deposits — remove the wrong one and add a correct one).

Q. Can a deposit be edited?

A. No — deposits are removed and re-added. **Remove** asks for confirmation naming the amount and the employee.

Q. Why won't the app let me delete an employee?

A. Because they have meals or deposits on record, and billing history must never disappear. Deactivate them instead — they vanish from the meal board but stay in every month's report where they ate or paid.

Q. What does "Not yours" mean on a meal column?

A. You are looking at a handover day (the 5th) and that meal belongs to the neighbouring month's manager. It is read-only for you and is left out of your meal counts.

Q. "This date is outside your mess month" — what now?

A. Press **Jump to today**, or pick a date between your period's first and last dates (shown in the sidebar under your account name).

Q. Is the CSV the same as what I see on screen?

A. Yes — the same rows and the same numbers, plus the breakfast/lunch/dinner breakdown. It always exports every employee, even when the table on screen is filtered to one.

18 Quick Start Guide

Two pages. Print them, pin them by the mess counter.

Employee — 30-second guide

1. **Sign in** at `/employee` with your **Token Number** and password.
2. **Open the day you care about** — **Next** → for tomorrow, or the date box for any day.
3. **Tap Breakfast / Lunch / Dinner** to switch each ON or OFF. It saves itself; there is no Save button.
4. **Watch the padlocks.**  means that meal can no longer be changed by you.
5. **Respect the deadlines** — Breakfast **8:00 AM**, Lunch **11:00 AM**, Dinner **5:00 PM** (today only; future days are always open).
6. **Scroll down** for the month: meals you have had, your deposits, and your bill once it is published.

Mess Manager — 30-second guide

1. **Sign in** at `/admin` as your month, e.g. `September2026`.
2. **Dashboard** — check the badge is **Active** and read today's three plate counts.
3. **Meal Status** — announce the dish, fix any meal an employee asks about, adjust a date's meal count for a special meal.
4. **Guest** — type today's guest numbers the moment you hear about them.
5. **Spend** — record every bazar payment the same day.
6. **Expense Status** — record deposits as cash arrives.
7. **Month end** — Sum Spending ÷ month meal count → **Test** the rate → **Publish** it → collect, refund, **Export CSV**.

18.1 The numbers to remember

THING	VALUE
Mess month	5th lunch → next 5th breakfast
Meal deadlines (today only)	Breakfast 8:00 AM · Lunch 11:00 AM · Dinner 5:00 PM
Default meal counts	Breakfast 0.75 · Lunch 1.25 · Dinner 1.00
Guest rates (paid by the office)	Breakfast ¥60 · Lunch ¥150 · Dinner ¥150
Password minimum	Employee 6 characters · Mess manager 8 characters
Guests per meal per date	0 – 10,000 , whole numbers
Meal counts per meal per date	0 – 10 , two decimals
Time zone	Asia/Dhaka , always

18.2 Where everything lives

I WANT TO...	GO TO
See today's plate count	 — the meal board (no login)
Set my own meals	Employee Panel → My meals
See how many meals I have had	Employee Panel → Meals I had
See what I owe	Employee Panel → My bill
Fix somebody's meal	Manager → Meal Status → that date
Announce the dish	Manager → Meal Status → 🍲 What's cooking this date
Change a date's meal count	Manager → Meal Status → Meal count for this date
Change the deadlines	Manager → Meal Status → 🗓️ Employee meal deadlines
Enter guests	Manager → Guest
Record cash from an employee	Manager → Expense Status → Record a deposit
Set or publish the meal rate	Manager → Expense Status (or Report)
Record a bazar payment	Manager → Spend → + Add Spending
Total the month's spending	Manager → Spend → Sum Spending
Export the month	Manager → Report → Export CSV
Add, rename or deactivate someone	Manager → Employees
Reset a forgotten password	Manager → Employees → Reset login

The three habits that make this work

Employees: set your meals a week ahead, not the morning of. **Managers:** record spending and deposits on the day, never in a month-end rush. **Everyone:** when something looks wrong, quote the *date* and the *meal* — that is all anyone needs to fix it.

A Appendix — Screen Audit & Demo Dataset

A.1 Every route in the application

ROUTE	SCREEN	LOGIN	DOCUMENTED IN
/	Meal board (cook's view)	None	2.1, 10.6, 12.1, 13.7
/employee/signup	Employee sign-up	None	2.2
/employee/login	Employee sign-in	None	2.3
/employee	Employee Panel	Employee	3, 4, 5
/admin/signup	Mess manager sign-up	None	2.4
/admin/login	Mess manager sign-in	None	2.5
/admin	Dashboard	Manager	6.3, 11
/admin/meals	Meal Status	Manager	4.5, 6.4, 8
/admin/guests	Guest	Manager	10
/admin/expenses	Expense Status	Manager	9
/admin/spending	Spend	Manager	6.5
/admin/reports	Report	Manager	6.6
/admin/employees	Employees	Manager	7

A.2 Completeness checklist

Every item below was opened in the running application, captured, and documented.

- ✓ Meal board — populated, empty, with guests, on a phone
- ✓ Employee sign-up — blank, filled, unknown token, token taken
- ✓ Employee sign-in — blank, wrong password
- ✓ Employee Panel — to day locked, to day partly locked, future editable, past date, zero-meal day, no-record date
- ✓ Employee Panel — Meals I had, dates list, deposits, published bill, calculator (filled and blank)
- ✓ Employee Panel — populated month, empty month, previous month, handover month
- ✓ Employee Panel — deactivated account, wrong-role account
- ✓ Manager sign-up — blank, month recognised, month taken
- ✓ Manager sign-in — blank, wrong credentials
- ✓ Dashboard — populated, empty, active, completed, not started
- ✓ Meal Status — populated, empty, custom meal counts, both handover days, outside the month, finished period
- ✓ Meal Status — menu form, meal-count form, deadline editor (collapsed, expanded, saved)
- ✓ Guest — small / large / single-meal / no guests, handover day, month list, bill card, empty month
- ✓ Expense Status — populated, empty, deposit form, deposit history, rate card published, rate card testing, bills at two rates
- ✓ Spend — populated, empty, Add dialog, Edit dialog, Sum Spending
- ✓ Report — populated, empty, filtered, CSV export

- ✓ Employees — populated, empty, add form, inline edit, badges, deactivation effect

✓ Loading skeleton, error messages, lock notices, period notices
- ✓ Phone layouts — board, Employee Panel, Dashboard, Expense Status, Meal Status

A.3 The demo dataset behind every screenshot

So that every figure in this manual can be checked, here is exactly what was loaded.

Manager accounts

ACCOUNT	PERIOD	STATE ON 29 SEP 2026
August2026	5 Aug lunch → 5 Sep breakfast	Completed — full month, rate ৳88 published
September2026	5 Sep lunch → 5 Oct breakfast	Active — the manual's reference month
October2026	5 Oct lunch → 5 Nov breakfast	Not started — two advance deposits
November2026	5 Nov lunch → 5 Dec breakfast	Not started — completely empty (all empty-state figures)

Employees (14)

TOKEN	NAME	PAT TERN	SEP MEAL COUNT
101	Romith Ahmed	All three most days; no breakfast on Fridays; on leave 12–13 Sep	74.25
102	Tanvir Hasan	Never breakfast; off at weekends	41.75
103	Nusrat Jahan	Lunch only	27.75
104	Sabbir Rahman	Every meal, every day	82.50
105	Mehedi Hasan	Irregular — several days with zero meals	28.00
106	Farhana Akter	Breakfast + lunch, weekdays	40.50
107	Imran Kabir	Night shift — dinner only	26.00
108	Sadia Islam	All three on weekdays; no deposits at all	55.50
109	Rakib Hossain	Lunch + dinner; overpaid	62.00
110	Jannatul Ferdous	All three; paid exactly the bill	80.25
111	Arif Mahmud	Joined 15 Sep	46.50
112	Shahriar Kabir	Left 20 Sep , now deactivated	31.25
113	Mizanur Rahman	Lunch + dinner, a few days off	50.75
—	Rafiq Chowdhury	No token , no meals, no deposits	0

Tokens 101, 102, 104, 109 and 110 have signed up; the rest show **Not signed up**.

September 2026 in numbers

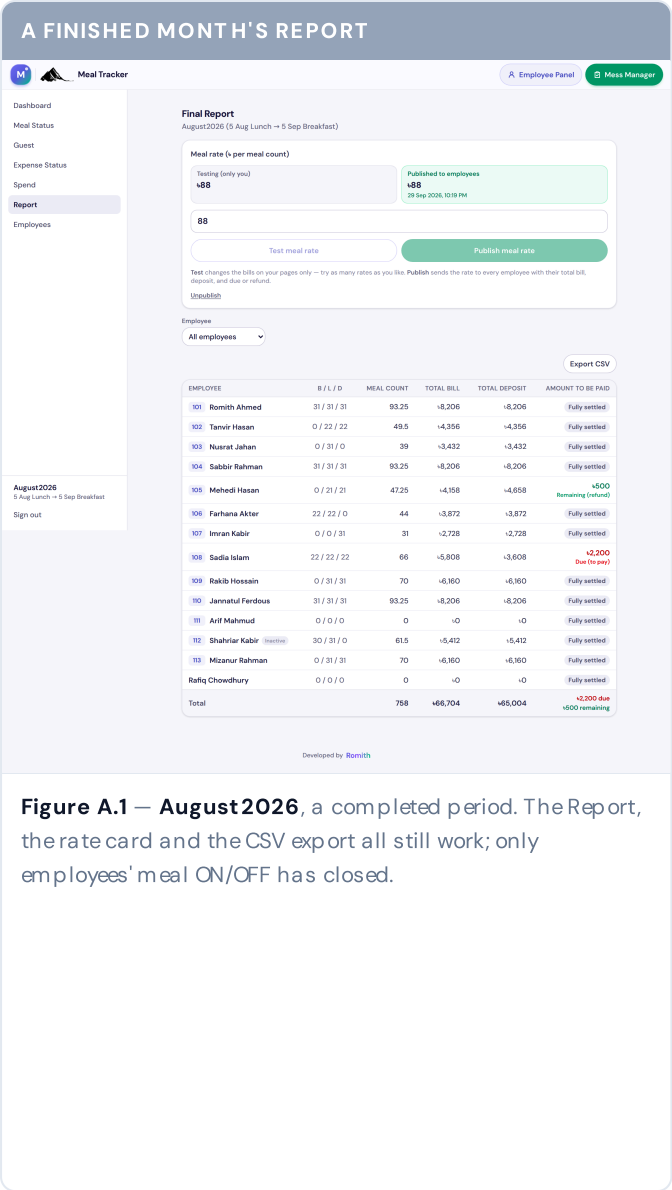
FIGURE	VALUE	WHERE TO CHECK IT
Daily meal records loaded	629	Across August and September
Month meal count	647	Dashboard
Meal rate (tested and published)	₹92.50	Expense Status
Total bill	₹59,847.53	Dashboard · Expense Status footer
Deposits received (18 deposits)	₹54,723.13	Dashboard · Expense Status footer
Still due	₹7,100.64	Dashboard · Expense Status footer
Remaining (refunds)	₹1,976.24	Expense Status footer
Total monthly spending (15 entries)	₹59,900	Spend → Sum Spending
Guest bill to collect (7 dates)	₹64,200	Guest tab · Dashboard
Guests: breakfast / lunch / dinner	35 / 291 / 123	Guest bill card
Customised meal-count dates	2	16 Sep (dinner 2.00) · 21 Sep (breakfast 1.00, lunch 1.50)

Arithmetic check

$647 \times ₹92.50 = ₹59,847.50$; the application shows **₹59,847.53** because each employee's bill is rounded to the paisa *before* the column is totalled. Both are correct — the three-paisa difference is rounding, and the figure the employees are billed is the per-person one.

A.4 Additional reference screens

Four screens referred to in the text but shown in full here.



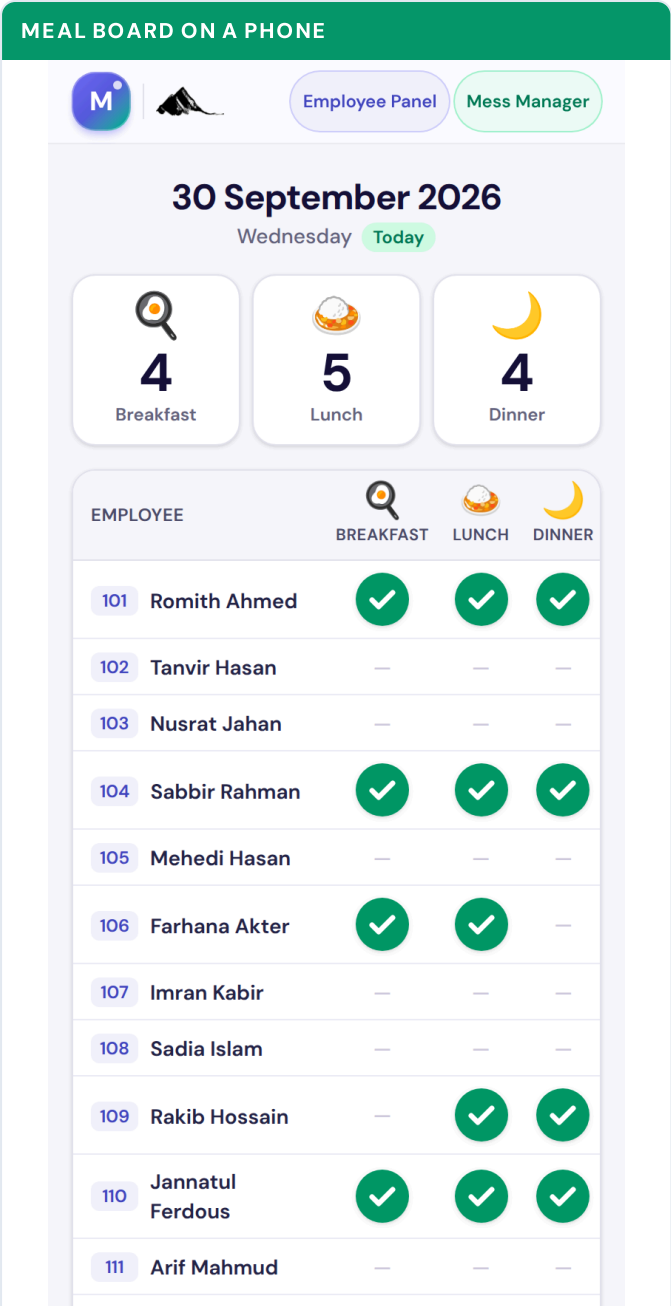


Figure A.3 — The cook's board at phone width: the three meal cards stay side by side, with guests and "To prepare" stacked underneath each.

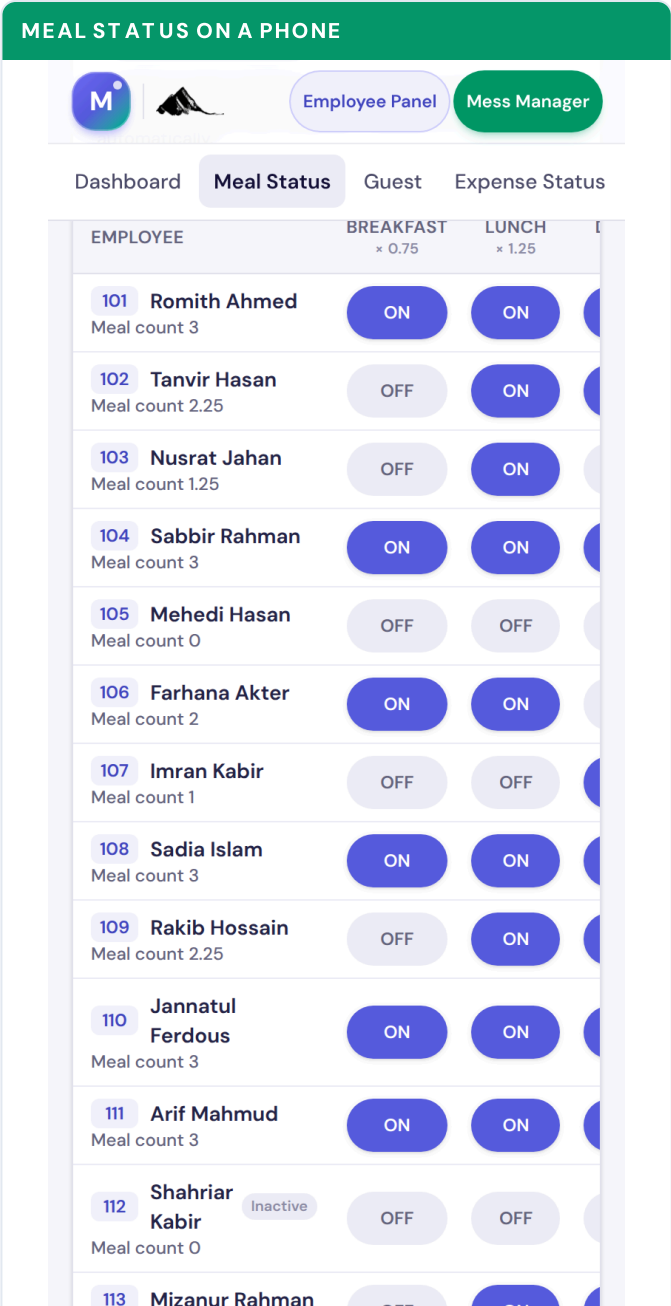


Figure A.4 — The manager's sheet on a phone: the tabs become a scrolling row, each employee's meal count moves under their name, and the meal columns scroll sideways (Dinner sits just off the right edge).

A.5 How this manual was produced

- 1. The application was run against an isolated, empty database — the production data was never touched, read or written.
- 2. Four manager accounts and fourteen employees were created through the application's own sign-up and Employees screens.
- 3. A complete month of meal records, deposits, guest dates, spending entries, custom meal counts and announced menus was loaded, plus a second, finished month (August) and two future months.
- 4. Every screen was then opened in a real browser and captured at 2× resolution — populated first, then empty, then in each locked or handover state.

5. Numbered call-outs were positioned from the live page geometry, so each marker sits on the element it names.
6. Every figure quoted in the text was read back from the application or the database and checked against the screenshots.

Reproducing a figure

Sign in as `September2026`, open the tab named in the caption, and set the same date. Because nothing in this application is cached or pre-computed, the same data always produces the same screen.